



Madeleine Strays

A WIFE-WATCHING ROMANCE



MAX SEBASTIAN

BOOK THREE OF THE MADELEINE TRILOGY

Madeleine Strays

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Madeleine Strays

BOOK THREE OF THE MADELEINE TRILOGY

M A X S E B A S T I A N

“Against the swollen river of molten jealousy there is, as far as I know, no other defence. Throw yourself in. At least that way you have a hand in your own destiny. And sink or swim, it may prove exhilarating.”

- Howard Jacobson, The Act of Love

One

It started on a Tuesday evening as the final month of the year arrived.

Hugo returned home after work to find Madeleine sitting at the little dining table between the TV area of the living room and the window seat. They didn't really use that table other than for holding a fruit bowl—most of the time eating meals on the sofa in front of the television. But here was Madeleine, having drawn out one of the chairs usually tucked tidily under the table, sitting there peering at the screen of her little MacBook.

She didn't even look up as her husband returned home from another hard day at the office, she was so absorbed.

“Hey honey.”

“Hey.”

She was wearing her glasses, which she also didn't usually do either unless she was tired—or down. In fact, Hugo realized that they hadn't really made much of an appearance in New York, certainly ever since she'd gotten her job at the bookstore. She looked cute in them—bookish, which seemed appropriate given her profession—and the look was emphasized by a high ponytail that seemed to be a light-hearted touch for Madeleine, but to Hugo gave her a coquettish hint.

“What are you up to?” he asked her quietly, dropping his briefcase by the front door.

“Oh, nothing much. I found this website.”

He took a few paces over toward the sofa, and now saw that Madeleine was wearing no pants. She sat in a white t-shirt, but after an initial moment where he thought she was naked, a couple of blinks confirmed that no, her shapely thighs were covered by pale pink leggings

as she sat there, one hand subtly tucked between, the kind she'd wear to the gym.

What was she doing?

"What's the site?"

"It's called Mary-Kay. It's a dating site."

Hugo felt that oh-so-familiar flip-flop in his stomach, and a stirring between his legs. Dating site?

She must have picked up on his pause, seeing it as a hesitation. She said defensively, "We did talk about trying a stranger?"

Instantly he said, "Uh... Yeah... Of course."

Trying to reassure her, spike any possibility she might think he disapproved. But Jesus, he thought to himself. This was really happening?

He approached her, placing his hands gently on her shoulders as he looked down at her screen, which was displaying a website designed tastefully in a lot of white with hints of pink and gray, which might have been an online florist or a wedding photographer's site except that instead of floral bouquets or wedding packages for sale, the site seemed to be offering a whole load of different men for Madeleine's perusal.

Hugo felt that familiar tingling pressure between his legs as his cock began to stiffen.

"A dating site, huh?" he said, trying to sound calm, interested but not panicking, despite the canon fire going off inside his chest. "So these are all what, potential dates?"

He gently massaged her shoulders and the back of her neck to underline his approval, his reassurance.

"It's a dating site especially for extra-marital affairs," she said, and he saw her shuffle her thighs together as though trying to cope with her own arousal. "I was actually wondering if you felt like helping me pick someone."

Hugo's eye casually tumbled through the headshots listed up on Madeleine's screen. Shots of men that she might decide to ask out, to share an evening, a nice dinner and some drinks, a few numbers on the dance floor and a taxi home. Men she might go home with, strip for, take inside her until she was screaming out their name.

"Sure," he said, leaning down to kiss the side of her neck, breathing in a hint of her perfume, yet also detecting the subtle scent of her arousal in the air.

As he kissed her, a glance down her top showed tempting cleavage bound in a sports bra, but somehow her nipples were just about visible through it.

She must have been seriously turned on.

Taking in the clues of her sports bra and leggings, he deduced: "You been to the gym this evening, honey?"

She smiled, looked up at him. "Yeah," she said with that naughty lilt in her voice. "You think that got me thinking about dating?"

"Didn't it? It's been a while since we talked about maybe looking at this."

She laughed, "Okay, maybe I was there. Maybe it made me hurry back here instead of taking my usual swim."

He smiled, "And now you're looking at lots of hot guys you might want to date?"

"Something like that. You want to take this into the bedroom?"

"Sure."

She got up, and Hugo nearly choked as he saw the damp patch between her thighs. This girl was seriously turned on.

"Coming?" she asked him, walking straight past without apparently noticing that he'd seen just how wet she was already.

Hugo felt as though he'd crossed over into some bizarre other world as he quietly followed Madeleine through to the bedroom, her laptop clutched under her arm.

Were they really about to pick out a date for Madeleine, some lucky guy for her to seduce? It felt completely unreal. But here they were, Madeleine slumping down on her front on the mattress, opening her laptop to expose that dangerous website, which must have caused so much marital strife if it specialized in adulterous affairs.

Hugo lay beside her, his arm over her shoulders, one leg slipping over her nearest thigh, so that he was almost spooning her as they both looked at the Internet browser and the list of potential dates.

“So how far have you got?” he asked her, feeling things inside him churning and fluttering at the thought that his wife was using a dating site that sported the slogan “Enjoy life now—have an affair”.

“Well, I registered for the site, as you can see. Had to create a profile to do that...”

She clicked through to show him her page. The butterflies stirred in his chest as he viewed her details. She’d called herself ‘SexySiren31’, and included a headshot photograph Hugo didn’t recognize. When had she had that taken? Her eyes in the picture were blocked out by a black ellipse, but anyone viewing would be able to see how attractive she was.

Some straightforward details about her age, location, gender, smoking habits, height and weight came alongside her photo, along with a category called “Seeking” under which she’d put *short or long-term affair*. Jesus.

Then underneath that, there was a box which stated boldly: “Things I’m open to trying”. Hugo felt his manhood thicken up as he scanned through her suggestions. Setting aside the more nonthreatening answers like *kissing*, *cuddling*, and *sensual massage*, Madeleine had included certain things Hugo might have expected—*conventional sex*, *like to give oral sex*, *likes to receive oral sex*, *experimenting with sex toys*, even *blindfolding* and *bondage*, although those were something they hadn’t really experimented with.

There were a few things that had perhaps been prompted by their recent games—*likes to be watched, role playing* of course, but also *open to experimentation*.

But she'd also included a few things that made his eyes bulge. *Curious about domination, curious about submission* were there, as was *threesome* and *anal sex*, which was something they'd never done.

"*Threesome*, huh?" he said to her, pressing his hardness against her thigh.

She laughed, and wiggled her butt, which meant her body rubbing against his erect cock. "Don't want them to think I'm boring," she said.

"So what comes next?" he asked her, squeezing her gently in his arms, pressing his face to her cheek to kiss her.

"I search for my ideal man," she said, clicking through to the search page.

"And he is..." Hugo smiled, kissed her.

"I don't know... tall, dark and handsome?" she said. "Fit, tanned, impressive in bed?"

"Sounds like there's one of those across the street," Hugo said, and saw Madeleine gently blush.

"Well," she said, "we're not going there, are we? I think we'll both feel safer with someone who doesn't hang out at my bookstore on a regular basis."

Hugo felt a slight pressure inside his chest merely from the fact that Madeleine saw Connor as a danger. It made him wonder whether the younger man from across the way might tempt her into a little more than just a one night stand if she gave him the chance. Sure, that did scare him, but it also excited him.

Madeleine put her requirements into the search boxes—tall, athletic, 25 to 50 years of age.

"Fifty?" Hugo said. "You want somebody that old?"

She smiled, said, “A little life experience—you know that could be sexy. A few gray hairs.”

Hitting the search button brought up a list of potential suitors. Madeleine flicked down through the list to the ones with pictures, but nothing seemed to catch her interest. There seemed to be a lot of guys on this service who were reluctant to include their faces in their photos, using either cut-off pictures, ridiculous looking masks, or photos that kept their faces in the dark or otherwise obscured.

“Do you really want to be with a guy who is already in a relationship?” Hugo asked her.

“No, you’re right,” she said, clicking back to her search screen to un-tick the option for *attached* males. “Hadn’t really thought of that.”

Again, the new search brought many profiles without a photo, and Madeleine skipped straight past them. On the next page of results, she scrolled down and actually found a youngish-looking guy from Queens, who had an easy-going kind of face, slightly wild overlong hair with a bit of a lazy quiff, and shades to slightly obscure his looks. He looked to Hugo a little like a Beat Poet, someone who might have hung out with Kerouac or Ginsberg in the 50s.

“How come these guys still block out their faces?” Hugo asked. “They’re all single...”

“Fearful of vengeful husbands, I guess,” Madeleine laughed as she looked at her husband, who was the very antithesis of vengeful.

The guy’s preferences box seemed to list most—if not all—the same tastes as Madeleine, Hugo noticed.

His message was that he’d recently moved back to the area and was looking to meet up with new people, keep it simple with no strings. It made Hugo wonder why he was particularly interested in married or attached women—you didn’t use this website merely for dating single women.

Madeleine hit the button *add to favorites*, and Hugo felt a little ripple of fear and excitement jaunt through his body.

“Him, huh?” he asked her, giving her a squeeze.

“Maybe,” she said, blushing again. “But I’ll keep looking at the options.”

“You do that, honey.”

Hugo could no longer lie idly by her side. As she scrolled through all the tall dark and handsome strangers listed on her screen, he peeled off her top, and began to massage her shoulders and her back. She moaned as he coaxed her muscles, and was clearly enjoying his treatment of her while she cast her eyes on various men that some day she might want to sleep with.

When he reached for the bedside table to retrieve the small bottle of massage oil in there, he found she had already removed her sports bra.

It was a joy to touch her, to feel her smooth skin, and have her respond to his touch.

He massaged the muscles in her legs, and found himself sliding his face along her thighs, seeking out that wicked scent coming from her damp sex.

“How about this one?” she asked as he touched her. He pulled one of her knees up so that her legs could part, giving him easier access to her pussy.

“Looks good, honey,” he said. Her choices all seemed similar—showing a clear difference from her husband—yet a nobvious hint of Connor. Was she embracing the difference between these guys and himself? Did it matter?

He loved that she was doing this—actually looking for the right man with whom to explore The Fantasy. But his focus was increasingly less on the stream of guys she was looking at, and more at the beautiful goddess lying under him.

He dipped his nose between her thighs and inhaled her sexy scent, but unable to resist, he reached up to peel down her leggings, along with her drenched panties, and then while she shortlisted a handful of men she intended to send messages through the website, Hugo prized apart her legs, pushed up her hips and ducked down to taste her flaming hot pussy.

She raised her own hips a little more as he ate her, her moans telling him all he needed to know about how he was making her feel while she played with her dating website.

He couldn't resist feasting on her while she was busy checking out an array of studs she might choose to fuck. It just seemed wrong on so many levels. He turned onto his back so he could slide under her for easier access, and she rested her pussy on his face while she continued with her website.

She was so wet, and the way she was unable to keep from gently writhing as he tasted her tangy slit was so appealing to him.

After a while, he heard her giggling, felt her whole body shivering from it. He rose to find out what she was up to.

"I have three guys trying to ask me out," she said, giving him an impish grin that revealed how naughty she felt.

"You've been emailing them?" he asked.

"They have a messaging thing, like a Skype chat kind of thing."

She closed her laptop, frustrating Hugo, who wanted to see what his wife was saying to other men, what the other men were saying to try to get her interested in a date. But he didn't want her to feel she was being supervised. In this, he felt it important to let her reveal what she wanted to reveal.

She turned onto her back, and following her signals, he lay between her thighs and slid his swollen manhood inside her, in awe at how wet she was.

"You think you might want to go out with any of them?" he asked her breathlessly as they moved together.

“Maybe,” she said cryptically. “I told one of them you were licking my pussy while I was looking for a date.”

Hugo laughed. “I bet he thought you were a bad girl.”

She smiled. “He asked about you—I guess it just slipped out. Only seemed to encourage him.”

“Wow. So what happens next?”

“If you’re okay with it, perhaps I’ll suggest some dinner Saturday night.”

“He had a photo?”

“Of course, I don’t look at the ones without.”

“Show me.”

She rolled over and opened her laptop, pulling up the profile of a guy who said he was 33, single but looking for a married woman or a couple.

Straddling her as she lay on her front, he lodged his hard cock between her buttocks for a moment, until she wiggled her behind again, urging him to slide back inside her. Though she kept her legs together, she was so wet he simply glided into her, filling her completely as she tapped out a suggestion for a dinner date.

Hugo was so stoked as he thrust inside her, seeing her gazing at the photograph of a man she could be dating—a man who might just screw her senseless.

The reply from this stranger came quickly. Madeleine clicked it, shooting him a look over her shoulder. She read his response aloud. “I’d love to...”

Her orgasm took them both by surprise, abrupt and hard, a moment before Hugo found himself exploding inside her.

He felt so big, so powerful as he pumped his hot seed inside her, like some alpha male in an animal pack out in the wild, marking his territory.

Wondering if the next weekend might find another man here
between her legs, giving her this flushed look of exultant jubilation after
bringing her to the most almighty orgasm.

TWO

Wednesday, Hugo woke up a little tired but with that enormous sense of wellbeing he always experienced the morning after sex with his wife. During the quiet times at work he found himself recalling the musky aroma of her sex. He found himself staring into space, dreaming of her flavor on his lips, his cock squeezed between her thighs.

The first few hours, he'd forgotten about the date entirely. Only when Madeleine texted to tell him that the guy from the website had emailed her a few times, flirting with her, did he feel the acid of uncertainty and fear injected into his stomach.

- > What did he say?
 - > He asked me what I liked doing on first dates.
 - > That's nice. Probably just trying to work out what he's going to do with you.
 - > Or how far I'm willing to go.
 - > How far are you willing to go?
 - > Depends what he's like ;-)
 - > If you like him? :-P
 - > If I really like him maybe I'm willing to find a hotel somewhere.
- :-P

That evening, she revealed she'd been chatting with the guy via email all day, and Hugo felt a little jealous she hadn't texted anything more about it. The guy was named Matthew. He was a business development executive for a company that manufactured water pipes, which led to Hugo teasing his wife having an affair with a plumber.

They made love that night, neither really in the mood to talk about what was coming on the Saturday night, though there was no doubt it was on their minds. Madeleine was particularly fiery in taking her

husband, and so wet as she straddled him and had her wicked way with him.

Thursday night, Madeleine had another one of her bookstore events, which meant sex was off the menu. On Friday night, she wanted to save herself for the following day, so again her husband went without.

Hugo felt himself wound tightly. He craved physical contact with his wife ahead of her planned encounter with another man, but he was unable to consummate his desires.

All week Hugo had been anxious about what was coming up, sure, but he'd felt that anxiety before. The surprise was just how scared, excited, nervous and aroused Madeleine was, all at once.

She'd led Hugo on a merry dance since they'd started their date nights, but though sometimes he had suggested certain fantasy situations for them to imagine, it had been Madeleine who'd had the gift to really make her husband believe they were doing it for real.

So Hugo had already experienced that heady mix of emotions before from thinking this was really happening. Madeleine had never experienced anything like it. She seemed a little pale, drawn almost—and yet if he asked her if she was okay, if she was worried about the date, she would smile, lights flickering on in her eyes, and she would become breathless with uncertain excitement. She was giddy, dizzy with anticipation—Hugo knew that feeling so well, felt it himself to a great degree, but now had Madeleine as a distraction.

Thursday night, he stayed home while she was doing her thing at the bookstore. He went to bed, even drifted off to sleep, and when he woke a little later, Madeleine was out in the living room, talking to someone on the phone. It didn't take long for Hugo to realize it was Matthew, the guy she was all set to go on a date with Saturday night.

Hugo was instantly hard as he heard her, even before he could make out what she was saying. Just knowing she was having an intimate conversation with another man put him on edge.

“Oh, I know how lucky I am,” she was saying. He couldn’t hear the other side of the conversation, but it seemed she’d been accurate in stating that she’d talked to this guy about her husband and his secret fantasy. That was a good thing, Hugo decided. The guy knew where he stood from the outset.

“Yeah, I was pretty unsure about it at first... sure, I thought about hot guys sometimes, you know, fantasized... no, I never thought about doing that.”

Hugo crept to the doorway, keeping to the shadows, and peered through the crack in the door.

“It was crazy—it is crazy... really? There is?”

Madeleine was sitting on the window seat, leaning back against the wall as she often had when spending some personal time in the company of her view, and particularly her view of the students and Connor.

“And I thought it was just my husband being weird!”

It felt like the old days as he paused to simply watch her a while. She was wearing her smart work gear, of course, though she’d removed her suit jacket to leave her in just the short skirt and white blouse, her legs covered by smart black pantyhose.

“It’s just fun. An ego boost, you know? And what it does to the libido... God...”

The way she was sitting, her skirt was pushed up a little, and while one hand held the phone up to her ear, the other danced circles on her thighs, creeping steadily upward.

“And you’re called a ‘Bull’—isn’t that kind of demeaning?”

He felt that tightness in his chest as he listened, the pressure of jealousy from realizing his wife had probably been in frequent contact with this guy, by email or phone, since that initial online connection, but she hadn’t opened up about any of it.

He supposed this was part and parcel of what he was doing with Madeleine—he had to accept her side of the deal, even come to

appreciate her independence.

“Oh yes, I’m sure I will. But so far it’s been kinda fun winding him up, teasing him.”

She wasn’t making any effort to talk quietly to Matthew, assuming it was him she was talking to—and that made it seem to Hugo firstly that she wasn’t attempting to hide anything, and secondly that she might even hope to wake her husband up with her late-night conversation.

“Control over him? Oh, I’m not sure it’s like that... you think?”

Hugo felt conflicted—he wanted to go out there, be with her, perhaps even sexually if she was in the right mood, and just after talking to her date he suspected she had to be. But he was also curious about what she was saying to her date, and did not want to affect the conversation by being out there.

He also had the old urge to just pause and watch her, take in the magnificence of her beauty. Madeleine, his goddess.

“Well, maybe it’s something to think about one day.”

Was she getting tips from Matthew on how to do this whole marital dating thing? Hugo felt curious what the guy was saying to her—if he was so relaxed about the fact she had a husband allowing her to do this, and he was a regular on this marital dating website, perhaps he’d done this a few times before.

“Well, okay.”

Hugo was about to head out there, to see if she might put him on speaker, since the conversation seemed more interesting than personal. Then Madeleine giggled, and stopped him just before he had a hand on the door handle.

She said to her date: “I have my suit on. Well, I took my jacket off.
“

Hugo paused, and then knelt back down.

Madeleine was running her free hand down her body, from her neck down over her chest, then down to her thigh and along the smooth dark

nylon of her pantyhose. It was a graceful motion that Hugo had seen before when he'd watched her in secret.

He could see her breathing beginning to deepen.

"I can't tell you that—I haven't even met you yet," she said quietly, but Hugo could see her blush faintly, and her hand flicked open a couple of buttons of her blouse before slipping inside to cup her cleavage.

A few moments fondling herself, and Madeleine's hand moved back to unfasten more of her buttons, her shirt falling open to reveal a pale pink and white satin bra, complete with a little bow poised just between her breasts.

She giggled again, said in that girlish, flirty voice of hers: "Well if you must know, it's pink and white. Silk... Feels very nice... soft... warm..."

Hugo felt the tension grow inside him. Had she forgotten he was there in the bedroom? That he might very well be awake? He watched her balance the phone between her shoulder and cheek, slipping off her blouse completely.

Once happy it was cast off to slunk dejectedly to the floor, she was leaning back against the wall again, the hand not now retrieving her phone slipping down the front of her bra to reveal seriously stiff nipples. She was caressing herself, teasing herself by brushing her hand over one sensitive bud, then the other.

And then she was slipping her bra strap over her shoulder, reaching behind to unfasten the catch.

Still talking to her prospective date on the phone.

"Wouldn't you like to know?" she was putting on a really soft, seductive voice, her words almost dripping like honey.

Hugo couldn't take his eyes off her, she was magnificent. He watched her hand stroking her thigh, drawing circles on her pantyhose, edging up until they were tracing out the crease at the top of her leg, and finally caressing her mound.

“Is it hard?” she breathed, her lips curling into a wicked grin. “How big is it?”

Hugo felt his stomach churning, imagining some guy in another part of the city holding his cock while he talked to Madeleine.

But she was so sexy.

“Oh God... I think I might be too tight for that...”

Hugo shivered, but sat tight. He wasn't going to interrupt this.

Madeleine lifted her hips, and now she peeled off her pantyhose.

“I suppose they are quite wet already...”

Hugo was startled by the fact that she wasn't wearing any panties underneath. Had she really gone to work all day without wearing panties? The thought made his hardness throb. He was so taken aback he almost missed how she brushed the nylon across her pussy, moaning at the friction as it pressed at her sensitive groove, spreading her wetness over her skin.

“Oh I'm not sure I'd let you do that... Well, perhaps so long as my husband never found out...”

Hugo was fairly sure she at least suspected he was watching now. Grazing the rough nylon over her tummy and her breasts, over her raw distended nipples and gently up her neck as though applying her scent like a perfume, she had to know her display was driving him wild. Promising him a body that already smelled of sex, that he'd get to sample her personal flavor whenever he kissed her, her performance was too graceful to be for the man on the phone.

She briefly touched her hose to her face, breathing in as though to try to ascertain why her husband or any other man could be so turned in by the musk of her sex, then she let it fall to join her blouse on the floor.

“Well now I'm not wearing anything,” she said, and Hugo saw her remove her skirt, adding: “Mmm... my husband likes doing that to me...”

He watched her touching herself, shaking a little, confused about whether he was excited by her display and her commentary for her admirer, or terrified that the extent of her intimacy with him already meant that their date made full sex inevitable.

He could hear in the stillness of the night how wet she was—did she suspect, or know, he was watching her?

“I can’t believe I’m doing this while I’m on the phone with you.”

She ducked down briefly and reached for her purse, which was lying on the floor below her. From inside she retrieved a black velvet pouch.

Hugo gasped as he saw her open the pouch to reveal a long, lilac but otherwise realistic-looking fake cock. When had she bought that?

She listened to her admirer on the phone, and gently stroked her stomach and chest with the tip of her toy.

She smiled, and moaned into the phone, “I bet you have a beautiful cock. I can’t wait to see it.”

Jealousy burned through Hugo’s every vein—and yet his long experience growing accustomed to the sensation made him embrace it, turning the sharp tightness into a mere part of his pleasure experience watching his hot wife bring that fake cock up to her face, her lips parting to kiss its tip, to lick along the underside of its shaft.

“Can you see me licking it?” she breathed, “Sucking it into my mouth?”

She slipped it inside her mouth, slurping a little and exaggerating her moans, the sounds of her lips sliding over the veiny rubber cock, for the benefit of her audience.

Then she was brushing it over her body again, down her breasts and stomach, around her mound and down to her pussy, nudging the tip against her clit and rubbing the shaft against her soaking lips.

Another long, low moan and she was circling the head of her toy around her glistening lips, until she slowly slipped it inside her.

Hugo caught his breath again, and felt certain she must have heard his involuntary response.

Madeleine had another cock inside her. It might have been fake, but the thing was realistic enough for him to imagine it was someone else's appendage—and perhaps, for her to imagine it. And there was the small matter of the other man speaking with her on the phone.

“Oh God, I love you how feel inside me...”

He was so hard, he couldn't stand it. Madeleine looked so beautiful, her hand working slowly to help the thing glide in and out of her tight, wet hole, the huge cock stretching her, reaching every sensitive part of her as it sank deep inside her.

She moaned, “Oh I shouldn't... my husband will wake up...”

He saw her drop the phone, her other hand moving to coax her clit as she fucked herself, panting for air as she drilled herself with the great fake cock.

Hugo couldn't remain hidden any longer. She smiled ecstatically as he emerged from the bedroom, giving him the warmest of feelings.

“You done watching?” she said, withdrawing her toy, resting it against her pussy.

“You done with your friend?”

“Oh I hung up ages ago.”

He took the sex toy from her, and now ducked down to replace it with his tongue, unable to keep his raw hunger for her at bay. He tasted and smelled a hint of her toy on her pussy, but it only drove on his hunger, perhaps the thought of how sexy his pretty blonde wife was to be ordering such a product from whichever online store it was that must have been getting rich from the desires of horny wives across the nation.

Realizing the fake cock was still in his hand, he offered it up to Madeleine, who now took it and placed it to her lips again, tasting herself as her tongue twirled around its tip.

“You think you’ll go all the way with him on Saturday?” he asked her, and felt a shiver from the thought that such an eventuality was a real possibility.

She smiled, shrugged. “Depends what he’s like.”

“But it’s a possibility?”

“It’s a possibility.”

He knelt up on the window seat and now steered his own cock to her flushed pussy lips, his hands on her knees as he slid so easily inside her dripping tightness.

As he fucked her, he saw her head turn, little lights flickering on inside her eyes.

Across the street, the light was on in Connor’s bedroom, and the tanned lothario appeared to have company.

“He doesn’t believe in curtains, does he?” Hugo said dryly, wondering how much of their own display was being concealed by the angle of their blinds.

She turned back to her husband, as though deciding she didn’t need to watch her crush seducing a young brunette in the apartment opposite.

“I feel jealous, watching him,” she said with a half smile as he slowly moved inside her. “Doesn’t that seem wrong to you?”

“You want him. Sure you’re jealous,” he said. “You can have him, you know.”

She shook her head, but pushed him up, picked herself up and stood facing the window, pointedly pushing out her butt to solicit his input.

“I have a date on Saturday,” she said as he slid back inside her insanely wet pussy. “Isn’t that crazy?”

They fucked like animals in front of the windows, and Hugo couldn’t be certain what fired up his pretty wife most—the athletic male mounting the brunette across the street, or the prospect that she would actually be dating a man who was not her husband in a few nights.

There was no doubt though. She was very fired up. They both were.

Three

Saturday. Waking up felt like arising on Christmas morning. Hugo was almost tempted to look out the windows to see if it had snowed during the night. It was cold enough.

He was feeling pretty keyed up by what was coming, but it didn't help with his inner tension that Madeleine had refused sex the night before, stating that she wanted to be fresh and focused ahead of her date.

She was awake before her husband, which was a surprise on a day in which she had no work shift. Having had trouble getting to sleep the previous night because of the thoughts going around and around in his head about what might happen the next day, by the time he'd eventually got to sleep, he was dead to the world until 10 am.

He woke to the sound of the front door closing as Madeleine came in from a visit to the gym.

"Hey sleepyhead," she said, doing his morning glory no favors by peeling off her sweatpants and hooded top in front of him to reveal that sexy one-piece swimsuit of hers.

"You're up early," he said.

"It's a big day, right?" she smiled, casually grazing her palms over her full breasts so that her nipples stiffened up underneath her swimsuit.

"Certainly is—you feel ready for it?"

She shrugged. "Feel a little nervous to be honest," she said. "That's why I've been to the gym—got to keep moving, right?"

She wanted him to accompany her as she kept moving, to help keep her distracted from what was happening that evening—and yet the whole day seemed to revolve around it.

She started off with stripping off that swimsuit in front of him before a quick rinse in the shower, and then they were out soon

afterwards, and Hugo found himself tailing her around Bloomingdale's, trying to find something to wear that evening.

He felt safe as long as they weren't wandering through the lingerie department. Yet he soon found the awkwardness of being dragged past so many racks of skimpy little panties or bras paled almost into insignificance when he reminded himself that she wasn't shopping for him, she wasn't even shopping for herself—she was shopping, potentially, for some clothes to impress her date.

After what seemed like half a day, she finally contented herself with the tiniest dress Hugo had ever seen, a little blue number which barely covered her rear as she was trying it on, and was so revealing around her cleavage with its plunging scoop neckline that it left nothing to the imagination. And Hugo swore the thing had some kind of spandex in the material, it was so skin-tight, molding itself to her every mouthwatering curve.

"Might as well just wear your underwear and dispense with the dress," he murmured as he sat in the changing room, watching her sport it for the mirror.

"Jealous?" she grinned, twisting her shoulders this way and that to check her angles.

"Of course," he smiled, then chuckled as she stepped back and placed her hand gently between his legs to feel his hardness there. "Are you sure it's the right size? It's not one or two too small?"

"You love it," she said.

In the lingerie department she toyed with a few possibilities in the Agent Provocateur range, including a nearly see-through blue lace bra and thong set that made Hugo wince to see her even consider it for the eyes of another man.

"You're quite concerned about your underwear considering it's a first date," he said to her quietly as she mulled over an alternative black lace teddy.

She looked at him and gave him an impish grin. “You really are jealous. I love it.”

But for whatever reason she wasn’t happy with the underwear on offer in Bloomingdale’s, or else she simply wanted to try to embarrass her husband a little more, pulling him along to a boutique store up on University Place, a little closer to home.

He just felt foolish in there—worse so than the department store, since the whole store was women’s underwear. With so much pastel and padded or frilly or lacy fittings, it was clearly not a place meant for a guy like him. He tried not to look at any of the other customers in the store, keeping his attention firmly on Madeleine, the safest place for his eyes to be.

He tried not to focus too much on the prices, either, though underneath the surface he was happy for her to spend whatever it took to get her feeling as gorgeous as she looked.

He tingled all over as she held up items as possibilities for her date to appreciate.

In the end, it was black and sheer with lace edges, a thong that was almost a G-string, it had so little there, but would remain invisible under her dress.

Her nervous energy continued as they got home, and Hugo would have thought even a mild orgasm might have calmed her down, but his offer was politely declined.

“I want to save myself for him,” she said. “You can have me soon as I get home from my date.”

“You better believe it,” Hugo smiled, though he found it a little hard to breathe after what she’d just said.

The thing was, after all the role-playing they’d done, even the realistic stuff, both of them knew this was really happening now. It was even more shocking this time because Hugo saw how nervous Madeleine

was underneath the surface, though nobody could deny she wasn't also extremely excited by what was coming.

She couldn't stay alone for a moment, though Hugo wasn't going to complain. He got to sit in the bathroom watching while she showered carefully with the shower curtain open. That was a treat in itself, seeing her gently coaxing her body wash all over her beautiful smooth skin, watching her shaving her legs. He couldn't help pressing against his hard cock through his jeans as he saw her using that little razor to tidy her patch of pubic hair—knowing that she was doing it in case her date happened to see it later that night.

Then she was putting on her lingerie, and he was telling her that if it came to the point where her date was close enough to her panties to see how sheer they were, the question as to whether she was dressed too slutty on a first date would be moot.

“You’ve been messaging him, haven’t you?” he asked. “In the past few days. Is he the kind of guy who would think bad of you for wearing that kind of underwear?”

“No, I suppose not.” Her implicit confirmation that she’d been continuing to chat to this guy in the past few days prompted a burst of jealous energy inside his chest.

“I mean, you’ve told him you’re married and that your husband is happy for you to have a fling with another guy.”

“You’re right.”

He talked her back into confidence, back into feeling comfortable about her sexy lingerie choice. As she sat in those wisps of black lace and black thigh-high hold-ups, applying her makeup in front of the mirror, it drove Hugo insane.

After brushing her hair, she tied it into the kind of girly high ponytail that he’d always thought Madeleine frowned upon, but perhaps did give her the coquettish hint she was going for on this date.

As she finally slipped on her dress, standing in front of the mirror in mild horror and elation at just how astoundingly short it was, Hugo found himself actually envying her date. Then she added a pair of shoes, complete with high heels. Fuck-me heels. Jesus. They made her push out her butt and her chest in order to maintain her balance, making her look even more devastatingly sexy

Whoever he was, if he played his cards right that evening, her date would end up a very lucky man.

“Will you be able to relax while you’re with him, honey?” he asked her after she’d asked him for the twentieth time if her dress was too over the top for a first date.

“I’ll try.”

“Remember, this isn’t supposed to be some kind of ordeal—it’s about you enjoying yourself. If you’re not enjoying yourself—”

“I know, I know,” she said, but the warmth in her smile suggested to Hugo that she had at least half-forgotten this point.

She said, “I guess I’m worried about you back here on your own...”

He slid forward, parted his legs and nudged in to sit behind her. “You’ve tested me enough, haven’t you? You’ve seen me when I’m under the impression you’ve actually been with another man.”

“I guess.” She smiled and wiggled her butt as she felt his erection pressing gently against her. She let out a quiet moan as he pushed forward. “You realize I’m going to have sex on the brain now when I meet this guy?”

Hugo chuckled. “You should, honey.”

Four

Waiting for her, he felt he should have been more prepared for the gut-wrenching uncertainty of it all, having been through it before.

He was, perhaps, a little less worried than the last time. When she'd made him think she was actually playing at being a prostitute, he had all the fears about the inherent risks that went with that oldest of professions. At least this time it was merely a first date.

She'd told him they were going to Calloway's, a fairly up-market Midtown steak house, a fairly safe venue.

He had to try to relax—plenty of young women went on plenty of first dates in New York City, you couldn't dwell on the minuscule possibility that she'd chosen to date an axe murderer. And anyway, the guy knew she was married—had to know her husband would come after him if he got abusive.

Even with his artificial attempts at calming himself, lounging in front of the TV with another feast from Domino's to keep him company, time seemed to crawl by as he waited.

About half an hour in, his phone buzzed, which made him jump half a foot into the air. First thought, naturally, was that Madeleine was in trouble. It turned out to be from Lucy of all people.

> So it's finally happening???

The three question marks at least conveyed their Maid of Honor's state of mind, and suggested she was still being kept relatively up to date on the personal details of what was going on between Hugo and Madeleine. It made Hugo laugh—Lucy was so in need of gossip, so in need of the juicy details, she couldn't wait barely half an hour into the date for the latest.

He texted back:

> She just left 30mins ago. Probably hasn't even got there yet!

A fraction of a second later, her reply:

> You actually feeling okay right now?

He actually felt touched that Lucy cared. She seemed to have changed her attitude toward him since they'd all moved to New York. He'd always got the hint of suspicion in Boston, in the latter years, that she had blamed him for Madeleine's constant distress. There was none of that feeling now. These days she seemed to want to take him under her wing, like he was some kind of favorite little brother.

He texted her back:

> Feeling good. Happy it's finally happening, hoping it's what she really wants and that it turns out great.

Well, that was fairly vague. But there was no way he was going to be able to communicate the nest of vipers going on inside him to anybody within the space of a text message.

> You're a special guy, Hugo. Madeleine's unbelievably lucky to have you. But know we can stop all this at any time, if you have any doubts about it.

He got the impression that she and Madeleine had spoken at length about all this, that Lucy perhaps saw the need to step in and ensure everything was all right even if Hugo couldn't bring himself to tell his wife directly. The way she used the word *we* in her text was oddly comforting to Hugo. Perhaps it really was a good thing that she was being kept in the loop with what was going on.

Making use of that word *we*, he texted back:

> Thanks, I know we can stop it if we have to. I'm really good now, though. Really want her to have this experience if possible, I know it sounds crazy.

Lucy texted back:

> Crazy good! God I wish I was married and had a husband like you. Keep me updated!

As his text message conversation with Lucy came to a close, one more SMS came in, though this time from Madeleine's number:

> Just arrived. Think I can see him at the table. Wish me luck!

Hugo wished her luck, his stomach doing cartwheels as he typed the message and hit the send button. By the time he'd sent a dutiful text to Lucy letting her know the date had started, he found that his heart rate and his breathing had quickened, while his hands had gone quite clammy clutching that phone.

He was even shaking a little.

Was this his body's way of telling him this was unnatural, wrong? God, he felt so hot inside, yet his skin was cold, rising into goose bumps.

It was only a first date, he told himself. Dinner would take at least an hour, Madeleine wasn't the type to rush it so she could get him to a hotel room. But then what type was she? She'd consistently broken through the boundaries of the type her husband had thought her to be—it was quite a thrill.

Sitting with phone in hand in case any news arrived, all he could do was breathe, and wait.

*

Two hours after her dinner started, with Hugo telling himself the extended meal was merely the way things were in an up-market restaurant rather than his wife's unwillingness to keep him informed, she texted him to let him know they were headed to a bar for a few drinks.

They were going to a bar—that meant the meal had to have gone well.

Hugo's stomach was really churning now—he even felt a little sick. She must be getting on nicely with her date, making a decision to go to another place, where she'd have more alcohol to lower her inhibitions.

As he had quite a bit in the previous couple hours, he started pacing around the room again, trying to calm himself down. He spotted their framed photographs sitting on the table by the front door, and picked up an image of the two of them taken at a house party back in Boston, Madeleine leaning back against his chest, his arms around her.

She looked so happy—that was just before they were married. Was she that happy again, now? Was she flashing that magical, care-free smile at her date right now? Hugo hoped so.

The text message he received from Lucy in reply to his update gave him some sound advice:

> Keep yourself occupied, it'll take your mind off things.

It was good advice, as it turned out. He figured that television wasn't going to cut it—instead, he fished out his laptop and did a little work for an hour, then when there was still no word from Madeleine, he pulled on his gym clothes and went down to the gym for a workout.

*

After a long leisurely workout—and cooling-down swim—still there was no further word from Madeleine.

He felt a little crushed to open the front door to an empty apartment. Strangely, his cock was semi-erect, and now the distraction of his visit to the gym was behind him, the thoughts returned to his head, of what she might be doing with her date that made her forget to keep her husband informed of her whereabouts.

Necking with him in some dark alleyway behind the bar, hands flying all over the place.

Sucking on each other's tongues while his hands found their way between her legs, to find the tiny little thong she was wearing.

Kneeling in some shady doorway somewhere, pulling his cock out before inhaling it.

Cuddling up to him in the back of a taxi on the way back to a hotel, his finger slipping inside her soaking pussy.

Hugo did a tentative search of the bedroom and bathroom, in case she was merely being very quiet—but it was clear she wasn't there, and hadn't been since she'd left for her date.

*

One o'clock in the morning. Still no sign. Sleep was impossible. Madeleine was going to come home to a very tidy apartment.

Thirty minutes passed, and then his heart nearly stopped as his phone buzzed—a text message from Madeleine. Finally.

> I'm so sorry! Completely lost track of time! On my way home.

Her text provoked shock—Hugo felt as though somebody had poured boiling oil down his throat, to scald and blister his stomach.

Where was she? Had she been with him all this time? It terrified and exhilarated Hugo in equal portion, but it bothered him a little that she hadn't clued him in to her whereabouts for such a long period. She had to have known how nervous he was about all this.

He responded:

> Can't wait to see you! You have a good time?

He wasn't angry, though. He placed blame on the alcohol, on the potential awkwardness she faced in such a new situation, on the undoubtedly intense attention she must have been getting from her date. It would have made it difficult to pull out her phone and start texting her husband.

Anyway, there was something so sexy about his wife having independence in her dating, even if it conflicted with his desire to watch. He couldn't entirely put a finger on why.

That final wait for her to arrive home was so jittery—he was a bundle of nerves, still, not knowing which way the date had gone, how

far she had gone with Matthew. His assumption was that she must have done something. She'd been emailing the guy and talking to him on the phone all week, she definitely liked him.

*

At last, down the hallway he heard the quiet ding of the elevator arriving on their floor and the doors opening.

Having been sitting on the couch, attempting to focus on the late night chat shows, he suddenly made the last-minute decision that when Madeleine came in, she should find him in bed. He wanted her to think he'd been relaxed waiting for her, perhaps even sleeping a little since she was so late.

He didn't want her to think he'd been so unbelievably nervous all evening.

Quietly, he slipped off the lights and stole through into the bedroom, pulling off his clothes before diving onto the mattress to switch on the bedside lamp. By the time he heard the rattle of the front door being unlocked and opened, he was giving a passable impression of someone who had only just woken up.

And there she was, and Hugo could not believe how desirable she looked—and that she had actually gone out to dinner and more with another man, wearing a dress as tiny as that.

She'd taken her hair out of her ponytail. What did that mean?

"Hey, you're still awake?" she said, her voice sounding a little dry, a little hoarse. The bar must have been loud, forcing their conversation into loud voices.

Or had she been screaming too much as her date had thrust inside her?

"Of course," he said, trying his utmost to sound casual. "You have a good time?"

She sauntered over to the bed, and he saw that she had been carrying her shoes, which she now dropped. She shrugged, “We had a nice dinner.”

Hugo’s stomach shrank.

“Anything happen afterwards?” he asked.

Standing in front of him, by the edge of the bed, she slipped the dress over one shoulder, then the other, allowed the little thing to drop to the floor to reveal her black lingerie and those sexy hold-ups.

“I guess I could tell you that it did,” she said, and he caught his breath as she reached behind to unfasten her bra strap, allowing it to fall, revealing those gorgeous breasts, her nipples so hard.

But she wrinkled her nose, and that was enough for Hugo to know her date had not ended as hoped.

“Matthew wasn’t the one?” he asked her.

She shook her head.

“I think to start with, I was just too nervous,” she said, climbing onto the bed. “But the thing was, I just didn’t feel it for him.”

Hugo felt a touch of disappointment, but he’d been through her role-plays before, when hopes and even sure-fire certainty that she had finally experienced extra-marital passion were dashed. Bottom line: he was just happy to get Madeleine back, and still apparently fired up.

“You must have had some fun,” he said. “Staying out so late?”

She smiled, and now peeled down the bed sheets, her eyes lighting up as she revealed her husband’s bare torso, and then the bulge in his boxers. “He was an interesting guy,” she said. “We talked a whole lot—and I guess I wanted to see if it was just nerves, you know—”

“You just didn’t find him attractive?”

“I can’t explain it—I mean, he wasn’t hideous. I’d seen pictures of him on the website. I talked to him on the phone, he seemed nice. But when I met him in real life...”

“You didn’t have chemistry with him.”

Hugo finished her sentence for her, but then she was kissing his mouth, and he felt in her kiss that she was relieved to be home, relieved to be back in his arms.

He tasted the white wine on her breath—she hadn't progressed to spirits, then. He found it hard to believe she'd been out on her date so long, coming back well past midnight, if she hadn't found her date the least bit alluring.

There was no stopping her now. Kneeling between his legs, she pulled his hard cock out of his boxer shorts and now sank onto it, drawing out a moan as her heat enveloped his sensitive tip and her fingers closed around his shaft.

“You never really went for the online dating craze before we met, did you?” he said, and looking up at him, she shook her head with his cockhead still in her mouth. “It's not quite as simple as picking a guy on the website and then falling for him soon as you meet him.”

God, she was so hungry for his cock. He was taken aback by her force—it was almost too much. He felt her tongue lashing him, her lips tight around his swollen girth—it was so hot that she was fired up by the need that had built up on her date.

He had to concentrate to avoid simply losing it in her mouth, though he got the feeling she wouldn't have minded so much if he'd let loose like that.

It was such a turn-on to see such a voracious sexual appetite in her, as though she'd been starved for weeks, and this was the first food offered to her—his cock tasting delicious to her. God, had her nipples ever been that hard? He gently held her head, his fingers slipping into her soft hair, but he didn't need to guide her rhythm or spur her on—she was taking what she wanted.

“You must have felt a little frustrated,” he said, trying to distract himself a little from the danger of imminent orgasm. “Dating a guy you

were allowed to do whatever you wanted with—and he just didn't get you going.”

She moaned in agreement, and he felt the vibrations through her mouth.

“That’s the thing with online dating—chances are you won’t find Mr. or Ms. Right the first time.”

“Mmm-hmm...”

“I can imagine you sitting there, thinking how you were allowed to go off with him if you liked, kiss him. Suck his cock. Let him inside you...”

“Mmmm...”

Oh God, she was good. Her poor date had missed out on this. Violating her pretty face with his big hard veiny cock.

“I wonder if it had been someone more like Connor, if you’d be here now,” he said, the words just bursting out of his mouth, seemingly before the thought had even formulated in his head.

“Mmm-hmm...” she liked that idea.

“You’d be in some seedy hotel room—or perhaps across the street in his apartment,” he said. His jealousy rose right along with the thrill there. His words spurred Madeleine on. “Maybe kissing him, or tasting that big, hard cock of his...”

She broke off from him, lifted up her head, fire in her eyes. Hand still locked around his shaft, squeezing him fiercely, she knelt forward to kiss his mouth. Feeling the soft sweetness of her lips as his nose lodged against hers, he felt her tongue penetrate him, and tasted the gentle saltiness he knew was his own cock.

God, would he really be able to kiss her mouth after she’d been with another man? Risking tasting his cock?

A shiver ran down his spine, but there was something darkly attractive about the idea. Tasting her like this would be proof beyond

doubt of her transgression—proof that she was indeed insatiable, as he'd always wanted.

She slipped aside her panties and plunging down on his rigid column, making him gasp from the sudden intense heat gripping him.

“Oh that really got you going, huh?” he grinned. “The thought of going on a date with Connor?”

She smiled, but did not answer. Just placed her hands on his shoulders and rode him, as though she were on a stallion galloping down a beach, wild and bareback. Hugo went with her, in awe at her magnificence, her sexy black thigh-high hold-ups adding a touch of the unreal to this glorious union between them.

He managed to hold himself, somehow, until her climax was building. Then she was shaking over him, pressing down against his body as the wave of energy washed over her, her tight pussy spasming around his hardness, milking him, so that even if he'd wanted to keep himself from coming, he would have been entirely unable.

It had been such a strange night, the nerves and the tension melting away as they fucked so hard, so desperately.

“Oh God, that was intense,” she said, breathless as they lay back afterwards, and he got the impression she didn't just mean the final lovemaking.

It had been an intense evening, despite the disappointing date.

What particularly pleased him was that when he finally awoke, and it was Sunday at noon, he came out into the living room to find Madeleine sitting at their little dining table, tapping away on her laptop—and on the screen was that familiar white and pink website where she might find someone for her second online date.

Five

After that first date, she seemed to take things more slowly, more cautiously. She chatted online with guys, or else she emailed them, but jumped to no conclusions about any of them being that special someone.

A few times through December, she told Hugo she was meeting someone for lunch, which seemed like a safe starting point. It always made him feel a flutter of hope, though he knew nothing much would happen over lunch itself, even if she clicked with her lunch date. But nothing came of her lunch meetings—she came back with a shrug or a sigh, seemingly happy to have done it, though uninspired by what had transpired.

“It’s like some weird kind of job interview,” she said once. “Only the potential job on offer is to sleep with me.”

“Isn’t that basically what any date is like?” Hugo had replied, thinking to himself how frustrating it must be to be one of her lunch dates, and have her sitting right there, potentially available for seriously hot sex, only to have the opportunity vetoed at the end of the lunch. Seeing her dressed in hot skin-tight jeans and a pink-and-white striped sweater that really highlighted her feminine curves, giving her a soft sex-kitten look, Hugo felt real pity for those men who did not meet Madeleine’s standards.

“But usually when you’re dating someone you met in the real world, you know you’re vaguely interested in them, and you kind of know you’re going to have at least a few dates to see what happens,” she said. “But with this it feels as though they only have lunch to impress me, to win me. So they just pitch to me as though they’re salesmen.”

“So maybe offer them more than just a lunch date to prove themselves?”

She'd laughed at that. "I guess. Haven't really found anyone yet to make me want to offer more than a lunch date, though."

Hugo was endlessly patient as she spent all that time through into January corresponding with various men through the website, carefully narrowing her list of options, dispensing with any who gave her even a hint of turning into a disappointment, inviting a few out for coffee or a sandwich.

Even if the process seemed long and slow, it was still exciting to both Hugo and Madeleine. Whenever she was at home in the evening, rather than out with Lucy or her bookstore buddies, or working the late shift, she spent time at her laptop dealing with the emails from her current shortlist, or from new prospects. Then they'd take it into the bedroom to defuse any tensions arising.

The lunch dates provided an added frisson, an added note of possibility, even though Hugo quickly came to see them as harmless in themselves.

Hugo didn't rush her, he didn't worry that it was taking her so long. He was supremely happy she was doing this at all, and wanted her to feel fully supported and confident in what she was pursuing. He respected and appreciated the care she was taking in this, demonstrating how precious she perceived his gift of sexual freedom.

As though rewarding him for his patience, Madeleine made love to him more frequently than ever. He was staggered each time just how wet she was—this process was a serious turn-on for her, as well.

When he finally came home one Friday night to find her sitting at the table with her laptop closed, and the first thing she said was that she'd agreed to a full dinner date with one of her shortlisted men, Hugo almost felt disappointment that their search for her next date was finally over.

"Is it Will?" he asked her, naming one of the stronger candidates among her list of five serious contenders she had been chatting with for a

while.

Standing now, though not really approaching him, she nodded silently.

“That’s great, honey!” he said, trying to appear relaxed, bright, supportive, though the butterflies were doing their best to support the chaos theory inside his stomach. “When’s the special day?”

Her eyes locked on him, but for a moment she said nothing, as though she was preparing herself for an angry reaction.

Then she said quietly, “Tomorrow night.”

It did make his heart miss a few beats, he had to admit as sheer terror gripped him, though he managed to downplay his reaction, and offer her up a warm smile. God, it didn’t help that she looked unbelievably gorgeous, her hair still wet from a post-gym shower, her full breasts barely contained by a bra-less pale pink cotton camisole that plunged so low in the front it almost left her hard nipples uncovered, while below her waist she wore only a pair of skin-tight white leggings.

“Fantastic,” he said, and loved that her face instantly brightened. “Where are you taking him?”

“He’s picking me up after work,” she said, her sudden cheery tone feeling like daggers in Hugo’s chest, though he was happy for her as well.

He wasn’t so keen that he wouldn’t get to see her before her date.

She draped herself over him and kissed him, and in two blinks of an eye they were all over each other, hands holding each other’s heads so they could suck on lips and tongue with intense vigor, the passion running white-hot between them as though they needed to prove their bond for each other.

Hugo felt her pressing her body against him, feeling his swollen hardness through their clothing, moaning as she rubbed herself on it, confirming how turned on he was by the news of her date.

But as he slipped her breasts out to begin teasing her straining nipples, Madeleine stopped him.

Breathless, she said, “No, we shouldn’t. I need to save myself for my date.”

Hugo nodded, though he felt more than a little put out.

“You can wait, can’t you?” she asked him. “It’s just... I feel pretty nervous now, I’m not sure if I’m in the right mood for...”

He smiled. “You’re saving yourself for him,” he said. “I think that’s kinda sexy.”

He could stand to wait a night—the suspense was exquisite to him, the tension adding to his enjoyment of the whole deal.

There was hugging, there was kissing as they passed the rest of the evening together. Madeleine even found excuses to keep brushing her hand over his crotch to feel how surprisingly hard he was almost all evening. But that was as far as it went.

What wrecked Hugo’s sleep that night was when he opened the bathroom cabinet to get the toothpaste, only to find next to her birth control a little CVS paper bag containing a shockingly huge box of condoms.

Oh Jesus.

He nearly came on the spot.

Six

He knew little about Will—though they'd discussed so many things regarding Madeleine's search for a date, as soon as she'd decided to place a man on her shortlist, she had stopped talking much about him to Hugo, other than the odd tidbit from their email flirtation.

In fact, over the days and weeks she'd spoken more about two other guys from her shortlist—one called Barnaby, and one named Jonathan—as she'd found them both intensely attractive but also frustrating.

Will had been the safe choice, which is why he was the most obvious for her date, but now that she'd confirmed it, Hugo could hardly remember any details about the guy. He was a schoolteacher from Brooklyn, he thought, and clearly fit with Madeleine's apparent ideal of a relatively athletic guy with dark hair and a handsome face. Not much like Hugo's appearance, but her need for clear difference was interesting.

He actually awoke relatively early for a Saturday—since Madeleine was buzzing around getting ready for work.

The thing was, she wasn't just getting ready for work. She was holding up tiny little dresses in front of the mirror, wearing only the little pair of white panties she'd slept in, which didn't help Hugo to keep his morning glory down.

Seeing him awake, she said, "Oh good, you can help. Which one do you think? This one...or this one?"

She showed him two equally daring dresses up against her body, still on hangers. She'd look incredible in either of them, he knew—these were not the type of things that old Madeleine from Boston would have ever been caught dead wearing.

Knowing she wasn't after flattery but a straightforward decision, since she couldn't make one herself, he picked the little charcoal dress

that looked to be made of thinner material.

“You’re going to wear this to work?” he teased her.

“No—I did tell you Will’s picking me up straight after my shift, didn’t I?”

Of course he knew that, but he hadn’t really put two and two together to realize she would have to effectively prepare for her date prior to the start of her Saturday shift at the bookstore.

“You’ll be able to change at the store?”

“It has a bathroom, you know.”

Lying there in bed, he actually enjoyed watching her preparing herself for a liaison with another man. There was something so immensely wrong about it, yet it was quite a thrill. And asking him his opinion on a dress was not to be his only participation.

“Here,” she said, handing him a sleek white plastic object that looked like part of an electric toothbrush.

“What’s this?” he said, feeling a little clueless.

Then he caught sight of the end of the device, and it was clear this was some kind of electric razor. Hugo caught his breath for the umpteenth time.

“Well, I guess girls are doing it this way nowadays,” Madeleine was blushing gently as he took the shaver from her. “I mean, we’ve seen them across the street, right?”

“You want me to...” he prompted her, feeling a hot flush of shock and uncertainty mixed with more than a little arousal.

She gave a shy smile as she climbed onto the bed beside him. “Well, I guess I never did it for you, but...”

The irony was not lost on Hugo that she’d never done this for her husband, but now she was set to play with another man, she was going to change herself for him. There was another little ripple of jealousy inside him, but Hugo felt a curious arousal, his loins tingling at the prospect of

seeing this different side of Madeleine, a sexy side, wanton with a smooth shaven pussy.

Madeleine made herself comfortable on the bed, allowing Hugo space to kneel in front of her.

As he switched on the shaver, which buzzed noisily, his gaze locked with hers, and he caught a look of nerves and excitement in her eyes—as though this wasn't merely about changing the age-old look of her pubic region, it was about making a commitment to the idea of offering herself up to another man.

Hugo had to shift slightly to ensure he was comfortable, the way his hardness now crowded his boxers.

“Okay?” he asked her softly, and she gave a little nod.

“Be careful,” she said, and it felt as though under the surface, she was asking him if this was really okay, if he was happy to do this, to prepare her in this way for another man.

“I will,” he said.

He placed the vibrating blade end of the shaver gently down to the edge of Madeleine's pubic hair, and then the buzzing noise changed pitch as he drew it into her thatch to begin shaving. The little space-age gizmo was surprisingly effective, so much so that it almost felt to him as though he was merely washing her mound, rather than cutting away the silky fuzz.

He shaved down to her pussy lips very gently, his fingers carefully stretching her soft skin this way or that to ensure a close shave. Initially, he left her a small landing strip of hair, giving her that last veto in case she wanted some remnant of her past self to stay.

But as he looked up at her, seeing that she was watching his every move, she gave a sharp little nod of the head, and off came that last patch of down.

Jesus.

He worked to remove as much of the traces of her hair as possible with that little gadget, his fingers trailing all over her sensitive folds to facilitate it. He noticed the way her lips began to glisten, the moisture emerging to show that this experience was turning Madeleine on as well as her husband.

At first, he tried to resist the temptation, and focus diligently on his task at hand, but as he began to detect the scent of her arousal, and with the strangeness of her completely bare mound so startling before him, it was increasingly difficult to act like a professional beautician.

He leaned forward and planted a soft little kiss just beside her pussy, breathing in that darkly wonderful aroma of her sex.

Madeleine let out a soft moan.

He ran his fingers along her tender folds, tracing the moisture and confirming just how wet she was getting from this unusual process of having her husband shave her pussy.

Then he ran his tongue along her slit, slowly, coursing through her sensitive flesh to soak up the tart flavor of her juices and draw out a long, exhilarating groan from the freshly shaven blonde.

She was so beautiful. He wanted to worship her. He wanted all men to worship her.

In that moment, jealousy suddenly seemed like an emotion that he was done with, over. He wanted others to come and bow down before this goddess, and pleasure her as she deserved.

Hugo began kissing around the strange new topography of her pussy and mound, but she stopped him.

“We’re not done yet,” she said.

There were a few stray hairs here and there, and perhaps a hint of stubble he’d missed. It was clear as she led him to the bathroom that Madeleine wanted to be perfect for her prospective new lover.

She had him strip off and join her under the wonderful warmth of the shower, had him soaping her up, rinsing her down, running his hands

all over her slippery skin. And she had him take the razor to make doubly sure she was perfectly smooth down there, between her thighs.

She showed him how to do it, though he couldn't remember her doing it even during their dating days. She'd always been tidy down there, but not shaven. Had she shaved for guys before him?

"Is it strange?" she asked him. "Doing all this, and it's not for you?"

All he had to do was show her how hard he was, and she simply grinned, loving the affect she was having on him.

"If it means you'll actually have a good time tonight, I don't mind," he said. "It's kind of hot that you want to do this for your date, but you never did it for me."

She wrinkled her brow. "Hot? How?"

He ran his tongue along the length of her bare pussy, unable to resist. She moaned in response, but he looked up and she clearly wanted an answer.

"Because it proves you're trying new things, I guess," he said. "And it suggests you really do intend to go through with it this time."

He shivered, and she saw him shiver, even with the hot water coursing all over him—that made her giggle.

"You know how much I love you?" she said. "I'm not sure I'll ever entirely understand you, but from the moment I knew you were serious about this, and it wasn't going to hurt you, I haven't stopped thinking about what it would be like."

"Good. Me neither."

"But you know I don't need this, don't you? Any of it. All I need is you. That's not to say I don't want this. But I don't need it."

"I know. I don't need it to happen, either. But I want you to experience it."

His rock-hard, throbbing, pulsating erection confirmed him to be telling the truth, and she couldn't help but hold it in her hands, looking at

him all wide-eyed at just how big he was in response to the thought of her actually having sex with another man.

“You’re amazing, you know that?” was all she said, and he didn’t know what to say to that.

Such a sensual delight to shave her, when it was all over he just wanted to throw her on the bed and devour her. Only, when she stepped out of the shower, her skin all pink from the scalding water, glistening with that lotion she used to use when they were dating, because it made her skin so fresh and sexy, she told him not to touch.

“I can’t be all wet and bothered when I have to put in a shift at the bookstore all day,” she said.

“Of course.”

“And anyway, this is not for you,” she added, with a touch of mischievous spite, her eyes flickering over his face, his reaction, the massively hard erection. Intrigued, surprised, aroused.

“Why don’t you pick something out for me?” she asked him, picking up the hairdryer.

His hands were shaking a little as he went to her underwear drawer, drew it open, his eyes tumbling into the chaos of lacy, silky, dangerous lingerie. When did there become so much of it? He swore he’d never seen half of this stuff.

He got the very real sense that in all this, after all these weeks and months of playing around with The Fantasy, his wife had actually been steadily preparing herself to start dating again for real, despite her apparent caution and initial reluctance.

Confused by the array of sexy underwear on offer, he looked up, back. The hum of the hairdryer ceased to leave brutal quiet, Madeleine brushing that magnificent golden cascade that poured down her back, sparkling clean and ready for another man’s hands.

“Maybe the black ones?” she suggested, and Hugo realized he’d just been standing there, baffled. Then, a beat more and she was explaining,

“The seamed stockings? I think fishnets may be too much for a first date.”

For Hugo, the stockings suddenly seemed too much. The lace of the bra, the ludicrous inefficiency of the garter belt, which seemed like the most archaic thing, and yet it made his blood pump four times as fast. And God, they had just shaved her pussy. For a first date! Her correspondence with this guy Will must have given her much more confidence than she'd had with her first online date.

Hugo laid out the stockings on the bed while she sat at her dresser to apply her make up.

“Panties?” she smiled through the mirror, and he looked at her, surprised that he could forget such a thing. “You do want me to wear some for him?”

Giving him that look of wonder, intrigue, mild shock, that this was really happening. That he was helping pick out her underwear for sex with someone else.

“Yeah,” he said, though a big part of him liked the idea of his wife going on her date without any panties. So naughty, so dangerous.

Thumbing through her lingerie again while she applied her make-up—relatively conservative for work other than the bright scarlet lipstick—the kind of lipstick a girl would only wear because it looked good sliding up and down a man's hard cock.

Hugo held up the most breath-taking wisp of see-through black mesh, initially not even recognizing it as actual underwear.

“Perfect,” he heard her say, and the choice was made before he even knew what he was holding. The filthiest see-through thong he'd ever laid eyes on, something she had never even worn for him.

Then she was standing before him, asking him for help putting it on—as though she needed it. The sight of her perfectly shaved sex, right there in front of him, making him swoon a little.

Trembling as he helped connect up the clasps, rapturous as he helped her step into the sheer, near-invisible thong, his heart hiccuping painfully as he grasped the significance of her wearing her panties over the top of the garter belt and suspenders.

Shocking, the complete loss of control he felt.

“You don’t mind?”

“Huh?”

“Me wearing this?”

“No, of course. You look incredible,” he breathed, and she was giving him the kind of surprised smile that said she noticed this complement was not the usual kind of automated husband response to a wife’s inquiry. It was entirely unsolicited and unthought out—a gut reaction, pure, credible.

“Thank you,” she said, flashing him the full-on flirt that caused his heart bounce—she hadn’t shared that with him since the very early days.

And then he realized she was only really practicing it, trying it out before she put it on display for someone else, for real.

Wriggling into her dress to show him how the complete ensemble would look, she’d left the bra forlorn on the bed. His thoughts did not dwell on the question of whether or not she’d look obvious without a bra on her date: his eyes were drawn to that thong in the moments before she just about covered it with her dress. God, it was so tiny. He knew it would slip aside so easily. When did she buy that?

“Zip me up?” she asked, voice light, bouncy, high-pitched. Flirty.

He obliged, though he really would have preferred to just tear that dress off her. Holding aside her silky-soft golden hair to guide the fiddly little zip all the way up her back, breathing in the kind of cherry-vanilla perfume that would draw any man into a whirling fever of lust.

“What do you think?” she asked.

This time it was his turn to look wide-eyed at her, his jaw dropping. He said, “Unbelievable.”

She beamed. Still naked from their shower, he could hardly hide his powerful attraction to her and this ridiculously short figure-hugging dress, which somehow seemed to enhance her curves, show off her cleavage and draw the eyes down to her beautiful thighs, so short they revealed the edges of her lace-topped stockings.

“You did want to have dinner with the guy?” he asked her.

“Yes.”

“Because I’m not sure he’s going to get through the appetizers with you looking like that—he’ll probably want to take you back to his place before they even bring out the entrees.”

“Well, he’ll just have to be patient. I am hungry, and appetizers just aren’t going to cut it.”

With that, she turned away and started removing her dress, then putting on a skirt for work that was not much longer than her dress, along with a white blouse that offered a more than subtle hint that she was wearing a sexy lace bra underneath.

“Too much?” she asked him, as she modeled the outfit for him.

“I wouldn’t say that,” he smiled, loving the idea that she would be driving her co-workers crazy all day. Would they ask her if she had a date that evening? Hugo might have inside knowledge, but it looked as though she had something special lined up for the evening

She grinned, loving his reaction to all this.

“You know, I guess I felt a little cheap when I started wearing tighter, shorter clothes—I just couldn’t get enough of how guys looked at me. But now...I don’t mind it so much. It feels...liberating.”

Hugo chuckled, “Well don’t feel too liberated until your shift’s over—those poor guys you work with have things they have to get done, you know.”

And then she was heading out the door, saying goodbye to her husband with an air kiss by his cheek, and it all seemed so sudden to him

despite the extensive time it had taken that morning to prepare her for her evening date.

“Just remember that I love you, and I’ll always love you,” she said, as though she was going away on a long, long journey.

The door closed with a brutal clunk, leaving silence, emptiness, cold.

He was in a daze as he wondered, naked, back to the bedroom. Holding his breath as he went into the bathroom to find that little CVS bag in the medical cabinet.

He nearly came when he saw that she’d removed three condoms from that big purple box.

Seven

He settled himself, at last, with the thought that she wasn't going on her date just yet. She was working an entire shift at the bookstore first. It didn't stop the apprehension, the nerves, making his hands all clammy and his stomach churn so much that lunch was a write-off. Yet it kept him from becoming the gibbering wreck he'd been immediately after she'd left for work wearing that insane version of business chic.

It was difficult not to keep reminding himself that somewhere out there in New York was a guy waiting to take Madeleine out for dinner, and then sleep with her. When his thoughts started turning in that direction, he either had to wait a moment and ride out the wave of fear and excitement, or find some quick distraction.

He had a rare day to himself lined up, and to start with that was a daunting prospect. He could probably have called Lowego or Davis—or even Ray of all people—to see what they were doing, to see if they wanted to hang out, during the day or in the evening. But he felt safer to keep on his own, he didn't want any secrets slipping out because his emotions were raw.

He went out to traipse around the record store on E 3rd Street, Hospital Productions, even though he could shop for music or DVDs perfectly well at home.

He went to the gym again, a little forceful exercise taking his mind off things until Madeleine's personal trainer came in with a young redhead. Hugo's mind right back on the fact that Madeleine could very well be engaging in such intimacy that night, and more.

A light lunch from the deli across the street from the gym had to be abandoned because of the mild nausea he felt, but then he was back at

the apartment building in the early afternoon with no plans to take him through to the evening, let alone night.

*

When five o'clock arrived, Hugo only had to look at the clock, and he found himself getting hard, that tingling sensation blossoming inside him, along with a chilling sense of fear that raised the hairs on the back of his neck.

Madeleine's date would be picking her up from the bookstore around now.

He felt so much more extreme than he had on that first date. Maybe that first time, she'd cried wolf on so many occasions he never actually believed she'd go through with anything on her date.

No, this time there really was more chance she'd go that step further with her potential new man. She'd been searching for this guy for weeks, carefully and diligently, as though it was some multi-billion dollar acquisition she was considering for her corporation.

Five minutes past five, Hugo's phone buzzed with a text message from her.

> Hey sweetie.

Hugo smiled, pleased she was thinking to text him at such a time. He dumped himself down on the couch, typed her a reply, which had to be suitably vague and relaxed so that he didn't sound either frightened, over-excited or in any way controlling.

> Hey hon, you all set?

Her reply came back almost instantly.

> All dressed up! Have my coat on so my co-workers can't see what I'm wearing, in case my date comes into the store to pick me up.

He couldn't help but picture her in that tiny dress, and delight in the knowledge of what kind of skimpy little sheer lingerie she was wearing

underneath.

> He running late?

> A few minutes. Traffic's pretty bad. How you doing?

> Pretty good—chilling at home.

> Feeling okay about this?

> Excited. A little nervous, but mainly excited. Hope this one works out for you :-) How you feeling?

> Nervous, I guess. Fabian just asked if he should turn up the heat a little, he saw me shivering.

> You're going to have a great time.

> Yes, I will. You know I love you, sweetie?

> I know. And you know I love you, nothing will change that, ever. I just want you to have some fun tonight. Maybe you'll come away with a friend with benefits, maybe not.

> I still think you're crazy. But I can't help but love it ;-)

Hugo chuckled. Then suddenly, she sent another text:

> He's here. Lv u

Just a quick text, urgent, no time for more. Hugo felt a powerful jolt of energy swamp his chest for a moment. It was now a familiar feeling—but its power did not diminish.

Madeleine was on a date.

*

The waiting during the date felt familiar too, though that only made it feel a little easier. He knew what to expect at least. Madeleine had taken him on a wild ride to get to this point, but he felt hugely grateful to her that she'd explored this fantasy so methodically.

He watched TV for a while, but found his thoughts veering off almost immediately after he started. He ordered a pizza, poured himself a beer. The beer made him feel a little better, the pizza did not.

It was very difficult to settle down when your beloved wife was out at a restaurant with another guy, working out whether she wanted to fuck him.

After an hour, he was finding little ways to distract his attention—streaming a new TV show from Netflix forced him to concentrate in order to get into the new characters, for example. He got his laptop out to surf the net, replying to a few emails, tapping out a little work stuff, even taking a look at some vacation ideas for the next summer.

It didn't stop his mind flicking back to the evening's events, though. Imagining them in the restaurant, gazing into each other's eyes, Madeleine's date, Will, staring down her top at her cleavage. Madeleine getting up to go to the restroom, showing him those stunning legs of hers.

Madeleine sitting there flirting with her date with her pussy all shaved and ready for him.

Ten o'clock swung by. It wasn't late for an evening, but Hugo was painfully aware that his beautiful wife had now spent nearly five hours on her date. A fortieth glance at the clock confirmed the time once again, but he could only groan. Well, he could hardly expect her to keep him updated all the way through the date.

He did regret not being able to watch it, though. To see the light in Madeleine's eyes as she flirted with him. The thrill in her face that she was being desired by this man in front of her, appreciated for her charms and her good looks by someone who wasn't obligated by marriage to offer her complements.

Five hours—they had to be finished with dinner by now. If you weren't rushing dinner, it could go on two, maybe three hours. Not five. Were they at a bar, Madeleine taking a little Dutch courage so that she might do more than just flirt with him?

At half past ten, Hugo's phone rang. He dived for it.

"Hey, Hugo!"

Lucy.

For a second—just a second—Hugo felt frustrated that it wasn't Madeleine on the line. He even felt a little irritated—that Lucy had chosen to call at this moment, that she was perhaps checking up on them, and what they were doing.

"Hey Luce. She's not here right now, you want me to pass on a message?"

"Oh no, I wanted to speak with you, actually."

Suddenly, all feelings of annoyance melted away. God, he needed someone to talk to.

"How can I help?" he said.

"Actually, I think it's supposed to be me helping you."

"Helping me? I don't think anyone can help me," Hugo chuckled, sitting down in the window seat now, gazing out of the blind as he spoke to Lucy.

"How are you feeling?" she said. "Really."

"Really? Well, it's strange. Knowing that she's out there somewhere, having fun with a guy she might sleep with."

"Must be beyond weird. I can't say I really understand why you want her to do it—I'm not saying I don't love the concept, from a woman's point of view but... well. You'll have to explain it sometime."

"It's complicated."

"I guess it must be hot to have a sexy wife that other guys want to get with."

"Something like that."

"So you're hoping she'll actually do it tonight?"

Hugo felt his heart thumping at what Lucy was saying. Did she have the inside track on what Madeleine was planning to do this evening?

"I don't know," he said. "I guess I'm of two minds. I do kind of want her to do it, so she has this experience, so we can fulfill this fantasy after so many months of thinking about it. But... I don't know... when I

first started wanting this to happen, I kind of pictured being there. I kind of want to see it—at least the first time.”

“You want to see it? You mean watch her with another guy?”

Hugo realized this fantasy relied on the date approving the presence of the husband, and also that the presence of a third person would affect the dynamics of the relationship drastically.

“I know having a husband in tow isn’t exactly going to make a date as hot for her, though,” he said. “So I guess I just have to deal with her doing it all somewhere out of sight, and hoping that she’ll tell me all about it afterwards.”

“You ever tell her you want a threesome some time?”

“I’m not sure it’s quite as simple as that,” he said. “I guess it’s difficult to explain—but the sex is just part of this. I mean, I don’t want her to fall in love with someone else, but I don’t really want her just going out, banging some random guy and then coming back home, either.”

“What do you want?”

“Well, ideally, I guess I want someone worthwhile to date her—you know, flirt with her, ask her out, take her to dinner, get to know her. Then gradually work up to the point where they’ll sleep together.”

Lucy drew in her breath. “And you’re not worried she’s going to fall for a guy like that?”

“I know that’s the risk. I suppose that’s my big fear in all this, other than the obvious one about her safety. But I just... I don’t know. I guess you think of the whole idea of swinging, and it just seems so tacky.”

“It does come across as kind of tacky.”

“I want it to be more special than that for Madeleine. You know, have her whisked off her feet, charmed, seduced, dazzled.”

“You know, you surprise me more and more every day, Hugo.”

“I just want other guys to really appreciate her, how special she is. And for her to feel adored, to have a guy really work to get her in bed, so

she really feels valued—and when she does have sex, it’s the most incredible thing.”

Hugo heard their Maid of Honor sigh on the other end of the line.

“Jesus, I have to get married,” she said after a pause where she was apparently collecting herself. “I have to get married now, and I have to get married to a man like you, Hugo Finnell.”

Hugo laughed. “Sounds like you need to start using that dating site Madeleine found.”

“It’s that or Craigslist,” Lucy said. “Seriously, though. You’re okay? You know you can always talk to me about any of this stuff, right?”

“Right.”

“And if you want to stop Maddie without hurting her feelings, because you’ve decided actually it’s not right for you—you know I can help you?”

“Thanks, Luce.”

“For the record, and I hope this doesn’t spoil anything for you, I don’t think she’s going to go all the way tonight.”

“She told you?”

“She said if the guy was really right, she wanted to take things slowly. She might go a little further than flirting, but I think she wants the same kind of experience that you want for her—you know, not just a quick in and out.”

“But she is planning on, you know... if the guy lets her take it slowly?”

“Going the whole way? Sure. If everything’s right, and you’re still okay with all this.”

“Oh, well,” he said. He felt relieved knowing Madeleine was going to take her time and really enjoy dating again, yet part of him worried that she wouldn’t end up going the whole way ever. “I guess that’s for the best,” he added.

“Of course, I could be wrong,” Lucy said. “I mean, every time she talks about him, she wants to jump his bones. Maybe she won’t be able to hold back.”

“Maybe.”

“Anyway. Call me, Hugo. If you need—even if you don’t.”

“I will.”

“And I just want to say again, I think what you’re doing is amazing.”

Hugo did actually feel better after Lucy’s call. Something about it reassured him that Madeleine’s date was not going to be something cheap and tacky, it would lead to a meaningful experience—whether she felt the need to jump his bones or take the slow seduction route.

He figured that if she came back and she’d done the deed, it would be exciting. If she came back and it transpired she would be taking things slowly with her date, starting with a second date, perhaps, then that would probably be the best.

One thing he did regret, though, was that he’d failed to find out from Lucy what Madeleine’s “dark secret” was. Would she ever tell him?

Eight

By midnight, the date clock ticking on past seven hours, Hugo had been quietly hopeful that the length of Madeleine's date meant at least she was enjoying herself, wherever she was.

Then she sent him a text:

> On my way home!

From a state of very close to relaxation, Hugo's heart suddenly picked up the pace. What had happened on her date? He was so desperate to know.

He sent her a reply:

> Fantastic—can't wait until you get home—did you have a good time?

Her reply sent shockwaves and butterflies and fireworks through his entire body.

> Wonderful! Had such a great time, going to see him again next week!

He didn't want to ask her via text messages how far she'd gone on her wonderful date, somehow that seemed tacky. Instead, he texted back:

> Hope you're in the mood to tell me all about it! Hurry home!
Love you honey xx

He was waiting for her perched on the back of the couch, arms folded, looking stern when she came in.

She looked absolutely stunning. Slipping off her long gray coat, Hugo was startled all over again with brevity of her dress.

"Hey," she said, looking at him with more than a hint of uncertainty in her eyes.

Was he angry with her? He could see the question imprinted on her face as she approached him like some kind of penitent sinner seeking

absolution.

God, she looked incredible. Had she reapplied her make-up on the way home? There seemed to be a very faint hint of old lipstick smeared around her mouth, which she'd very nearly removed totally, yet a clue remained as to her misdeeds.

Hugo felt himself bristling up, yet warm arousal was blossoming inside him at the same time, his manhood thickening.

She gazed into his eyes, trying to read him. Faintly afraid.

She stepped up to him, a couple of feet away. He could breathe in her sweet fragrance. Tilted her head demurely, gently apologetic yet unsure quite what it was about her evening's behavior that had apparently displeased her husband.

Hugo maintained his stern expression, just a few moments too long to be taken seriously. He was smiling inside at offering her a brief taste of the kind of role-play that she had duped him with so many times that year. But he was too horny and too curious to maintain the act of an offended husband who has discovered his wife's affair.

"You've been a naughty girl, haven't you?" he said.

Her intent stare shifted subtly from one of uncertainty and fear into wicked lustful excitement as she understood his game.

"I couldn't help it," she said, trying to conceal her smile. "He was just so nice, so charming."

Hugo nodded sagely. He said: "How far did you go with him?"

She said, "I kissed him."

"Did you enjoy it? Did you have... chemistry with him?"

"Yes, and yes. A whole lot of chemistry."

Hugo felt his heart leap at that, at the barely-concealed exhilaration in her expression as she mentioned her chemistry with this other man.

"You were with him a very long time," he said. "Are you sure you only kissed him?"

Flames were flickering in her dark eyes. “I kissed him, he kissed me, we kissed,” she spoke slowly, and he watched her lips as she formed the words, in awe that she had actually made out with another man.

He knew she was telling the truth this time. He could feel it.

“He walked me home,” she said, and he regretted not being able to see the date escort her back to this building, see who he was, whether he was worthy. “It took a while to get here. We kept stopping in doorways.”

“Stopping in doorways? Why?”

“Because we couldn’t keep our hands off each other.”

Hugo felt so strange. He felt as though his chest cavity contained nothing but a carousel, one of the bright rowdy fairground varieties with flashing lights and horses rising and falling as the whole thing revolved. This was exactly what he wanted, wasn’t it? For Madeleine to have a blazing love affair that made her so passionate she couldn’t keep herself apart from her lover, one that lifted her up and turned her into a great beacon of energy.

“You were kissing him in these doorways?”

“Kissing, holding, pressing myself to him.”

“Show me.”

He loved the burning desire in her eyes—the fact that she appeared to want her husband as much as the lover of which she spoke, the fact that Hugo was driving her crazy. Was she grateful to him for having this fantasy? There was that sense blended in with her desire—the feeling that she wanted to reward him for having a kink, a fetish about her sexual liberation.

She paused briefly, as though recalling her doorway liaisons. Then she grabbed him by the collar of his shirt, surprising him with her strength and assertiveness, pulling him to her, her mouth closing against his, her lips crushing his, sucking them as her hands slipped up to cradle his head.

Hands falling naturally to her waist, he wondered at the soft heat of her mouth, the sweetness of her lips, the ferocity of her kiss. She tasted of sweet liquor, accented by the unmistakable bitterness of tobacco smoke. It almost made it feel as though he was kissing another woman—emphasizing to Hugo that Madeleine had been experiencing a different life, albeit for one night only.

“He was a good kisser?” Hugo breathed as they parted, holding her firmly, his hands just above her hips, locking her there standing between his thighs.

“He was. Not so good as you, but he made me feel all... melty inside.”

“Melty,” Hugo nodded.

She pulled him to her again, kissing him, seeking his reassurance that he still wanted her, still needed her, still loved her even though these lips had been courting another.

He stood up, continuing their kiss, his hand reaching around her head, feeling her silky hair, holding her against him as he sucked on her lips, her tongue, pressing his nose against hers.

“Was he annoyed that you didn’t let him do anything more than kiss you in doorways?” Hugo asked her.

“No,” she said. “He asked me for another date, though.”

Hugo looked up at her. “I thought the guy was supposed to wait a day or two before he asked you something like that?”

Madeleine shrugged, “It is the 21st Century now, sweetie.”

He nodded, then kissed his way down her neck, adoring her heat, her velvet skin, the fragrance she’d reapplied on her way up in the elevator. Then he was kissing down her chest, pushing his face into her cleavage, shoving down her dress to reveal that black sheer bra.

“Are you disappointed?” he asked her. “You bought fancy underwear for him... you shaved your pussy.”

She said, “I bought that for you. I shaved for you.”

“For me?”

“Lucy pointed out a few websites about your...condition.”

“My condition?”

“It said guys like you enjoy preparing their wives for dates, having the idea that their wives are dressing up in fancy underwear, making themselves all sexy and slutty for another guy.”

“Right. I suppose it was quite exciting getting you ready.”

“You loved it. And I just loved getting you going like that. Having such power over you. I guess I get that from all of this...”

He slid her dress down over her hips now, letting it fall the rest of the way to the floor, leaving his beautiful wife standing there in sheer black panties and her bra, which allowed him to see her nipples and her smooth shaven slit.

Then she was pulling away from him, unfastening the buttons on his shirt, kissing and licking his chest, breathing in his scent.

“So you have a second date all lined up?” he asked her.

“We do, yes,” she smiled, then stood up, turned her back to him, letting him run his hands all over her half-naked body, feeling those glorious curves, her smooth soft skin. She was leaning back into him as he touched her, pressing her behind against his hardness, feeling how turned on he was, her stance almost reminiscent of a lap dance.

“And?” he said, cupping her breasts and slipping his chin over her shoulder to kiss her mouth. “What will you guys be doing together on the second date?”

She smiled as she sucked on his lips again, tilting her hips this way and that to rub his hard cock against her body, loving how aroused he was by her.

“He wants to take me to the symphony on our second date,” she said, then she dropped down, turning to face him, and crouching there, began unfastening his belt, obviously craving his weapon of choice since she’d apparently had no access to that of her date.

“The symphony, huh? Very cultured.”

“Isn’t he? They’re doing the New World Symphony at the Met and you know how much I love that one. Some of his friends are performing.”

“Sounds wonderful.”

“Yes, I thought so.”

He loved the way her face brightened when she’d eventually pulled apart his belt, opened his fly and dragged his pants down his thighs to reveal his big hard cock poised and ready for her.

“He sounds like a catch,” he said, sighing as her fingers closed around his girth, and she took his tip into her hot mouth. “You think you might be tempted to go beyond a few kisses next time?”

She grinned, even with her mouth full of his manhood. “I hope so,” she said. He shuddered in her mouth, and she felt it. It seemed to drive her on, her head sinking down on his shaft, taking him in so incredibly deep.

He stroked her cheek as she withdrew his length and started licking him.

“Tell me what happened,” he said. “You went for dinner with him?”

“Yes,” she said between long licks along the underside of his erection. “He took me to Toscana.”

“Expensive.”

“He was paying,” she grinned, took him into her mouth briefly again, all the while Hugo stroking her hair. “It was just nice. I relaxed with him. We had some Chianti and just talked and talked.”

A few more bobs down on his cock, as though she couldn’t resist him, couldn’t get enough of this thing. Then she was licking him again, his shaft glistening with moisture already in the low light of the table lamps.

“I guess we had a load of food—I don’t know, pasta, salad, meat, veggies—it just came in little bursts as a distraction while we talked,”

she said. “We really took our time, got to know each other.”

“He’s an interesting guy?” Hugo asked, leaning forward to slip the straps of her bra off her shoulders.

She reached behind to flick the catch, freeing her exquisite breasts from captivity so that he could fondle them while she sucked his cock. Her nipples really were rock hard.

Continuing to pump his length with her hands, she said: “His family comes from old money. I guess he wouldn’t need to work at all, but he’s already done so much...”

Hugo was impressed at how his wife was pitching this guy to him. She was obviously quite taken with him, which was remarkable enough after a single date, considering what happened on her first date. His jealousy flickered on, growing intense as he watched her speak of her date’s clever little business start-ups, which he seemed to get going only to sell off once he started getting bored. Was he the same with women—lacking long-term commitment? Somehow that made Hugo feel easier about this.

He leaned forward to kiss her now, tasting the faint hint of himself on her lips, which made him wonder whether he would handle kissing these beautifully soft lips once they’d stretched around another man’s cock.

Their tongues tangoed, Madeleine really exploring his kiss—still comparing him to her date, perhaps.

“Does he often date married women?” he asked, urging her up now.

“I was his first.”

He peeled her panties down over the sweet roundness of her peachy behind, and supporting herself on the back of the couch, pushing out her butt, she allowed her underwear to fall to the ground, leaving her naked other than her high-heeled shoes.

“You told him I approved of this date?”

“No,” she said.

He caressed her back, kissed her shoulder, in awe at the effect her curves had on him. She turned to kiss him again, standing, her back to his chest so that his hands could sweep over her breasts, and down her stomach to her mound.

He couldn't help but let out a little gasp as his fingers brushed over her smooth pussy. Reminded that she had shaved her sex completely, for the first time while she'd been with Hugo. Shaved for her date.

She was seriously wet. Hugo found that his mouth was watering.

"I guess he found it quite fascinating that I was stepping out on my marriage," she said, turning, following his prompt to perch on the back of the sofa.

He kissed her breast, sucked in one of her bullet-like nipples.

"I didn't tell him that you wanted me to date him," she said, a broad smile breaking out on her face as her husband sank to his knees, his face hovering between her thighs, appreciating the perfection of her hairless sex. "But I didn't lie, either."

"Selective editing," he smiled, and closed his eyes as he inhaled her darkly thrilling scent.

"I told him we have a passionate relationship, that I've never stopped being madly in love with you, that nothing would ever threaten that," she said, then moaned as he licked her wet groove, slowly coursing the tip up her sweet valley up to her clit.

"He was okay about that?"

"Oh, yes. He's not looking for a relationship. I told him I was only after a little fun—you know, that I had the urge to feel the thrill of dating again after so many years. He seemed of similar mind—he's not married, but he's not aiming to settle with anyone."

She moaned as he held her hips, fluttered his tongue lightly over her clit, loving the feeling of her smooth shaven pussy against his face, the aroma of her arousal, the tangy flavor of her nectar.

"Oh God..."

He prompted her: “So when dinner was done...”

She drew in her breath as he penetrated her with a stiffened tongue, pushing his face into her, delving as deeply as he could in her succulent womanhood.

“We went to a bar a few streets over,” she panted as he fucked her with his face, one hand on his head. “I didn’t see what it was called—it was one of those places that’s just a door on a street, secret, for people in the know only.”

Her whole body was heaving as he now lapped at her folds, stroking her with his tongue, moaning gently to stir her with the vibrations of his voice as he sampled her syrup.

Thinking that perhaps some time soon, another man would be enjoying this sweet pussy, Hugo tickled his own jealousy to add that frisson of spice into the powerful lust he felt for his wife.

“You had a few drinks at this place?” he asked her.

“Oh fuck that feels amazing,” she breathed. Then she said: “For a while. I guess I felt pretty comfortable with him.”

“And I bet he was quite enchanted by you.”

She smiled. “Enough to drag me down to the dance floor,” she said.

“Really?” he said, urging her up now, no longer able to contain his powerful need for her.

She stood, obedient, hands placed on the back of the sofa, her beautiful behind presented for him. Hugo slid his full hardness between her cheeks, feeling the softness of her skin against his sensitive shaft, then he brushed the tip of his cock against her searing, slippery pussy lips.

“I know how you like to dance,” he said as he teased her.

She moaned, said: “He liked to dance, too. I could feel it.”

“You could feel him? He’s big?”

She nodded, biting her lip.

Hugo thrust forward, entered her. She was dripping wet, he glided straight in, filling her completely, forcing out a blissful cry as his swollen organ touched every part of her inside.

“He put his hands all over you?”

She nodded. “I let him.”

Hugo stroked her back as he fucked her tight pussy, loving the softness of her skin, the shape of her body, the heat of her flesh as she shivered and shook and gasped, this young doe he was reclaiming from another stag.

He leaned down, over her shoulder, his thrusting slowing as she twisted her head to kiss him, giving him a glimpse of her wild eyes.

She turned, and he gave her space to face him again, perch up on the back of the sofa, spreading her legs for him to step forward and glide back inside her glistening flower.

“He touched you here?” he asked her, breathless as he fucked her hard, his fingers brushing over her lips before he kissed her again briefly.

A slight nod, a wicked smile.

“And here?” his hands slid down to her breasts, cupping her, fondling her, squeezing her, his thumbs grazing over her stiff, sensitive nipples.

She nodded again. “Not on the dance floor. On the way home,” she said.

“In those doorways.”

“Yes.”

“And here?” he slipped a hand between her legs, his fingers finding her moisture even as he continued to thrust inside her, then pressing against her clit to spur her on to greater levels of ecstasy,

“No,” she said. “He didn’t touch me there.”

“Maybe next time?”

“Maybe next time.”

And with that, she shuddered, she almost convulsed as her orgasm hit, her pussy squeezing him, pushing him over the edge with her.

She was thinking about how another man might feel inside her, and seeing that in her eyes as he neared the end ignited a depth charge inside his chest.

Hugo let the wave of emotion and sensation consume him, feeling the raw jealousy give in to the feeling that he was taking this beautiful woman back, making her his own again.

But at the end, just after her climax blossomed, Hugo was pulling out of her, leaning back. A sudden hint of surprise passed through her face, but she allowed him to withdraw, stroking his head against her soaking, burning pussy for a few moments.

Then his whole body jarred, and with his hardness gripped tightly in both hands, he pumped his hot seed over her pussy, his sticky cream spurting up over her mound, her stomach, splashing over her flushed rosy lips, her beautiful shaven pussy.

Marking his territory.

Nine

Madeleine seemed to be walking on air the whole of the next week, and as a result, so was Hugo.

They slept most of Sunday, feeling almost jet-lagged, they were so off schedule because of a night of rampant sex spurred on from her first date with Will. That evening, she revealed that he'd texted her, confirming a date for the coming Wednesday night, which they'd agreed on since Madeleine had the Thursday off that week.

Only five days after their first date, it felt too soon to Hugo to be having a second date, though he could tell Madeleine was itching to see her new boyfriend again.

That night they were too tired to even really talk about her first date. On Monday night, Hugo came home to find Madeleine sitting on the window seat, peering into her cell phone, one hand quietly tucked under her skirt.

"Are you texting him?" he said to her, feeling the tickle of jealousy and the warmth of arousal stirring inside him.

"Maybe," she said, pulling her hand away.

He smiled. "Don't stop on my account."

The blinds were open, and Hugo could see across the street, though the more interesting windows were dark—even the college students' place.

"Oh, he's finished," she said, dropping the cell phone by her side on the window seat.

As ever, she looked dazzlingly beautiful, sitting in the window with her knees drawn up under her chin, her hair tied up in a ponytail that allowed rogue strands of gold to hang down the side of her pretty face.

A light went on across the street, and Hugo saw that it was in Connor's apartment. Madeleine's eyes seemed to light up—well, her crush was still firmly in place, then, even though she'd started dating another man. But then, no doubt she still reacted physically to Fabian or Ryan or Dan or any of her flirty authors, that wasn't going to stop just because she'd found a new lover.

"Does he still come into the store sometimes?" Hugo said, not needing to specify who he was talking about. "Does he still hit on you sometimes?"

"Yeah, he does," she said with a faintly dreamy tone of voice.

"You still want him, don't you?"

"Of course," she said. Her hand drifted back between her thighs as they watched him walk into his bedroom.

"Well, maybe one day the opportunity will present itself."

She stood up, smiled, reached to kiss him. Her lips were so soft as they touched his—appreciating him, and his tolerance of her urges for other men, though perhaps her urges were in part due to his encouragement.

"Did you have a good day, sweetie?" she asked him.

"Sure."

"Want to make it a great day?"

"Absolutely."

She reached under her skirt, and a moment later her panties were falling over her thighs and down past her knees to the floor. Then she slowly turned to the windows, leaning forward, her hands on the glass, pushing up her rear for him.

"Fuck me," she said, but he was already there, lining up behind her, sliding inside her incredibly wet pussy as they watched her crush on the opposite side of the street now strip off his shirt and his pants, turning away from them to the room's built-in wardrobe before his underwear came down.

Afterward, they were lying in bed together, and she said, “Lucy said you were suffering a little, while I was out on my date.”

Hugo sighed, fearing that Lucy was now talking Madeleine out of this whole thing, their Maid of Honor not entirely understanding where he was coming from in all this.

He said, “Waiting’s never easy. I wouldn’t exactly say I was suffering, though.”

The thing was, part of him was in full agreement with Lucy. Only, along with the suffering, waiting in the company of the thought that his pretty wife was having the time of her life was also excruciatingly pleasurable.

“Tell me what it was like, thinking of me being out on a date with another man.”

He gently stroked her breast, noting how her nipple pursed, hardened under his touch.

He said, “I guess it’s kind of scary. But also seriously hot.”

“Scary?”

“I was nervous, nervous that things wouldn’t work out, that you wouldn’t have a good time on your date. And maybe nervous that you wouldn’t come back at all.”

“Oh, you know I wouldn’t do that to you.”

He chuckled. “I know that, but the body isn’t always rational, you know? It depends on hormones that were never designed for this kind of fantasy.”

Her fingers found his cock, saw that it was stiffening up a little.

“I’m not sure I like the thought that I make you nervous when I’m out,” she said. She curled her hand around his shaft, appreciating its shape, its burgeoning thickness. Hugo noticed her breathing was deepening.

“It’s not just nerves—all that just makes it seem more exciting, somehow. It’s hard to explain. Like adding salt to your food—you

wouldn't want it all on its own, but when it's there with the thrill of knowing you're out enjoying yourself, feeling the buzz of a new relationship—then that slight sense of fear just enhances the flavor of everything else.”

“When you're waiting... you're frightened that I might actually do something with my date?”

“A little,” he admitted, then moaned quietly as she started to pump his shaft. “Only a little frightened—hopeful, mostly. I want to experience what it's like to know you've been naughty, you've given in to your desires, you've stepped over the line.”

“You're hopeful I'll be naughty?”

“Yes,” he said. “To start with, even thinking you're holding his hand, looking at him with that glint in your eye that says you'd quite like him to seduce you. Later, when you'd been out with him long enough, I start to hope you've kissed him, maybe found a dark corner somewhere for a little more...”

She grinned. “So you would actually want me to... you know... go a little further, if the opportunity presented itself?”

“I mean, I know I'll always love you, no matter what happens. And the fact that I'm encouraging you to do this means I could never be angry if you actually go through with it. If I decide I can't handle it afterwards—then I can't handle it. But I know there's no malice on your part, you'd never want to hurt me. So I want you to do it, find out what it's like, so then I'll know whether I want this to continue.”

“End the uncertainty,” she nodded. Then she said, “What do you do when you're waiting for me?”

“Not a huge amount,” he said. “I do tend to dwell on my thoughts while I wait.”

“You need some distraction,” she said.

He shrugged, said, “You could give me some hints about what you're up to.”

“I guess I did kind of go all radio-silent on you most of the night, huh?” she said. “It was just too much to remember to text you, too overwhelming. Plus, I kind of thought I wasn’t doing anything worth reporting back, you know? Just chatting, drinking. A little kissing...”

“It’s okay, I knew how it was. And I don’t want to feel like I’m controlling you.”

“Well, maybe this next date I will do something worth reporting back on.”

She kissed him, and it suddenly seemed so real, that she was actually going to be stretching these lips around Will on Wednesday night, smearing her lipstick all over his hard cock. When she slung a leg over his body, pulled herself up onto him, and he slid back inside her, Hugo wondered how he’d feel if he received a text from her saying that she’d finally fucked another man.

Ten

Wednesday. In the morning, he had to get up and out of the apartment before Madeleine. His kiss goodbye woke her, and still half asleep, there wasn't much he could say that was in any way meaningful ahead of the evening's date.

"I love you," he whispered.

"Love you too, sweetie," she said, lips curling into a smile.

"Good luck this evening—enjoy yourself, let it go as far as you feel comfortable."

"I will."

"If you can't manage to keep me updated—never mind, you can tell me after."

Then he was gone, his every spare thought that day revolved around Madeleine—about what kind of clothes she'd wear on her date to the symphony, about what kind of underwear she'd put on, about whether she'd be shaving her pussy again in the anticipation that this time they would go back to his place for a little fooling around.

He thought about how nervous she must be in the run-up to the date, but how completely keyed up she would be, all day.

*

Nobody at the office was going for a quick drink after work, so come seven o'clock Hugo found himself descending the elevator alone, trying to decide what he might do with himself that evening.

If this whole dating thing for Madeleine was going to continue long-term—and Hugo sincerely hoped that it was—he figured that he'd have to get himself some kind of hobby to pass the dead hours waiting for her.

This evening, though, Hugo went through the security barrier of his building and out the door onto the street to find a familiar face out there waiting for him. Standing out there on the sidewalk in front of a hotdog cart was none other than the slender, Asian-American form of Lucy, arms folded, waiting for him. Smiling as he emerged from the revolving door.

“Have we met somewhere before?”

“Your face is kinda familiar.”

She embraced him, a little more friendly than he remembered her ever being before, as though she had somehow accepted him as being more than just the husband of her best friend, as though they had a connection of their own now.

Well, she did have a fairly intimate knowledge of his personal life.

“You here to tell me Madeleine’s finally decided to run off with another man?” he joked.

She smiled warmly, her eyes telling him everything was okay, that she was here to give him some distraction, to support him in this strange endeavor.

“Maddie sent me down here to keep you company,” she said, and Hugo liked that this was the reason for her being here, that his wife was concerned about his wellbeing.

“So she’s definitely planning on doing something tonight, then?”

“Maybe,” Lucy said. She looked good in casual jeans and a Harvard hooded top, which Hugo knew she’d stolen from some boyfriend from ages past. “Maybe not.”

Hugo chuckled. “So it’s going to be like that, is it? Should we go grab a bite to eat?”

“Sure, that would be great,” Lucy grinned.

“What you in the mood for?”

“Comfort food, don’t you think?”

They hopped in a cab for a short ride to a little diner over in Hell’s Kitchen that Hugo had been to a few times after work with Ray and

Lowego. It had two rows of tables, and thankfully wasn't particularly full for a midweek evening, so they got a booth by the windows.

"Nervous?" she asked him once the order was in, and the waitress hustling away to fetch drinks.

"Of course."

"More nervous than last time?"

"Not sure. I guess a little more. I'm fairly sure she's going to do something with the guy this time," Hugo said.

She nodded, leaned back. He couldn't quite read her poker face: did she know something of Madeleine's plans? It seemed to Hugo there was a faint glimmer within her pretty almond-shaped eyes suggesting she did have inside knowledge.

Reaching forward to fumble with the straw in her Cosmopolitan, Lucy looked out the window, then straight at him. "How would you feel if Madeleine had an actual affair?" she asked him.

Hugo felt a bolt of lightening scorch his heart. Was this the dark secret to which she'd referred the other night in her conversation with Madeleine? He managed to conceal his shock, play it down.

He said: "I don't know. I suppose it would hurt quite a bit."

"And yet here you are, and she is on a date with another man."

"This is totally different from an affair."

"How so? You've basically given her permission to fuck this guy."

"That's the point, isn't it?" he sipped his tall glass of draft Blue Moon. "I've given her permission."

"So it's an affair, of sorts. You told her you wanted to watch her have an affair."

"I guess I did," he said, nodding, never failing to be surprised at just how much detail his wife passed on from their private conversations to her best friend. "But I think you mean the kind of affair where I know nothing about it, and maybe it affects our marriage."

“If she did have something with someone, and didn’t want to tell you about it, how would you feel?”

Hugo felt cold from this conversation, though the diner itself was wonderfully warm and cozy. He said, “I guess I’d feel excluded, and that would hurt. This whole thing isn’t about giving her an alternative to our relationship—it’s about enhancing our relationship.”

Lucy nodded. “You’d be angry at her?”

“I don’t know.” He took a deep gulp of his beer, tried to imagine how he might feel if Madeleine came home one evening to reveal she’d been sleeping with Fabian for the past three months.

He couldn’t quite picture it. Why would she do such a thing, when they’d been role-playing this kind of thing so extensively, and he had made it so clear she could date whomever she wanted—sleep with whomever she wanted—so long as she didn’t hide it from him, she shared the details of her entanglement.

“I think if it was done because she simply couldn’t help herself, she was overcome by blind lust—I wouldn’t be angry with her. Particularly since I’ve been encouraging that kind of lust in her,” he said finally.

Lucy tilted her head, taken aback by his response. “You’d be okay with it?”

He shrugged, and realized as he was sitting there that actually yes, for the most part he’d be okay. “I’d be okay with the sex part,” he said. “Just the lying part, the failure to tell me—that would make me feel a little annoyed. Angry, maybe.”

“You’d be okay with the sex part, but not the lying part,” Lucy nodded. “You saying the sex part would fit with this whole fantasy of yours?”

Another sip of Blue Moon. “I guess part of me would find it exciting, yes. That she’s having a secret fling, that she’s being so hot and so bad. But that wouldn’t negate the fact she’d excluded me from this whole thing.”

They watched as the couple in the booth across the aisle from them received two big plates full of burgers and fries. Hugo didn't feel quite so hungry any more.

Lucy said, "You both have this fantasy now, don't you? For her to sleep with other men."

"I think so. I mean, I don't like to think it's just me pushing her to do this."

"Can't be," Lucy grinned. "Any woman looks at other guys and imagines fucking them, even if she's dating Brad Pitt. But this fantasy—you know hers is probably a little different from yours?"

"Different? How so?"

The waitress was with them next, placing a huge great steak sandwich in front of Lucy, a classic burger for Hugo.

"Could you... uh... just bring me a strawberry milkshake as well?" he asked their server. As good as the burger looked, he wasn't sure he could stomach it right now.

Left to themselves again, Lucy said, "The way her version of the fantasy has developed, it's been different than the way yours has."

"Of course. I wasn't assuming she'd just suddenly latch on to this fantasy I was having," Hugo said, pausing as the waitress laid his milkshake before him. "She started flirting with the guys around her in the bookstore, and she started imagining herself with that Connor guy from across the street way before I ever mentioned wanting to see her sleep with someone else."

Lucy was having no problems with her appetite—her steak sandwich had no chance. Hugo wondered where she put all the food—her frame seemed too slender to absorb that much volume.

Once her mouth was empty again, she said, "She thought you weren't interested in her—sexually, I mean. She never doubted your love for her, after everything you did for her. But you saw her at such a low

point in her life, it was really demeaning for you both when you were her caregiver—”

“No, it was just the—”

Lucy shook her head. “She made the assumption that after that, you’d never see her in the same way as before. As your loving wife, sure, but not as an attractive female.”

“I just didn’t know how to regain what we had, you know, sexually. It seemed awkward after what we went through. I was never sure she was in the mood—and then when I was certain she was in the mood, she seemed to take care of herself. She didn’t seem to want me.”

“Communication problems,” Lucy said, tearing off another hunk of steak. “Oh, once she knew you’d been secretly watching her, totally absorbed in her while you did—she was seriously happy. But before that, she did start dreaming of infidelity.”

Hugo said, “It was only a fantasy, though. She wouldn’t have acted on it.”

“Yeah—I mean, when that guy Fabian kissed her, she was totally horrified. I don’t think I ever saw her so terrified after that, before you guys talked it out. Only, now you’ve talked about her seeing other guys... her fantasy’s still there.”

Hugo wasn’t sure milkshake was compatible with beer. Maybe he just needed something a little stronger.

He sipped the sweet sugary drink, thinking about Madeleine’s conversation with Lucy when they had spoken about a “dark secret”. Was it something to do with this fantasy of hers?

As he put his glass down, he saw a startled look on Lucy’s face. He realized that he’d actually just blurted out the question now spinning around and around his mind.

“What did you say?” she asked him.

He knew he had to step carefully—he didn’t want her to know he’d overheard her private conversation with Madeleine. It wasn’t exactly

ethical, though it hadn't been his fault they'd made the assumption he'd been asleep.

As the professional spin-doctor he now was, he spun his reply to her, hushing up the part about overhearing the conversation, inferring he'd known about something for a while. "I've just had this feeling that something happened once, something Madeleine's never felt able to talk to me about," he said. "I wondered if it was some kind of fling or affair."

Lucy's eyes widened for just a brief moment before she concealed it, and Hugo felt as though someone had dropped a heavy hot stone in his stomach. There for the tiniest glimpse was some kind of admission that there was something in what he was suggesting.

Had Madeleine had an affair?

He felt the cold fingers of jealousy and fear now circling his heart—and yet he was almost more fearful that whatever knowledge Lucy had would reveal that he could not handle the reality of Madeleine being with another, even if he so wanted it to happen in theory.

"Seriously," he said. "We're sitting here waiting while she's out dating another guy, and you're worried about hurting my feelings telling me about some fling she's already had?"

He could see in Lucy's face that she wanted to tell him. It was Lucy—for God's sake, the woman didn't know the meaning of the word confidential. She was the biggest gossip on the East Coast.

"Something did happen, didn't it?"

But she shook her head once. Refusal.

"Come on," Hugo said, "It's past history, isn't it? Nothing will make me change my mind about her, you know, or this, or anything."

Lucy looked regretfully up to the waitress, silently requesting the bill, and Hugo felt frustrated by her silence.

Then she said, "It's for her to tell you."

He said, "She did have an affair?"

"It wasn't so much an affair as... an indiscretion."

“When? Recently? A year ago? While we’ve been married?”

Lucy sighed. “Look, it was nothing, really. Nothing important.”

“Before we got married?”

He could see her breaking down in front of him—felt a little bad for her, in a way. Yet if she wanted to be his great supporter in all this, she couldn’t keep secrets from him like this.

She said, “Okay, something might have happened at her bachelorette party. But you really, really, have to get it from her. I didn’t even hint at anything.”

Hugo nodded. “Did she meet someone?”

Lucy tilted her head. “Maybe.”

“Did they go home together?”

“Well, we all kind of crashed back at Marie’s place.”

Hugo actually felt relieved. Things were supposed to happen on bachelorette parties. Madeleine had come back from hers glowing, and he remembered her telling him what a great time she’d had, what a wild night it had been—but they both had an unsaid understanding that she wasn’t going to fill him in on the details, and he wasn’t going to demand them. He’d been okay about that, since it had allowed him to keep quiet about his own lame bachelor party.

He had actually assumed her bachelorette night had mostly likely been little more than a normal girls’ night out, perhaps with a little more drinking than usual. He was intrigued that something more than that had actually happened.

“Tell me about him.”

“I can’t.”

“Please. Just a couple of details?”

Another sigh. It was getting to the point where she’d tell him something just to stop this line of conversation. “Not a word to her that I said anything,” she said.

“Promise.”

A small nod. “Dark hair, cute. About her age. That’s all I’m telling you.”

Hugo felt himself tingling as he sat in the booth—Madeleine had a dark secret, some kind of drunken fumble while she’d crashed overnight with her friend Marie following the bachelorette night. Well, he couldn’t be angry at that, it was even before they’d uttered their wedding vows. Sexy to think she’d kept that dirty secret so long.

“Everyone was drunk, very drunk, Hugo,” Lucy said as though in damage limitation mode.

“But she did sleep with someone else.”

“It was a mistake, that’s all. Heat of the moment.”

He could see Lucy trying to assess him as she was telling him this, examining the signs on his face about how he was really taking this, looking for the suggestions for how he would take the idea of Madeleine actually doing something with her date that evening.

Would Madeleine tell him more?

Lucy was looking awkward for the first time since he’d met her. She really did think she was getting her best friend into trouble, possibly even threatening her marriage by revealing all this stuff. Hugo gave her a break.

He said, calmly, “So now you know I’m not going to freak out about that bachelorette party all those moons ago, you can be straight with me, Luce. Madeleine’s fantasy is to actually commit adultery, right? She wants to sleep with guys and not tell me about it?”

Lucy took a huge gulp of her cocktail. “I wouldn’t say it’s as simple as that,” she said. “I mean she does have a big urge to fulfill your fantasy, so that would mean telling you all the details, or letting you watch. She does love playing with you—teasing you, keeping you in suspense, surprising you, even shocking you, I guess.”

“But?” he assumed there was a *but* coming.

She nodded. “When she went out on that first date, from the website, she said it wasn’t exactly what she wanted.”

“The guy wasn’t great—I know that. But she’s found someone else now.”

Lucy shook her head. She looked straight at Hugo, her eyes so very dark. She said, “Don’t freak out that I’m telling you this, Hugo...”

“I won’t.”

His heart was thumping in his chest so hard it was a wonder it didn’t rattle the dishes.

“That first date was the only time she ever met anyone from that website.”

Hugo felt his stomach tighten. So Madeleine had been lying to him?

“So who did she go out with on Saturday? Who is she going to the symphony with right now?”

“Connor. She’s kind of been dating him a while now.”

Eleven

She saw how it hit him right in the solar plexus. She settled up the bill and escorted him to a nearby bar, pronto. He felt sick, but a shot of vodka actually helped him.

“So what, she’s already been sleeping with him, behind my back?”

“No,” Lucy shook her head. “No, they haven’t done anything yet. Really—it’s been very slow, and it’s been very casual. Just a few lunch dates, really.”

“She made it seem as though she was having lunch with guys from the website.”

“She wasn’t. It wasn’t just those dates she told you about, you know how long he’s been after her—and she’s been interested. She’s been helping him with his writing, you know, with her Small Press project.”

“She told me she didn’t want to date him. She was worried she felt too strongly about him.”

Lucy ordered a fresh round of shots. She said, “That night when she had her Internet date—you know, she walked away from that guy after the entrees?”

Hugo scratched his head. There was too much information about Madeleine’s secret side coming at him at once, hard to process. “But she was out until late that night.”

“She came ‘round to mine,” Lucy said. “Kind of upset, really. The whole Internet dating thing was not happening—she said she liked the guy, he was very friendly. But there was no chemistry whatsoever.”

“Okay, she said that afterwards.”

“But it wasn’t just that—she felt it was all kind of cheap, somehow. Meaningless. It was about her just going out and having sex with some random guy—even if she’d picked him from a line-up on a website. She

knew it wasn't going to thrill her in the way you wanted it to," Lucy explained.

Somehow, Hugo completely understood. And he understood why she might decide to go after Connor instead—and he approved. He'd always wanted her to pursue her crush, the way the guy turned her on. But why had she felt the need to hide it?

"It was all just so flat," Lucy said. "She didn't want to be just a piece of meat her husband sent out to bang random guys before coming back for him to reclaim her. If she was going to be allowed to experience the joys of a new relationship, it had to be a relationship that made her feel that joy."

"I get it," Hugo said. "But why lie about it? I told her I'd love it if she dated Connor. We even pictured it sometimes when we made love."

Lucy said, "It started out that night when she came over after that Internet date went so badly wrong. She was late back to you because we stayed up talking so long. She felt any date she had with a guy off that website was going to turn out the same way. It was obvious she had to date someone who actually meant something to her—but she knew your big fear was of this thing becoming more than just sex."

"You knew she was going to start dating Connor? And that she was going to tell me she was still looking for guys on that website?"

Lucy held up her hands to protest her innocence. "We thought she could keep looking for someone on the website, just in case. But in the mean time, she could quietly explore the possibility of Connor—and whether dating him would start to make her feel more than just physical attraction to him."

"But you're saying nothing's happened?"

"Not yet, not really. What happened on Saturday—that was the first time she really went with him for more than just a coffee, a lunch or a couple of drinks after work. And you know she kissed him."

"I didn't know it was Connor she kissed."

“You’re angry?” Lucy asked him.

Hugo sat there staring at another shot glass full of clear liquid. He was feeling all light-headed, dizzy, but it was nothing to do with the alcohol blazing around his system. He also realized that things were all tingly between his thighs—and he was semi-erect.

He felt no hint of anger toward Madeleine.

“No. Not really. She wanted to see if dating Connor would actually be something that could damage us,” he reasoned. “So what did she find out?”

Lucy smiled, seeing that Hugo was quietly warming to the idea of his wife dating her crush. She said, “Well, she found out that Connor’s a lovely guy, but not interested in settling with one woman, let alone a married one.”

Hugo was silent a while, just drinking and contemplating.

Lucy said, “It’s not just sleeping with a guy that’s not her husband that forms the center of her fantasy, you see? It’s the sense that it’s forbidden, that she’s being bad in doing it. And that Internet date of hers offered her none of those feelings.”

“So she invents this ‘Will’ character, and she’s telling me that she might sleep with him, and then in actual fact she’ll sleep with Connor, is that it?”

Lucy said, “She wanted to make sure you were experiencing the fact of her having sex with another man for the first time—having your fantasy made real. She just didn’t feel ready to open up about doing it with Connor.”

Hugo sighed. “I guess I see the attraction to the idea that it’s forbidden, it’s not exactly what I wanted, but I can see she’s not actively trying to hurt me.”

“No,” Lucy said. “She’s definitely not trying to do that.”

“But why bother to invent the whole Will thing? She could just have kept the whole thing quiet, told me she was going out with you whenever

she wanted to see him.”

“It was a possibility,” Lucy said. “But you have to see she’s conflicted—she wants the whole forbidden fruit thing, but then she also wants you to know about her, because she knows it’s your fantasy. So her idea was to pursue Connor, and have you imagine she was just going on random Internet dates.”

“But now you’re telling me all this. Does Madeleine know you’re telling me?”

Lucy took a sip of her drink, then shook her head. “Not really,” she said. “It’s complicated.”

Hugo chuckled. “So explain—we’ve got time, haven’t we?”

It was past eleven o’clock by now. Hugo was acutely aware of the time, having watched the hands circulating the dial on the clock back in the diner, and now the one tucked away behind the bar, wondering every minute what Madeleine was doing, how their date was going.

Lucy said, “When we were talking after that appalling first date of hers, we kind of figured it would be nice if Madeleine could date Connor in secret, but that you would approve of it. Then she’d reveal all when she was ready.”

Hugo couldn’t help but smile. Madeleine wanted to have her cake and eat it, that was clear enough.

“So how would you engineer that?” he asked.

He felt that familiar tingle of arousal between his legs, a warm glow building inside his chest. It was actually quite hot to think about Madeleine pursuing an affair, with him finding out about it.

“You like the idea, don’t you?” Lucy said. “I can tell. You don’t have much of a poker face.”

Hugo took a huge sip of his vodka tonic. He said, “Okay, so Madeleine would have her affair—then what? She’d have you tell me about it?”

“We didn’t really come up with any kind of plan,” Lucy said. “We just left it at that—wouldn’t it be nice if she had her affair, and you had your little insights into a straying wife, albeit some time later.”

“But you’re not doing it that way?”

Lucy sipped her drink, and he could see her trying to find the words to explain herself. Finally, she said, “Okay, right now, all she knows is that I’m here helping you pass some time until her date is over. As far as she is concerned, I’m not supposed to tell you anything about the date.”

“Oh.”

Lucy continued, “But what I was supposed to do was to talk to you about hypothetical things, and make sure that you could understand her version of the fantasy—you know, in purely theoretical terms—and approve of it.”

“You were going to make me approve of her having an actual affair, thinking she wasn’t having one yet?”

“Something like that. Then if I wasn’t able to persuade you, if you really hated the idea, I’d just text her and she’d break it off with Connor until we figure out something else, something you’d be happy with.”

“But you are telling me about her actual affair.”

Lucy shrugged. “It’s not your fantasy to have it as a secret. Your fantasy is to know all about her tryst with someone else. So what if you know? The important thing is that she doesn’t know that you know.”

Hugo scratched his head. “This is in danger of turning into some kind of an SNL skit. So wait... you are going to tell me what’s happening on this date?”

Lucy laughed. “I’ll drop a few details if you want me to. I mean, that way, she gets to have her little fantasy, and you get to have yours, right?”

“Right. That does sound fair. So what’s she planning to do tonight? They’re going to the Met for a concert—I know that, she told me straight after her last date. Are they going to sleep together after that?”

Lucy shook her head. “She told me it was too soon for that. She’s not ready to go all the way, not tonight.”

“And if she goes into his bedroom, she might be tempted,” he nodded. “She’ll want to take things slowly, knowing Maddie. Cautiously. On their first date, they were kissing in doorways, she said. Couldn’t get their hands off each other. But no more than that. So maybe something more will happen when he takes her home this time.”

“You won’t get to see her if it’s in a taxi.”

“The concert’s at the Met—so maybe they’ll feel like a late-night stroll through Central Park after the symphony’s over—how late does it stay open?”

Lucy fumbled with her smartphone a moment or two. “One.”

“You think we might see something if we’re lucky?”

Lucy smiled knowingly, and Hugo couldn’t help but think he was being set up for something. He said quietly: “You’re going to turn me into her own personal stalker.”

“I’m not sure it’ll be that bad. Besides, I’m not sure you’re allowed to call them stalkers any more. Obsessive American, I believe is the acceptable label,” Lucy grinned. “And you’re her beloved husband, you’re allowed to be obsessive.”

*

The taxi took them up 10th Avenue and then Amsterdam, and promptly snarled up in traffic when it came time to thread through the narrow W81 St over to the transverse across Central Park.

Halfway through the park, Hugo was quietly suggesting they bale out and proceed the final part of the way on foot.

“We have time,” Lucy insisted, and Hugo gave her a sharp glance that questioned whether she knew more than she was saying about Madeleine and her plans for the evening.

“The music’s only 45 minutes long.”

Lucy shook her head, “The program’s ninety minutes—they’re doing a few other numbers as well.”

Hugo nodded. “God, it’s so random. There’s no way we’ll find them at a place as huge as the Met.”

The taxi dropped them off on the corner of 5th, so they could walk the short distance up the avenue to the museum. Hugo felt himself shivering a little, though it actually wasn’t too cold considering the time of year.

“Do you feel bad—that you’re allowing her the freedom to see other guys, but you don’t get to date other women?” Lucy asked him, almost as though she was trying to keep his mind occupied, distracted from the nervous tension running through him.

“Actually, not at all,” he said. “It seems weird, doesn’t it? Ten years ago, my biggest fantasy was having sex with more than one woman. Now, though, I’m just in a different place.”

“Wait, you don’t fantasize about having sex with two women at once any more?”

He shrugged. “Not really. I’m more likely to imagine that Madeleine is one of the women, and the guy is some stranger—but I get to watch.”

“Jesus.”

“Yeah, it’s not for everyone.”

“Have you guys ever talked about any limits on what she does?”

“She knows my biggest fear is that she’ll fall for someone else. But I really don’t want to restrict her—it has to be her choice in this.”

“Seriously. I have got to get me a husband like you.”

As they came to the museum’s iconic façade, Hugo’s heart was beating double-quick time again, his breathing becoming shallow in anticipation of what they might see. Would they notice a lone couple

exiting the building, descending the broad stone stairs down to street level?

Lucy indicated that they should sit on the top step, on the south side, where they could pose as a couple of tourists or young lovers sitting to appreciate the architecture, casting an eye behind them in case their targets emerged.

“How are we supposed to do this?” he said. “I mean, neither of us are exactly trained in surveillance techniques. They could probably walk right by us and we’d never know.”

Lucy said, “We just have to pay attention.”

There were a few other people milling around on the steps, some in smart clothing, perhaps as concertgoers.

“And if they come right this way?” he asked. “Where are we supposed to hide?”

“You’ll just have to kiss me, pretend we’re a couple of love birds.”

“I’m not sure Madeleine would be too happy about that.”

Lucy laughed. “Relax. She’s kissed me enough times, what matter is it if you did too?”

Hugo coughed, tried not to choke. “Uh... say that one again.”

Lucy rolled her eyes. “Why do guys always obsess about that kind of thing?”

“She used to practice kissing with you?”

“It’s what college girls do—well, the non-slutty ones, anyway. Practice on their friends.”

Lucy suddenly looked behind her, peering over her shoulder toward the museum entrance. A few people were coming out, now, wearing suits and tuxedos. The audience from the concert? Was Madeleine on her way out with her date?

None of them were Madeleine and Connor.

“Maybe they’re still inside,” Hugo said in a loud whisper. “They could have found a quiet gallery somewhere to make out.”

Lucy shook her head. “No,” she said, again making him feel certain she knew more about this situation than she’d let on. “She wouldn’t do it like that.”

A few moments, and the trickle of well-dressed people became a flurry, and it was quite clear the concert was over. Hugo was suddenly aware that there were so many people now coming out of the building that it was impossible to assess all their faces—Madeleine and her date could have easily blended in with the crowd, and they’d never know they had come out.

“I can’t see properly,” Lucy whispered. “Let’s stand up. We’ll have to get familiar if we want to keep our cover.”

Hugo stood up, the question “what?” imprinted in his open mouth before she grabbed him and pulled him in for an embrace. They didn’t actually kiss, but Lucy wedged her face against his, pressing cheek-to-cheek, so that he could feel her soft skin, breathe in her Chanel No.5. To anyone behind them, it would probably look as though they were in a full-on PDA.

Hugo felt her pressing her hips to him, and realized she would be able to feel his semi-hard cock pressing against her.

“Hey,” he said, pulling his hips away from hers. “Careful.”

Lucy grinned, her dark eyes full of mischievous mirth. “Who knew you were so gifted?” she said. “It’s a wonder Maddie feels the need for alternatives.”

“Okay, okay.”

“Although,” she added, “If you were mine and I knew the thought of me being with another man made you that hard, I’d want to do it too. Who are we kidding, I’d probably want to do it anyway, just because you’d let me.”

“Shh! You want to blow our cover?”

It took a while, and it seemed to Hugo that Lucy was as nervous as he was in watching the various people coming out of there. Where were

they? It would be such a disappointment if they did hang back, make use of an empty theater to misbehave.

Then, suddenly, there they were.

Twelve

Hugo felt a strange dizzying energy sweep through his system on seeing them.

Madeleine looked simply dazzling in a stylish crimson dress that clung to her curves and fell mid-thigh, which perhaps wasn't quite as short as some of the skirts she'd worn to work that summer, but seemed a touch scandalous for the classical music crowd. She was wearing a coat over the top, but left it open to reveal her dress, her legs looking divine clad in black nylon.

Somehow she seemed different than the Madeleine he knew so well—initially, he wasn't sure if it was just the strangeness of seeing an unfamiliar man on her arm. After a moment or two, he realized it was her confident bearing as she stood there with him, waiting for him to retrieve and light a cigarette.

With her dark eyeliner, heavy mascara, and jarringly bright scarlet lipstick, she looked a little like a movie star from some bygone age, when the contrast had to be exaggerated because everything was in black and white. Hugo recognized the look from some of the girls they sometimes saw hanging around in the college students' apartment across the street. The thought prompted a little burst of zesty jealousy within him, along with a piquant hint of arousal: her make-up was designed to attract a younger man—Connor, not her husband.

That lipstick seemed to straddle the border between sleazy and ultra-sexy glamor. It made him think of how it might smear while her lips were gliding up and down her new boyfriend's cock.

Connor himself looked dashing in a smart dark suit, his crimson shirt making him match Madeleine's outfit as though they were dance partners. Hugo hadn't really seen him except from a distance, and now

felt quietly pleased that he was so well turned out. Worthy, perhaps, of Madeleine.

Lucy held Hugo tight, like a lover, standing on tiptoes as though her petite frame might hide him. He was confident neither Madeleine nor Connor would spot them.

He watched them pause, Connor saying something to Madeleine that made her smile, then look at him with adoring eyes.

Jesus. This man really was on course to take her, if he so wanted.

“Are you okay with this?” Lucy whispered as she continued to cling on to him.

He had lost his erection. It wasn't that he wasn't still blooming with quiet excitement, it was simply the shock of realizing what was going on.

“Yes,” he replied. “I think so.”

Lucy said, “You better know so. Very soon, you won't get the option of stopping them.”

Hugo watched Connor offer his cigarette to Madeleine, who accepted it, drew a great long toke on it, startling her husband, since as far as he knew she'd been a non-smoker as long as he'd known her. She handed it back to him without any hint that it wasn't some completely normal occurrence in her life. Then the two of them turned, and slowly walked toward Lucy and Hugo, who now regretted not shifting further over to the side of the steps.

Hugo felt panic rising in his chest—that paranoid part of him concerned that they would be seen, that Madeleine would be angry at having her privacy invaded, that she would wreak her revenge by going straight home with Connor, spending the night with him. He buried his face in Lucy's neck, as though nuzzling her,

The other couple drifted by without noticing they were being watched. Hugo appreciated that had they been seen, Madeleine probably wouldn't have been angry. Surprised, perhaps.

“I don’t want to stop them,” he whispered to Lucy, and with the initial shock of This Is Really Happening Now mellowing into his general feeling of aroused-jealous wonderment, he felt a warm tingle in his loins as the blood started flowing back into his manhood.

“Good,” Lucy whispered in his ear, doing a good job in pretending they were a couple unable to resist each other after an evening of performing arts.

“I feel bad we’ve never really done anything like this together,” he said. “You know—dressing up, seeing some culture.”

“You’ve been settling in, there’s plenty of time for all that,” Lucy said.

“We rarely did anything in Boston, either. It makes me feel I’ve neglected her.”

“You were her caregiver. That was the complete opposite of neglect. Connor just comes from a different world—and remember, he has to win Madeleine over, he has to impress her.”

Lucy gave him a little reassuring squeeze. He wondered in that moment why she’d had such trouble finding the right guy. She deserved someone worthwhile.

He said, “You think we could really follow them, and they wouldn’t know we were doing it?”

“We can try,” she said, tentatively turning to cast an eye behind her, to see whether they were safe to follow.

They followed about twenty paces behind their prey, Lucy clinging to Hugo’s arm, both of them completely tense, poised to turn and perhaps pull each other in for another fake kiss in the event that Connor or Madeleine suddenly turned.

They didn’t turn. Arm in arm, they seemed completely absorbed in each other—stoking Hugo’s jealousy as they chatted and laughed flirtatiously. They strolled slowly down 5th before turning into the park, as their followers had predicted.

It was already dark, of course, though there was street lighting along the path they were following. There was plenty of scope for them to go off piste, though, and disappear from sight.

Lucy held Hugo back a little, since the absence of others entering the park this time of night made their presence that much more noticeable. They hung back, held hands like a loving couple, constantly vigilant for signs that their prey might turn and see them. But Madeleine and Connor were too absorbed in each other to be concerned about others.

Descending through the trees to the lake, then skirting around the lake a little to ensure distance from the main trail, Madeleine and Connor paused by the waterside, gazing at the view of the city over the park.

Hugo watched with bated breath as Madeleine tugged on Connor's hand, and the two of them came together, arms encircling each other, lips closing in on lips.

Hugo gasped, almost giving them away, though the dark bushes leant them suitable concealment.

Somehow, whether helped by the lights of the city, reflected off the still surface of the lake, or the fact their eyes had gotten used to the darkness, Hugo found he could see Madeleine and her new lover fairly well.

She was smiling as she kissed him, and when they finally broke apart, there was clear affection in her expression—clear feelings for Connor. Madeleine hadn't been open about how much she'd seen this guy so far—well, as far as Hugo was supposed to know, she was on a date with some character called Will tonight. But he wasn't expecting this level of a connection between them. It cut Hugo to the bone, but he knew he had to choose to take it as simple lust and appreciation for the guy, not love.

He wanted her to be with a guy who was worthy enough, who made her melt inside, that was a good thing. But he had to tell his primordial

instincts that it was okay, this man wasn't going to steal his wife. It wasn't easy to just switch off those innate hormone-driven feelings.

Connor stroked her cheek, and leaned forward to kiss her tenderly again.

Hugo felt himself tremble as his wife placed her hand gently on the side of Connor's neck as they continued to kiss, her eyes closing as she sucked on his lips, inhaled his fragrance. A kiss could be worse than anything when a husband allowed his wife to be with another. Sex might be personal, but it could be seen as purely a physical thing—two people rubbing themselves together to satisfy an urge. Kissing involved staring into each others' eyes, soft caresses of the cheeks, affectionate romance between the participants—it was more intimate than you gave it credit.

It didn't help that the scene in which they found themselves was wonderfully romantic.

Hugo found himself drifting into some strange kind of dream state as Madeleine continued to lock lips with this comparative stranger, looking so blissed out by the experience that it made Hugo feel as though he was on cloud nine himself. He almost failed to notice her break off from Connor now, then whisper something in his ear.

A smile crept across Connor's face, as he gave her a slight nod.

Madeleine sank slowly to her knees in front of him. Hugo felt a sudden queasy sensation in his stomach. He looked at Lucy, and she was giving him a pointed stare, eyebrows raised, face silently fixed in the kind of expression that clearly told him—this is your last chance. Speak now or forever hold your peace.

Lucy held out her smartphone to him—indicating that he could call Madeleine, right now, and she would stop. They wouldn't need some shouted confrontation in the middle of the park.

Hugo took a deep breath and shook his head. He might be feeling dizzy above the neck, but below the waist he was hard as granite. Madeleine looked absolutely gorgeous, the angel corrupted, and the

glimpse of her face that Hugo had seen just before she sank was worth any hardship he could go through—she seemed so exhilarated.

In something of a daze, he saw his wife's hands fumbling with the younger man's belt. From here, they could see everything—disturbingly close.

Connor reached down, stroking Madeleine's cheek as she unzipped his fly, and then dragged down his suit pants to reveal his impressive hardness. Even now, the guy didn't seem concerned that this was a public park, that anyone could come along and see them.

Madeleine smiled up at him, that warmth of real affection still jabbing Hugo between the ribs, and she took another man's erect cock in her hands.

The night air was suddenly pierced by a squawk from an emergency vehicle's siren down Central Park West. Both couples there by the lake froze.

But the siren passed. After a sigh of relief, Madeleine was looking up at her new boyfriend, and they were laughing about it together.

They saw Madeleine looking about her, a last check to see they were alone.

Hugo stiffened as he saw Madeleine's red, red lips curl upwards as she gazed into Connor's eyes, offering him a last sexy smile.

Her focus was fell onto the sizable beast in front of her—exploring it, feasting her eyes on it as she coaxed it with her hands, slowly pumping him in preparation for her mouth.

With all the clamor in his ears and in his head as she edged her face close to it, Hugo almost missed the fact that Connor was completely bare. Not a single hair was visible other than on his head. It seemed almost as though he was a statue.

No wonder Madeleine had wanted to shave herself for him.

Hugo felt a jolt of shock tear through his chest as Madeleine ducked down, pushing her face against Connor's body, nudging her cheek

against his hardness as she kissed his abdomen just beside it. She brushed it with the silky blonde hair that strayed over her forehead and then slowly trailed her mouth and nose up from his sac all the way up his hard, straight cock, breathing in his scent, feeling the softness of his skin, the heat of his body.

Madeleine replaced her nose with the tip of her tongue as she caressed his twitching shaft, licking him, down, then upward, until the tip of his prick was at her lips, and she only needed a slight movement for him to be inside her.

He saw her look up into Connor's eyes, a question on her face—teasing him: you really want this? As she pressed that huge hot column of flesh to her face. Hugo wasn't looking at Connor to catch his response, but whatever it was made the silent question on Madeleine's face melt into a wicked, sultry look of pure lust and desire.

She was licking him again, rising up to the tip, but this time with clear intent in her beautiful dark eyes.

Hugo drew in a sharp breath as he watched her part her lips, and slip them over the head of the other man's bulging manhood. She slowly slid down, taking more of him inside her, her hands gripping tightly around the base of his shaft.

Madeleine—his Madeleine—was sucking a stranger's cock.

Connor groaned, long and deep, tilting his head back, his eyes closed as she rose and fell on his hardness, then withdrew, her tongue gliding up and down his shaft in the same slow, sensual rhythm a few times before she took him back inside her mouth.

Hugo throbbed with excitement at such a wanton display from his pretty wife.

Madeleine tucked a rogue strand of her hair behind her ear, as though to allow her husband to better see her face rather than to pull it out of her way. For a while she focused her sucking on his tip, swirling her tongue around his head, feeling the strange topography of that large

rounded helmet with her lips as her hand pumped his shaft firmly to maintain the rhythm.

Gazing down at the beautiful flushed blonde as she pumped his cock and bobbed her head over its tip, Connor placed his hand on her head, his fingers moving through her silky blonde hair. He gripped her tightly, guiding her rhythm, fucking her face, no doubt feeling her soft lips made waxy by her bright red lipstick.

Connor moaned, loudly, then they heard him warn her, “I’m so close.”

Madeleine grinned up at him, and Hugo saw how her makeup was already smeared. She looked so sexy. Then she said to the man who was not her husband, “So come for me.”

That almost had Hugo exploding in his pants again.

She slipped Connor’s cock back in her mouth, stretching her soft scarlet-stained lips around the man’s tip, sinking down on him, her hand continuing to pump him, the other cradling his sac.

Connor placed his hand on her head again as she took him deep, and for a few moments he was just fucking her pretty face in obscene ecstasy.

He let out a deep guttural groan, and Hugo saw his cock flinch in her hands. He was visibly pumping into her. Hugo heard his wife swallowing, even above the low noise of the traffic half a block away—she was gulping down his cream, her face the picture of bliss and satisfaction at such a filthy end to their little date.

A little of his emission escaped her lips, splashing over her chin, her neck, her upper chest.

Madeleine gave an impish grin, wiping the fluid, rubbing it into her skin. She opened her mouth to clean his cock as it throbbed, the last few aftershocks dying down following his climax. Hugo swore he could see the come inside her mouth.

He stepped back as he saw his wife smile warmly up at Connor, the flicker of jealousy returning to him even as his entire body cried out to

go over there and drag Madeleine away, tear off her clothes, reclaim her as his own.

Then Lucy pulled him back, out into the street and over to the other side, away from the direction that would lead the two new lovers home. He felt as though someone had fed him drugs—his head was spinning, his chest felt as though it was on fire.

Madeleine had really done it—she had gone down on the guy from across the street, her crush ever since they'd arrived in New York City. From across the street, they were able to see the new couple fixing their clothing, laughing and cooing at each other, before they re-started their walk home.

Apparently, she'd really enjoyed herself. Even with that hint of bittersweet jealousy glimmering in his veins, Hugo felt wonderful.

Thirteen

They followed Madeleine and Connor home in a cab. Hugo felt his heart thudding all the way, almost as though he was in incredibly poor shape.

It had been such a strange experience. On one level, it was really nothing special—just a woman making her male companion feel better, almost as though she had been giving him a brief massage of the shoulders. Yet culture imbrued the act with such personal significance.

To Hugo, the thing that had really taken his breath away, and spurred his jealousy more than anything, had been the way Madeleine looked at him, the way she had been with him. The graceful, incredibly feminine way she moved around him—all part of the flirtation, he supposed—in a way she did not with her husband. The way she looked at him, her eyes so very bright, admiring and affectionate. Obsessed, almost.

The shocking thing about watching her kneel before him and take his cock into her mouth was that it seemed to Hugo that she did it not to fulfill her own sexual craving to be wicked, or because she knew it would eventually fuel her husband's sexual fantasies, but because she had so enjoyed her evening with Connor, and liked him so much.

He knew she had been adamant that whatever happened, she would never fall for another man, there would never be any threat to Hugo's status as her primary, number-one guy. Watching her doing it, though, revealed how difficult it was to actually untangle the lust thing from the love thing.

Hugo had to tell himself that she was merely being flirtatious, merely playing up her feminine wiles to attract Connor, to seduce him, to keep him interested in a way she did not need to do with her husband. He had to tell himself she did not love her new boyfriend.

Oh, but how the danger spiced up the excitement.

They had the cab stop some way from the entrance to Hugo's building so they could safely observe Connor escort Madeleine inside. Lucy held Hugo back, since apparently he wasn't thinking straight, he was set to go straight in there after them. He allowed the pretty Asian American to contain him, giving her a nod to signal his realization that she was right, they couldn't go in yet.

"Is she going to sleep with him?" Hugo asked Lucy, feeling that familiar conflicted sensation again.

"I don't know," she said. "Or at least, I think if she was going to, it wouldn't be in your apartment."

"Right. Because we might come back any minute."

"I've texted her to say we're heading back after our night out. She knows we're coming."

They crossed the street to hover outside the entrance to Connor's building. Hanging out, trying not to look suspicious, embracing if they thought they were looking suspicious—Hugo feeling increasingly comfortable with Lucy doing that, though in more of a sibling-style relationship than in a sexual way.

Then Connor surprised them a little, suddenly appearing from Hugo's building and crossing the street toward them, heading directly for them, since they were in the way of the door.

Lucy took emergency evasive action and actually pulled Hugo into a french kiss, such that he tasted the traces of her most recent cosmopolitan on her lips.

Connor drifted by inches away from them, apparently none the wiser that they weren't actual lovers, clueless that they had been monitoring him.

"Jesus," Hugo said breathlessly as they eventually broke apart.

"My God," Lucy laughed. "I wish I had you to practice on in college!"

“Okay, let’s not mention this to Maddie.”

“Your secret is safe with me.”

“As safe as your secrets tend to be, I suppose.”

Lucy grinned. “I’ll only blackmail you for what you can afford.”

Hugo raised an eyebrow. “What can I afford?”

“Details,” she said. “You know—of what’s going on with you guys.”

Hugo rolled his eyes.

He was a little surprised that Lucy followed him across the street, into the building and up the elevator, all the way to the apartment front door. But the whole way his thoughts were more focused on calculating how long Connor had been inside with Madeleine—how much time he might have had with her before coming out. Judging by the length of time the elevator took getting to their floor, he can’t have had long at all—probably not much more than escorting his date to her door, a quick smooch and then departure.

The elevator doors opened, and Hugo felt himself slipping back into a daze, almost as though he was inebriated by liquor. The patterned décor of the wallpaper swirling and whirling around him. His brain protecting itself from potential shock, perhaps. From the fear that he would open that apartment door to find a woman who was no longer his wife, no longer the sweetheart he had married, forever changed by her experience going down on another man.

Any fears he did have melted away as soon as the door opened, and there she was, still wearing the short dress from her date, her makeup a little smeared, her lipstick reapplied though with a subtle hint that she’d used her mouth for something other than kissing.

There was a brief pause as they both looked at each other, Madeleine perhaps wondering if he knew what she’d done, Hugo curious as to what the protocol was now—as far as she was concerned, he knew only that she’d been on a second date with ‘Will’, but that Lucy had

talked to him and secured his approval for the hypothetical concept of her having an affair, with the details only coming to light when she was ready to tell.

“Hey,” she said, her face breaking out into a delayed but heartfelt smile. “I missed you. Have a good time with Lucy?”

“I think I should be asking you that question,” he gave her a smile in return. “How was your date?”

She shrugged, but he saw emotion bubbling up behind her eyes. She seemed to be holding back, putting a brave face on things as she said, “Oh, you know. So-so. It was okay. I enjoyed it.”

Hugo was somewhat surprised. Was she upset?

It was awkward having Lucy there. Hugo wanted to hold his beautiful wife in his arms, make love to her there and then—reclaim her, show her that nothing she could have done could threaten his love for her. But Lucy was hovering over his shoulder.

Madeleine’s eyes flickered all over his face, apparently seeking out any hint that he knew what she’d done, or was angry at her for doing it.

He felt pity for her, for the anxiety she felt in not knowing whether she had his full approval for the complex fantasy she wanted to pursue in real life, in worrying that he would take offense to it after all, to her little white lies, her concealment of her crush in the guise of some random Internet date.

Hugo thought to hell with it—to hell with Lucy being there. He reached forward, circled his hand around the back of her head and pulled her to him, her soft lips to his.

He kissed her hard, caring nothing whether they were observed, whether they were judged. He needed to connect with his gorgeous bride, and show her what she meant to him.

After a moment of surprise, Madeleine sank into his kiss, expressing full relief at his feelings for her, before that feeling became simple strong desire.

Hugo felt the unusual waxiness of her heavy lipstick, tasted the sweetness of her lips and the bitter hint of cigarette smoke—a flavor he certainly wasn't used to from kissing her, which made her seem somehow different from the Madeleine he'd known. Rebellious. Wicked. Sexy, though he would not ordinarily approve of her smoking.

And as he kissed her, he realized that he could smell the faint whiff of male cologne on her—more subtle than the time when she'd hoodwinked him in that hotel—and, dear God, he even suspected that he could taste something faint in her mouth that might just have been the almost imperceptible traces of another man.

Hugo shivered, but found the thought of where her mouth had been earlier that evening exhilarating. God, she was hot, God she was wicked.

After a while, she broke away, said, "Wait, I haven't... I haven't freshened up yet."

But he was kissing her again, breathing in the strange musty smell, tasting a slight saltiness on her lips that he knew he was not imagining. Was there something wrong with him? Finding it so hot that she'd strayed from the pure path of marriage?

Madeleine was apparently a little surprised, taken aback at his sudden desire for her, but after a moment or two, she relaxed into it, enjoyed his feverish craving for her.

But finally, she broke away from him, took a step back, and Hugo allowed her space.

"You want a drink before you go?" she asked Lucy, who smiled, nodded. A little shocked at the PDA.

"How was he?" Lucy asked her friend. "You do much?"

"Oh, you know," she said. "Second date, so nothing much happened. I guess we kissed a little."

"Was the symphony any good?"

"Uh... yeah, it was," Madeleine said as she fetched glasses from the kitchen cupboard.

Hugo excused himself to the bathroom, and as he proceeded toward the bedroom, he caught the briefest glimpse of a look passing between Madeleine and Lucy—that his wife did not mean for him to see. It was clearly a look designed to ask Lucy if Hugo was all right, if things were all right generally, if there was anything Madeleine needed to be wary of, careful of, in dealing with him now.

In the bathroom, he was too aroused to pee.

Standing there in front of the toilet, his cock was semi-hard in his hands, and in that state it was biologically impossible for him to empty his bladder. He stood in silence, except that he could hear through to the living room with surprising clarity. The way the vents were designed, he assumed.

“Did you talk about it?”

“Of course.”

“And what did he say?”

“He seemed okay with it.”

“You told him everything?”

“I told him what he needed to hear. To be informed, to give his consent.”

“And you really think he’s okay with it?”

“I think he’s excited that you’re actually going through with this. He wants to know the details when you’re ready to tell him.”

“So did you tell him about Connor?”

“I told him enough to know he’d be okay with you being with him. And if he discovered it was Connor, and not some guy named Will that you’ve been with, he won’t be upset.”

“Even that I kind of lied to him?”

“As long as you’re not trying to hurt him. As long as you’re not being malicious—but you wouldn’t be. You can see it in his eyes, he thinks it’s hot you have this fantasy.”

“He does?”

“He doesn’t want this to be only about making his fantasy come true. He wants it to be about your fantasy too, and to hear you have the fantasy too, even though it’s a little different—really gets him going.”

“That’s fantastic!”

“I’ll say. You’ve got the most amazing husband there, Mads, don’t let him go.”

“Oh, I won’t. I know that.”

“So how was it? Tonight?... I’ll take it that it was pretty amazing, then.”

“I’ll say.”

“Hugo’s under the impression you might have gone down on him tonight, by the way.”

“I’ll tell him when I’m ready.”

“You make sure you do. That’s the only thing he won’t forgive—being excluded.”

“I know that.”

“So when’s your next date with Connor?”

“Oh, I don’t know. Soon. You’re sure he’d be okay with it this way?”

“Certain. Jesus. I wish I had a husband like him.”

“I’m very lucky.”

“You better recognize that. Treat him to what he wants.”

Hugo felt a little self-conscious, thought perhaps they’d be wondering where he’d got to. He flushed the toilet and the sound of the conversation was gone.

When he emerged from the bathroom, Lucy was already at the front door, fastening her coat once again, ready to go.

“Hey, thanks for a really nice evening,” she said to him, and he saw both pity and a kind of affectionate respect in her eyes. Lucy had always been much, much closer to Madeleine—obviously, since they went way

back, she was Madeleine's best friend—but Hugo felt just then that he had a really strong connection with her now.

“Thank you,” he said. “I think I needed you to hold my hand.”

A strange look passed over Madeleine's face as she glanced at the two of them, as though she suddenly suspected that they might be keeping the whole truth from her, in the way that she thought she was keeping back a little of the truth from them.

Lucy flung her arms around him, hugged him tight. She said quietly in his ear: “You take care of yourself. Call me whenever you need.”

“I will,” he said.

When the door closed behind Lucy, Madeleine had the look of hesitancy in her eyes again, as though she was afraid now that her friend had left them alone, the real truth would come out, and Hugo would be angry with her.

“Hey,” he said, voice soft, trying to reassure her he was still okay with everything.

“Hey,” she said, offering him a faltering smile.

She was blushing as he stepped up to kissed her, not quite so frenzied this time—slow, measured, loving. Madeleine responded, smiling as she kissed him, the tension seeming to leach out of her body. His hands moved naturally to her breasts, touching her, seeking out that oh-so-wonderful shape of femininity, her luscious curves, which another man now desired totally, and was being given access, slowly.

Was Hugo really willing to give this up? Well, it wasn't really giving it up. Sharing. Allowing others to appreciate what he got to appreciate all the time.

She turned slightly, kissing him still, but now over her shoulder, so he could have better access to her breasts, slipping the straps of her dress down over her shoulders, revealing her semi-transparent black bra, which didn't last long.

“So you had a good time tonight?” he asked her.

“Unbelievable,” she said.

Her nipples were so hard as her breasts were bared, he stooped to take them into his mouth. She placed her hand delicately on the back of his neck as he sampled her flesh.

She said, “You talked to Lucy about everything?”

He nodded. “She said your version of this fantasy is different to mine.”

“You’re okay with that?”

He straightened, kissed her mouth again, sucking on her lips, her tongue, a little astounded at himself for not wanting her to immediately have a shower, cleanse herself of any trace she’d been with another. A little dumbfounded, actually, at how electrified he was to sense the slight hints of her other man still lingering on her.

He looked her in the eyes. “I like that you have a different interpretation of our fantasy. That it’s yours independent of me having it.”

“But it’s not entirely compatible with your version,” she said, eyes apologetic.

He shrugged. “Sure it is,” he said. “As long as you share the details eventually. I don’t mind waiting.”

“I could do it your way,” she said, offered. “It’s just... you know... when it feels most natural...”

“Of course, you get most out of it from pursuing it independently,” he nodded. Kissed her. “I’m not sure I’d like to miss your first time.”

“My first time?” she looked concerned. As though she’d jumped the gun, perhaps because of her earlier actions with Connor.

He smiled. “Well,” he said, “when it’s your first time actually going the whole way with your date. I’d like to at least know it’s happened. You know, that we’ve finally crossed that threshold.”

“Right,” she said.

She was wearing only her see-through black panties now. Hugo led her to the couch. He could already smell the slight undercurrent of her arousal through the remaining traces of her perfume, knew she must be as turned on as he was—having kissed and gone down on her date that evening, without Connor reciprocating as far as Hugo was aware.

She allowed herself to be led, to be positioned.

“So I found out a few things about you tonight,” he said to her, keeping his tone of voice light, casual.

“Oh? What was Lucy saying?”

Hugo knelt between her knees, pushing her legs open kissing the bottom of her inner thigh. Parting her knees, he was greeted by a waft of her spicy scent, which made him shiver to behold, confirmation of how pent up she was already, primed for him by another man. From where he was, he could also see through the semi-transparent gauze of her panties, see the tantalizing shape of her pussy lips.

His mouth was watering.

He said, “Well, I guess I was curious about this fantasy of yours and exactly where it came from. You know how shrinks always say that your character is shaped by your formative experiences.”

“Okay. Are you saying your fantasy comes from your formative experiences?” she smiled, deflecting the question back to him.

“Oh, you know that’s true,” he said, kissing his way slowly up her thigh. “When I first asked you out, I thought you were probably the most gorgeous girl in the world and were completely out of my league. When I married you, I was certain of it. So my fantasy’s probably grown out of all that insecurity.”

“Don’t be ridiculous.”

“So from what Lucy hinted, I think something happened to you that’s spawned this need for a secret romance,” he said.

“What?”

He kissed her other inner thigh, grazing his cheek over the rough, soaking material of her panties, feeling the heat of her pussy through it along with the abundant moisture.

“In fact,” he said, turning his head to nudge his nose and lips against her mound, her scent so wonderfully strong it was almost overwhelming, “I would even hazard a guess that something happened on your bachelorette party.”

Madeleine was blushing furiously. She said, “How much did Lucy tell you?”

He gently but firmly pulled off her panties now, peeling them down her thighs, revealing that beautifully smooth shaven pussy of hers.

He said, “She told me you had a dark secret, of which only you could tell me the full details. And that if I couldn’t handle the truth, then I can’t handle you dating again.”

Madeleine nodded, smiled as he pulled her panties over her ankles and off, before pressing them to his nose, inhaling her scent before casting them aside.

“I suppose she’s right,” she said.

He pulled her thighs apart again, this time revealing her pretty pink flower in all its glistening glory, shaved for another man. Then, hovering over her as though he would go no further if she didn’t tell him all, so close she could feel his hot breath on her sensitive folds, he prompted her, “So?”

She took a deep breath. “I guess something did happen on my bachelorette party. Are you mad at me?”

He shook his head. “How could I be?” he said. “I think it’s hot.”

He dipped his head, tasted her, felt her heat, her desire. She placed her hand on the back of his head as he began to lap at her tangy, succulent nectar. The way she writhed under him, gasped for breath as he ate her, stroked his head urgently, told him how much she needed release.

“Tell me what happened,” he urged her, nudging his nose against her clit as he forced his tongue as deep inside her as he could reach.

Madeleine groaned.

She said, “I’m not sure I’m ready just yet.”

Hugo sighed, but had to accept her right to open up when she was ready.

“I guess I walked into that,” he said.

“I promise I’ll tell you soon. Is that all right?”

“Sure.”

“So fuck me. Right now.”

Hugo took one last long deep lick along her reddened, swollen pussy lips, sopping up as much of her flavor as he could. Then he was up on his feet, helping her up from the couch, allowing her to lead him through to the bedroom where she could work on removing his clothes.

Kissing her, tasting those lips that had stretched around another man’s cock that night, as she unfastened his belt, pushed down his pants and underwear to reveal his full length. Lapping at her, fondling her exquisite breasts and those hard pink pellets pushing out from them while she stroked his erection, using both hands to feel just how hard he was for her.

Naked, she pushed him down on the bed, crawled between his legs, ran her lips and nose along his full length, breathing in his scent, feeling the softness of the skin along his shaft.

Comparing him to the cock she’d sucked on earlier that night?

She pulled herself up to straddle his lap, pressing his hardness to the soft wet flesh between her legs. She shuffled forward, and he felt the head of his cock slip inside her, his sensitive tip pulsing at the searing heat of her pussy now admitting entrance.

Hugo held her waist, looked up at her magnificent breasts as they jostled with the rhythm of her riding him, at her flushed face framed by

golden hair, adoring this sexy, confident woman she had become since they'd arrived in New York.

She gripped his forearm as he held her, as though she could keep him from running out the door now.

"You know we would have got through it if you'd told me back then something happened on your bachelorette night," he said. "Even then, you wouldn't have lost me."

"I'm sorry I didn't tell you. I just couldn't face it."

He kissed her, said: "You know, even back then, I had a funny feeling about you going on that bachelorette party. I was okay about you going on it, I was okay about not asking what went on. It felt exciting that you might be misbehaving."

"Even then?" she asked, eyebrows raised.

"I guess we were getting married, I didn't have the insecurities I had when we were only dating. So I thought it was sexy, you going on a naughty girls' night out."

"I almost told you," she said. "Lucy said I should wait until a while after the wedding. I guess I forgot about it after everything..."

"You were quite frisky after that bachelorette weekend, so I guess that was why. I remember you wanting to jump my bones every moment you could."

"I needed to reassure myself you still wanted me."

"I remember thinking how maybe I'd like it if you went on more bachelorette parties."

Hugo flashed his eyes as though tempting her to tell him more about what happened that night. He gripped her waist tighter still, pulling her on him. He took one of her hard nipples in his mouth, and suddenly she was accelerating on his lap, pumping her hips to fuck him hard, his cock becoming some kind of piston inside her tight wet pussy.

It wasn't long before she was trembling over him, an expansive orgasm blooming through her.

Hugo, though, wasn't done with her, manhandling her onto her hands and knees, lining up beside her to take her from behind. He lunged forward, forcing out her breath as he penetrated her.

As he slammed into her, his thoughts were dwelling on the picture of her with Connor's cock in her hands, in her mouth, his come pumping down her throat.

Such a wicked girl, such a sexy woman.

She cried out with the force as he exploded deep inside her, but as he was doing so, Hugo found himself imagining that it was Connor doing this, Connor penetrating Madeleine, Connor fucking her and coming inside her.

Maybe he was ready for that final step. It was going to happen.

Fourteen

With the knowledge that it was definitely about to happen—any day, any hour, any minute—Hugo spent a lot of time wondering whether he'd made the right decision to allow Madeleine the space to conduct her affair behind closed doors.

He wanted to be right there, as it was all happening, seeing the expressions on her face as she took that monumental step. He wanted to witness the surprise and the shock on her pretty face when she felt another man inside her for the first time in years. He wanted to feel the jealousy coursing through his veins as a man who made her heart skip penetrated her most intimate parts and took her to heaven and back.

He had to focus on the promise that at some point, when she was ready, she would really divulge all.

Madeleine had gone down on Connor, in the middle of a public park, and had swallowed his come. She had had permission to play with other guys for a long while now, but only now did she have the confidence and the opportunity to do whatever she wanted any time she felt like it.

She could invite him around to their apartment during a lunch break if she wanted to, while Hugo was at work. She could slip away after work, before her husband got home. She could spend her entire day off engaging in nefarious activities while her beloved was none the wiser.

Hugo did find himself checking the apartment when he got home in the evenings, to see if there were any signs that Madeleine had been entertaining while he'd been away at the office. It was even quietly exciting that he might find something—perhaps a torn condom wrapper on the carpet by the bed, a couple of coffee mugs denoting some mid-day

rendezvous, one of the mugs sporting smudge of that blazing-scarlet lipstick she wore to seduce.

There were no signs of mischief at the apartment, but the mere possibility wound Hugo up into a ball of tension and lust, fueling the fire of passion every night after that Central Park experience.

There was no question that she would be seeing Connor soon. Madeleine herself gave off the faint impression that she was now building up towards another date with her new flame that would involve more than just oral sex. There was a new nervousness about her as they made love each night—every night without fail, spurred on to new heights of passion.

Their frenzy in the bedroom each night also reassured Hugo that she wasn't losing interest in him just because she had her eyes on another.

*

Wednesday night, Madeleine said she was too tired to make love, and it set alarm bells ringing in Hugo. He didn't question it despite the fact that she'd been tired on previous nights as well, and had wanted sex.

As well as stating her tiredness before retiring, she had also reminded him she would be busy the next evening on one of her book events, and most likely back very late at night.

Hugo could hardly sleep—as far as he was concerned, it was the night before the big occasion.

While he supposed Madeleine was feeding him little white lies to give herself the time window for a full date, Hugo also fed her a few white lies of his own—starting with the late meeting he supposedly had in Newark that would mean he could have a lie-in the next morning.

The office received a different story—that he had a touch of food poisoning that day.

Staying in bed, feigning sleep while Madeleine got up ahead of him for once, meant he could keep an eye on her preparation for work. The clues continued to come thick and fast: she spent much longer in the shower than normal, in fact twice as long. He was certain it wasn't merely leg-shaving time, either.

She kept checking he was asleep as she was figuring out what to wear. Hugo did well to maintain his sleep act considering the strong emotions stirring in him.

He managed to catch glimpses of her getting dressed—saw her perfectly smooth pussy, freshly shaven and immaculate for her next date. He saw her dress in a sexy little set of bra and panties—white with elegant black polka dots and black lace frills—which were a little nice for a mere work day. Her pants were tight in all the right places, her sweater warm but highlighting the sweet curves of her chest—she looked good enough to eat.

She applied make-up and a good dose of perfume, and Hugo was seriously hard as he lay there in the bed listening and taking the occasional sneak peak.

Before she left the room, she took one last look at her husband—checking he was still asleep, he assumed—and then retrieved a small bag from the bottom drawer of her dresser, taking something out to place inside her handbag.

He played dead, of course, even when she leaned over to kiss him goodbye, whispering, “I love you.”

Hearing the front door click shut as Madeleine left for the day, Hugo wondered if there had been something more significant in that parting than just a pleasantry before she headed out for the day.

His blood ran cold as he realized it could very well be the last time he saw her before she made love to Connor—before she finally became an adulterous wife, albeit with her husband's consent.

His gentle nausea almost provided credence for the lie he'd told his company for his expected late arrival. The excitement he felt alongside it, though, was growing.

Confident he was on his own, Hugo got up and quietly opened the bottom drawer of Madeleine's dresser. He saw the little shopping bag, and hoped for a clue as to what she had taken from it to put in her purse.

The shopping bag was white, unmarked—but inside, along with some light tissue paper, was a receipt. He was on the Internet in a flash, typing in the name of the retailer and the product into Google.

Oh, he knew the name of the retailer before it even came up on his laptop browser—but he didn't know what she'd bought from it.

It turned out that she'd bought the sexiest looking lingerie set, complete with stockings and suspenders.

*

He did eventually stumble into work about 10 am, figuring it was best to spend the day actually diverting his attention elsewhere than his impending wife-sharing debut, despite his colleagues' views that if he had food poisoning, he really ought to be at home that day.

"You do look a little rough," Lowego said to him. "You know, no one will hold it against you if you were to slink off home."

"I'm okay," he said, though his stomach was doing its best to make his story hold up. "Too much to do to let a some bad shrimp get in the way."

Lowego had nodded sagely. Ray had thrown him a couple of airplane sick bags—God alone knew how he'd come by them.

He did have a fairly unproductive morning.

But as mid-afternoon rolled around, and he was none the wiser about his predicament, he decided he had nothing to lose from sending a

text to Lucy. Lucy loved all this stuff anyway, didn't she? She wasn't going to deride him for asking her what she knew.

He tried not to sound pathetic when he texted her:

> So I get the feeling the big night might be tonight. You have any inside info?

He had to wait an agonizing twenty minutes for her to reply.

> You might be right. She's spending the day with him today, so it's all probably building up to something.

She was spending the day with Connor?

He texted back:

> She told me she was working today, has another book signing event tonight.

Lucy's reply took the form of a photo, which took Hugo by surprise. It had clearly been taken by Madeleine's phone—but not by her, judging from the angle. It showed her dressed up in warm clothing, face flushed with apparent cheer and possibly exercise, as she skated along the ice at Rockefeller Center.

Madeleine looked so happy, so alive in that picture, it made Hugo burn with jealousy that he wasn't the cause of that happiness. And yet after a moment spent examining that little snap, he felt the tight grip around his heart loosen. He was the cause of that happiness—his encouragement for her to date other men had directly led to this moment.

He felt a warm glow the rest of the afternoon, thinking that she must have been having a wonderful day to look so completely jubilant as she did in that picture. It drove Hugo crazy that this new man in her life could be so obviously courting her, showing her a different side of New York—but it was a great thing that she could have such new experiences.

At the end of the working day, he was completely unsure what he was supposed to do with himself. He found himself checking out the website of Madeleine's bookstore, to find that there was supposed to be another author evening that night. So she had to be there, surely? Perhaps

she'd be there with Connor—Lucy had let slip that she had been helping him with his writing.

It was all he had to cling on to—as he got out of work, he went straight down to the bookstore, hoping to find his wife there in some capacity. Perhaps he'd be able to watch her from afar, interacting with Connor, taking him somewhere afterward.

When he got down there, though, a Champagne flute summarily thrust into his hand on the way in, to his consternation there was absolutely no sign of Madeleine or Connor.

“Oh, she's not here tonight,” said a young woman he didn't recognize, whose name badge declared her as Julie. “She'll probably be here for the next one, though.”

“She doesn't always come to these?”

“Not always—not now they're so established. She's been helping set up events in our other bookstores, too.”

“But she's not at another bookstore tonight?”

“Oh no—she had the day off today. She said she was spending the day with one of her authors, seeing the sights. Sounded absolutely divine.”

Hugo nodded, and knew that it had probably been absolutely divine—but where had the day ended up? Knowing Connor, or at least to some extent, it had probably ended up at the opera, or some glitzy party, or some other kind of glamorous event that Hugo would never have been able to take Madeleine even if he'd wanted to. And then what? A night at an expensive hotel, perhaps, getting pampered in five star luxury before ultimately succumbing to her new lover's charms, spreading her legs for him.

Would she at least tell Hugo about her experience afterward? He wasn't sure if that was the deal any more.

“I thought I might find you here.”

The voice startled him, and nearly made him drop his Champagne glass.

Lucy.

“Well, I guess I got it wrong,” he said. “She’s certainly not here.”

His wife’s best friend nodded quietly, once again giving him the impression she knew more than she was letting on about Madeleine’s whereabouts.

“She hasn’t told you much about today, then, huh?”

Hugo shook his head. “Not a thing. As far as I’m concerned it’s just another day at work for her.”

Lucy swirled her half-full Champagne glass, took a sip, calm, relaxed. Hugo could see under the surface she was itching to tell all.

“You’ve spoken to her recently?” he asked.

She took a quick glance this way and that, checking they were not overheard, and on seeing the question and answer session underway, she gave a quick flick of the head toward the exit, suggesting they take this one on the road.

Hugo put his glass down on a nearby shelf, and led her out of the store.

“She’s had a wonderful day with Connor,” Lucy said as they stepped out of the pool of light in front of the bookstore, and started out along the street in the direction of Hugo’s apartment. “Lunch at Espressione...”

“Wow.”

“Ice skating at Rockefeller—well, I sent you the picture—and a matinee showing of *Wicked* on Broadway.”

“Jesus—she loves that one, I meant to take her.” Hugo felt his insides freezing up. Madeleine was going to fall for this guy if he wasn’t careful.

Lucy hooked her arm in his as they walked. “Feeling scared yet?” she smiled. “A little nausea in the tummy?”

He nodded. “A little.”

She said, “Well, if it makes you feel any better, she called me after they got out of the show, and said what a fantastic time she’d had—but she said she was kinda scared about what came next.”

“Scared?”

Lucy shrugged. “She’s scared you’ll feel bad about this guy treating her like his queen. She’s scared that you actually really hate all this secrecy, that when Connor wants to take her back to his place for some dinner and romance, that you’ll suddenly wish none of this had ever happened.”

“She’s scared I don’t actually want this?” he asked.

“I said I’d come keep you company tonight,” Lucy squeezed his arm, “I promised her I’d make sure you were okay about this, that even though you might not know the details, you’d know generally what was going on, and if you changed your mind, I’d let her know to call things off.”

“So you’re not going to tell me the details?” Hugo asked, feeling a little disappointed.

“I told her I wasn’t going to tell you the details.”

There was a twinkle in Lucy’s eye.

“So what’s next? Where are they?”

Lucy smiled. “Connor’s cooking her dinner back at his place. He’s quite the cook, apparently.”

“Seriously?”

“Come on. We’ll be able to see them from your apartment, right?”

Hugo’s eyes widened, and his whole body seemed to heat up a few degrees. Lucy was right—if this was where everything was going to happen, they’d get the perfect view. And if Connor chose not to close his curtains—and why break the habit of a lifetime now?—he would get to see Madeleine actually take that step and give herself up to another man.

Fifteen

Lucy had thought of everything, bringing two pairs of opera glasses to enhance their viewing. They weren't the most high-powered of binoculars, but it wasn't a great distance across the street—Hugo found he could see things in phenomenal detail.

Connor was wearing another designer suit, only the jacket was on the back of a barstool and his shirt sleeves were rolled up, a cutesy apron protecting his outfit as he rustled up the meal for his date. Madeleine was perched on a stool at the brunch bar in her new man's luxurious kitchen, constantly laughing and smiling, effervescent as he regaled her with never-ending anecdotes as he gave her the kind of dinner experience you just couldn't buy at a restaurant.

Hugo bubbled and simmered with jealousy, but while he sat on the window seat opposite Lucy, he also buzzed with adrenaline and tingled with arousal, his manhood rock hard within his pants. Madeleine looked stunning, once again, in a simple smart skirt and purple blouse, her legs clad in stockings, a hint of suspenders showing from the way she was sitting, her face adorned by that devilish make-up that made Hugo's heart race.

"And she thinks I'm doing what tonight?"

"You're taking me to see the late night showing of *Rear Window at the Sunshine*, aren't you?"

"*Rear Window*? Nice." Hugo laughed. "I guess I do feel a little like Jimmy Stewart, not that I'm in a wheelchair. I just hope we don't see a murder tonight."

"I think it'll be almost the complete opposite."

When they'd first arrived back at the apartment, Hugo had felt massive relief that Connor and Madeleine were still in the middle of

dinner. It meant he hadn't missed anything. Lucy had handed him the plastic spyglasses she'd swiped from some opera or other, and they had kept the apartment lights very firmly off.

Sitting on the window seat, they were both pressed themselves back against the wall either side of the windows, to minimize the chances of being spotted by anyone on the other side of the street. Even so, Hugo felt a little jumpy—even fearful—when Lucy opened the refrigerator to retrieve a chilled bottle of Sauvignon Blanc, and the light from inside had blazed out into the rest of the room.

He felt a little funny sneaking around his own apartment—as though he didn't have the right to be there. But the important thing was not to put Madeleine off her game.

“You regretting letting her do this?” Lucy asked him. Still the journalist, still wanting to dig into the experiences of others.

“No, not at all.”

“They look good together, don't they?”

“Uh-huh. Perfect.”

The dark-haired Asian girl moved silently back to the kitchen, picking up the bottle from the counter to return and refill their glasses. The street light filtering in through the horizontal blinds cast bright lines across her, and Hugo worried that she was still quite visible. Were they both obvious to those who might look out the windows across the street?

As she refilled his glass, and then her own, pushing the alcohol on him as though to calm his nerves, he could tell that Lucy was watching him as much as the view out of the windows. Interested in the enigma that was the sharing husband, the man who desired to see his beloved wife in the arms of another man.

“How are you feeling?” she asked, her voice soft, gentle.

“Oh you know,” he said. “Butterflies taking over my stomach.”

He almost expected her to be the same old Lucy, any moment to hear her start cracking jokes, making merry about this whole thing, about

Hugo letting another man have a go at his wife. But she didn't. Lucy recognized the seriousness of this situation, the gravity. She was not going to make jokes at his expense, not that evening.

"She's really doing this, this time."

"She is," Hugo swallowed.

"And you've told her she can go as far with him as she likes."

"I told her," he said quietly, and realized he was shaking a little.

"And you're really happy about it? That she's going to fuck someone else?"

"You know how excited she is about it? How wild it's driving her?"

"Well, of course."

"Well, then. That's how I feel about her feeling that way."

He saw how she held her cell phone in one hand while she clutched the wine glass in the other. As though there was some kind of possibility that the State Governor would phone and give Hugo a last-minute reprieve.

"And she's allowed to do anything with him? Anything she likes?"

"It's up to her."

"Is she allowed to stay the night?"

"I don't know. We never talked about it. I'm not supposed to know about this, remember?" Hugo felt his stomach churning. He desperately did not want her to stay the night—not on this first time, at any rate. It would be a little too much for Hugo to abide by this early on. But it was not his place to decide.

"I guess she thinks you're taking me to the movies, and she's late after her book signing thing," Lucy said. "So she could hardly stay away all night."

"No, I guess not."

It felt deliciously wicked to see her flirting with her crush, in the apartment Hugo and his wife had both monitored so much over the months since they'd been living there. It looked so strange, so wrong.

Madeleine looking so blonde, so pretty. Like an angel in that scandalous skirt with her stockings and garter belt.

“You know we can stop this right now?” Lucy said, holding up her phone. “I promise, I won’t say another word about it if you choose to.”

He shook his head. “I’m okay. Really.”

It was reassuring to know that there was a kind of nuclear button, though. That if this all got too intense, he could have Lucy text Madeleine, or even call her. Emergency. Get out. It didn’t stop all the anxiety. What if Madeleine’s phone battery died? Or if she got too drunk?

As the dessert was dished out—some kind of impressively delicious looking tart or cheesecake—Connor sat on his own bar stool, the two of them flashing bedroom eyes at each other. Hugo felt the claw of desperation and fear encircle his heart. Through the binoculars, he could see a coltish hunger in her eyes, in her giddy smile, as she focused directly on him, batting her lashes and biting her bottom lip in a slow, exaggerated way that spoke of sex.

She’d never looked like that with Hugo. Even at her most horny, she’d never looked so sultry, so seductive, so... grown up.

God, she really was going to fuck him.

“You’re really going through with this,” he heard Lucy say, her voice a near whisper, filled with some kind of awe. Their Maid of Honor had really been expecting him to get to a point and then call time out, say the safe word, or whatever.

He turned to find her standing there behind him, surprisingly close.

“I’m really going through with it,” he said, his throat almost too dry to get any words out.

Lucy looked at him, and he looked at her, staring each other down. She really was attractive, Hugo couldn’t deny that. But the way her perfume filled his lungs only made him wonder what Connor must be

feeling having spent the day with Madeleine, and then having his invitation to take her back to his place accepted.

Lucy was breathing shallowly, and Hugo could see that she was nervous. Why on Earth should she be nervous?

“You can have me if you like,” she said quietly, taking him by complete surprise.

“I’m sorry?”

“Is that what you want? You’re letting her have Connor, so fair’s fair, right? That’s the reason you’re doing this, so she has to let you be with other women.”

“No, Lucy,” he said.

She brushed her long black hair out of her face, and gazed up at him with those big almond-shaped eyes, and he could see a slight tremor in her red lips. Her nipples were hard, pushing against the thin cotton of her shirt.

“She’d never find out,” Lucy said. “We can just text her to say she can do what she likes with Connor—she’d never know we were together.”

She put her arms over his shoulders, linking her hands together around the back of his neck, eyes focused on his.

“Lucy, I’m sorry,” he said softly. “Really—you’re so beautiful, I can’t believe the perfect guy hasn’t come along and put a ring on your finger. But—”

She flashed a part-disappointed, part-pleading look his way, insisted, “Oh, but we’d be so good together, Hugo...”

She pushed herself up on tip-toes, reaching for him, her face coming so close to his he could feel her warmth through the air—he was suddenly worried she was going to try to kiss him, cause a scene, force him to be firm with her.

But she didn’t kiss him. Seemingly at the last minute, she halted, merely touching gently against him, cheek to cheek, breathing in his

subtle cologne.

He said, "I'm sorry, Lucy..."

Then she let go of him, her hands dropping down to her sides, her face brightening up into a smile. "That was the right answer," she said, then offered him a look of clear apology. "You know she always thought you wanted me. Even told me a few times she wouldn't be so upset if you were ever tempted to a drunken kiss one day."

"You were testing me?"

Lucy shrugged. "You know, if a wife hears that her husband is all right about her fooling around with another guy, her first assumption is that her husband wants to fool around with another woman guilt-free."

"I suppose so. I told her I didn't."

Lucy nodded. "And now she knows."

He could probably have been a little annoyed at Madeleine's need to know, her strange plan to get Lucy to test his own motivations. But that was Madeleine—she needed to know everything, every little detail.

They watched, now, as Madeleine pushed her dessert away half-finished, though clearly praising her host for its quality. Then she slipped off her stool with a quiet word to Connor, and tiptoed through to the bedroom, where she continued on to the bathroom, closing the door behind her.

Freshening up for the big show.

This was really happening. He was really stepping on the edge of a precipice, about to take the mother of all cliff dives.

In the dark apartment, Lucy's cell phone suddenly announced its presence with a furious flash of light.

"It's her!" she hissed.

Hugo felt a jolt of heat surge through his chest.

But what was he afraid of? That she would finally decide to go through with it—or that she'd once again step back, unable to make the fantasy they'd imagined for so many months a reality?

“What’s she saying?”

“She’s nervous—she’s really, really nervous.”

He wasn’t sure why they were whispering. The tension in the air was electric, the fear, the excitement, the uncertainty.

Lucy said, “She wants me to bring you home from the movie theater.”

“What does that mean? I thought she wanted to do this in secret?”

“Guess she changed her mind.”

Hugo felt an unexpected warmth swamp his system. She wanted him there, at least the first time. Wanted him watching her, supporting her, excited by her. It was what he’d always wanted.

“Ask her if she really wants me to watch,” he said.

He saw Lucy’s phone display light up as she typed a text message to Madeleine. His heart was thumping hard within his chest—this was the moment where it could all finally happen, and yet the fear levels had built in both of them to the point where it could all collapse around them any minute.

Lucy said, “Yes. She wants you to watch.”

Hugo’s heart leapt, his whole body pulsed. His cock had never been harder.

Lucy added: “She wants you with her, sharing this.”

Hugo had never felt happier. It felt like choirs of angels were singing inside his chest. His whole body saturated with the kind of saccharine goodness that a thousand Hallmark card writers could not capture.

He said, “Tell her we’re here. Tell her I worked out what she was up to today. Tell her I’m watching right now.”

Lucy tapped out the message, and Hugo realized that what he had said to his wife across the street was a full green light for her to now step out of that bathroom and seduce another man, take him in her arms and between her legs.

In that moment, that was exactly what he wanted.

Lucy's phone vibrated as another text message came in, the sound making Hugo jump.

"She says she loves you," Lucy said. "She says all of this is because of you, and she says you make her the happiest woman in the world."

Hugo nodded in the darkness.

Then they both watched as Madeleine emerged from the bathroom. Hugo's heart rate picked up even further—he felt his ticker straining under his breast plate, and had a sudden sharp fear: could his body actually take this intense emotion? Had people actually had heart attacks because of strong feelings?

As she walked through the bedroom, they saw her pause, peering out of the windows as though trying to tell whether her husband was telling the truth, whether he was indeed right there watching. Hugo wondered for a moment whether he ought to do something to confirm his presence. But then the moment was past, and she was straightening herself up to re-enter the rest of the apartment, and walk back to the kitchen area in which Connor waited patiently.

God, she looked wonderful. Hugo felt burning envy now for the man who was going to have her like this—her make-up perfect in that exotic manner that was such a recent change, her hair shimmering gold since she'd had it highlighted to further draw the interested of other men, her figure trim from her visits to the gym, and well presented in that small but smart skirt and elegant purple blouse—her legs clad in wicked stockings waiting for a man's hands to wander up them towards the heaven that awaited.

Connor rose as she returned, and went to her. Hugo's breath caught as Connor pulled Madeleine to him, bringing his hands up to touch her cheeks before leaning in for a kiss.

Madeleine was smiling, kissing him back, doing nothing to stop his hands trailing down her neck, over her breasts.

Hugo felt the jealousy burning, but the excitement at seeing how Madeleine responded to his advances, the thrill imprinted in her features that this athletic godlike man was interested in her, and she was free to indulge in him if she so chose. It was the strangest experience, the stomach-churning loss of control, the cold fear, the dizzying panic that his beautiful wife was about to give herself body and soul to another man, that once this happened, there was no way back, no do-over.

“I want to check something,” he vaguely heard Lucy say, though he wasn’t paying attention to anything much on this side of the street.

He was watching Madeleine tilt her head to the side, allowing her new lover to kiss his way down her neck in the most affectionate, sensual way, his hands still gently caressing her breasts.

Through the binoculars, Hugo could see his wife’s nipples hard through the thin purple material of her blouse. The two of them were kissing again, forcefully, passionately, Madeleine’s hand now curled around the back of Connor’s head, pulling him to her. Hugo could even see glimpses of their tongues as they explored each others’ mouths.

Hands on her behind, Connor lifted her briefly, showing off his strength, making her laugh.

Then Hugo felt a hand press against his own hardness, and it made him jump.

“Sorry,” Lucy said, snatching her hand back. “But I had to know.”

“Know?” He felt stupid. Hadn’t he told her he wasn’t interested?

“I had to know how you really feel about all this,” she said. “And now I do.”

She flashed her eyes as she delivered her verdict on his response to Madeleine’s early foreplay. Hugo shook his head, quietly disapproving. She grinned.

“Madeleine’s a lucky girl,” she said looking down at the bulge in Hugo’s pants again, as though he might not get her reference. “No wonder she was confused you want her to be with another man.”

“It’s nothing to do with my size,” Hugo said.

Across the street, Connor was actually fixing them both drinks now. Madeleine was standing a yard away, watching him, following his every move, and full of giddy smiles like a schoolgirl on a date with the guy of her dreams.

Champagne, some kind of brandy, and another liqueur Hugo could not identify—it seemed to have the approval of Madeleine, who sipped it once he’d handed it to her, nodded, smiled and flashed her eyes appreciatively.

As Connor mixed the drinks, they saw Madeleine subtly toying with the cell phone she carried in her hand.

Another buzz as a text message landed.

Lucy’s voice cut through the stillness. “She wants to know if you want her to go through with this. If you’ve had any doubts at all.”

That was Madeleine—had to be sure.

He felt a wave of nausea wash over him. Through his binoculars, he could see his wife clink glasses with the Other Man—and he could see her clutching that little mobile phone tight in her hands. Waiting for Lucy’s message, waiting for the final verdict: go ahead, or come home.

Hugo dropped the binoculars, and looked at his evening’s dinner companion. His heart was pounding so loud, he wondered if she could hear it.

He said, “Tell her that I love her, and that she looks incredibly beautiful, and that I want more than anything for her to have this experience and enjoy it, and then return to me afterward so we can share it together.”

In the darkness, he heard Lucy sigh. Then she was tapping out the message, and there was no way back.

Hugo watched his wife and her prospective new lover staring into each others’ eyes, that fiery lustful look on both of their stares, as they supped on the Champagne cocktail. Then they were kissing again.

Connor fed her a strawberry, an affectionate, romantic gesture perhaps, and one that amused Madeleine. She fed him the tip of her tongue, and Hugo found himself wondering how much she'd told Connor.

He knew she was married—did he know her husband was approving of her little affair? He thought probably not at this stage.

“Should I press the send button?” Lucy said, and Hugo felt another little jolt to the heart, having assumed she'd sent her explosive text message.

This was Lucy making absolutely sure—giving him every possible chance to stop all this.

Now he found himself wondering what would happen if he did tell Madeleine to stop, to wait until the next time. What would she say to her date? It was so clear where they were headed otherwise.

The two of them seemed to be getting on like a house on fire over there, the sexual chemistry between them undeniable. Madeleine was rubbing herself up against him like an affectionate feline, her shoulder caressing his chest as he leaned in to kiss her neck and breathe in her fragrance, and she was smiling so broadly he could see the white of her teeth.

He quietly gasped as he spotted her hand on Connor's crotch, gently stroking his bulge, tracing out the shape of another man's hard cock through his jeans.

She bit her lip, showing her clear desire.

Jealousy and desire rippled through Hugo's body.

He said, his throat so dry it felt as though his tongue was rubbing up against a cheese grater, “Press it.”

Sixteen

He knew it always took a moment or two before a text message went through. Watching her leaning in to Connor, that beaming smile of hers so genuine, so thrilled, kissing him as though she was some frisky single college girl again, Hugo felt suddenly very cold.

It was happening. He'd given the go-ahead. Pressed the nuclear strike button.

Lucy was watching too, and they both saw Madeleine seductively feeding Connor a strawberry.

"You can still stop it," she said. "You know that. Any time. We can just send her another text."

"Will she even remember to monitor her phone?" He was joking really. He didn't have any intention of stopping her now.

"Of course she will. She might look as though she's enjoying herself—and I'm sure she is—but she's nervous too, remember?"

"I suppose so."

"She needs to know that if you change your mind at any point, the communication channels are open, right?" Lucy said, and Hugo felt oddly comforted at that thought.

"Sure."

Through the binoculars, he could see Madeleine eating yet another strawberry from Connor's hand, still coyly brushing her side against his chest, allowing him the occasional brief kiss, smiling at him seductively, flirtatiously—but it was getting ever more evident that the pair of them were delaying their progress. Lucy was right—she needed his consent, his constant support.

It warmed Hugo up inside, and for perhaps the first time since they'd returned to the apartment after dinner, he felt the lust and desire

inside him winning out in the battle against the fear and jealousy.

This was his gift to Madeleine. She was enjoying herself—and she was going to enjoy herself even more—because he had allowed it. Connor was simply a sex toy that Hugo was using on his wife. A sophisticated sex toy, sure, but a sex toy.

Across the street, they saw Madeleine jump slightly, and knew that Lucy's text message had finally arrived.

Hugo trained his binoculars on her face, and witnessed her eyes lighting up, her eyebrows rising, her mouth opening to draw in a sudden breath as she responded to the approval she now had for the nuclear option.

"I should go," he heard Lucy say beside him, but he could hear the curiosity in her voice, the flat tone suggesting she would stay if he wanted her to, suggesting she rather wanted to see what was going to happen.

But he shot down any idea of her staying, replying, "I suppose so."

There was a note of disappointment in her face as he turned to see her nod acceptance of the plan. Lucy stepped away, and Hugo felt the societal pressure to act the good host and at least show her to the door, though he desperately wanted to stand by the window and monitor what was going on.

"I can see myself out," she insisted, now looking at him with a certain amount of pity in her face.

Lucy hadn't experienced Madeleine under the full darkness of her depression. Oh, she'd been there as a friend the whole time, but whenever a third person had been present, whenever Madeleine had been in the company of someone other than her husband, she'd always put on a brave face. There was no way she'd ever truly understand Hugo's fundamental need for Madeleine to be happy and enjoying life, or the compersion that had developed in him as a result.

“Thanks Lucy,” he said as he ignored her and accompanied her to the door. “You have been a great support, really.”

Stepping out of the door, she nodded again. Wistful, almost.

“Remember,” she said, “any time, you can text her. You can call her. And it’ll all stop. You can text or call me if you can’t face doing that.”

Hugo leaned forward, and kissed her gently on the cheek, marveling at the softness of her skin, faintly enjoying the sweet scent of her perfume, though it made his mind wander across the street and think about how Connor must be appreciating similar aspects of Madeleine right now, and he would be able to take them forward to a full conclusion.

“I’ll be okay,” he said softly, feeling strange to be reassuring her. “It’s going to be a wild ride, and I don’t quite know how I’ll entirely feel about it, but I’ll be okay. We’ll pick up the pieces.”

“Of course.”

“And just maybe it will turn out as we all hope,” he smiled, “and the experiment will all be worth it. We’ll have this new thing that we can do, and everyone will be happy.”

Lucy nodded again, pity still there in her skeptical eyes.

“You’ll promise to tell me how it goes?” she asked. “Even if you want to leave out... you know, the details.”

“Of course.”

“And if it happens and afterwards, you don’t like it, don’t be angry with her, Hugo. It’s your fault too.”

“I know.”

Then she was gone, and the door closed on Hugo, and he was alone, standing in darkness across the street from his wife as she prepared to make love to another man.

Seventeen

They were still in the kitchen when Hugo returned to the windows, picked up his binoculars again. Connor was behind her, with Madeleine in his arms, kissing her neck as she grinned like someone who had just received the best birthday present ever.

Part of Hugo felt gently disappointed that his wife didn't appear to be even more nervous, but he could see she was suppressing her anxiety as Connor now slipped open her blouse to reveal her startlingly bare breasts.

She wanted this, but she was frightened, too. It gave her an added frisson of desirability that ignited Hugo as he watched her.

God, she'd purposefully neglected to wear a bra on her date. Her breasts looked magnificent as she leaned back against her new lover's shoulder and kissed him again, her hand reaching for the back of his neck, her tongue slipping in between his lips. His hands fell over them, concealing them as he caressed them, teased her stiff nipples.

She turned, and bit her lip as her hand spread all over Connor's bulge again, and as the tan-skinned god gently kissed the back of her neck, she pulled his strong hand down to press between her thighs, touching her there for the first time, making Hugo wonder if she'd foregone panties as well.

Connor led her toward the bedroom, and Hugo found himself becoming frantic with worry again.

Connor and a flushed Madeleine pushed through into the bedroom, which was already lit with warm, gentle lighting that seemed perfectly designed for seduction. Hugo saw Madeleine sit down on the edge of the bed, and expected Connor to shove her back, rip down his pants, take her right there and then. He didn't. He excused himself to the restroom.

Hugo jumped as his phone vibrated.

Pulling it out of his pocket, the light from the screen suddenly seemed too bright in an apartment lit only by the streetlight filtering in through those blinds.

A text from Madeleine. Hugo's heart skipped a beat.

> Are you watching sweetie?

He smiled, his insides filling with a wonderful warmth. She hadn't forgotten about him. Even now, moments before a bronzed, athletic Adonis was to take her to heaven and back, she was thinking about Hugo.

He took a brief look into the binoculars, and caught a glimpse of Madeleine looking across the street toward him.

He texted back:

> Every moment. You look so beautiful, honey. He's a lucky guy. And I'm a lucky guy, too :)

The text message seemed to go through more quickly this time than when Lucy had texted her. He hit the send button, waited a heartbeat or three, and then saw Madeleine gaze at her phone, a wonderfully contented smile spreading across her pretty face.

I made that smile, he thought to himself. It was a smile that spoke of her reassurance, that she was supported, that her desire for this new man was being nurtured by her true love without risk of offending or horrifying him.

Another text came through to Hugo's phone:

> I love you so much. You're the most wonderful person I ever met. I thank my lucky stars every day that you're mine.

Hugo was basking in that comment from her, and as normal with any complement she ever paid him, he had no idea how to respond, but while he paused trying to come up with something, she sent him another text:

> Take your clothes off, sweetie. I want to know you're with me. You're part of this. I want to make you come as you watch.

Hugo stiffened, his heart rate picking up again.

He liked that thought from her—he was part of this. It was just that she was over there being unfaithful to him: this was almost a threesome. She was playing with Connor while in the full knowledge that Hugo was watching and enjoying her.

He wrestled to tear off his clothes as quickly as he could before snatching up his phone again.

> I've taken them off. I'm so hard watching you, honey. You're so gorgeous.

He made himself comfortable on the window seat, in the very same position Madeleine had taken so many times to watch the apartment across the street. Then he curled his fingers around his rigid shaft and went back to watching her.

She smiled as Connor returned, glancing into her phone one last time as though she'd been playing Candy Crush while waiting for him to finish up in the bathroom.

Then, Madeleine rose to put her arms around her new boyfriend, and Hugo held his breath.

*

It seemed so unreal that she was over there. They'd both watched Connor's apartment so much, and yet here was the familiar sight of Madeleine in that environment, seemingly incongruous in that place.

He watched as Madeleine pinned her new lover to the wall opposite the bed, both hands on his face as she kissed him. Her body seemed to melt into his as his strong hands hauled up the hem of her skirt, revealing the smooth roundness of her shapely buttocks, and those wicked stockings and suspenders.

They were not wasting time.

They moved so well together, so sensually, it was shocking to Hugo. It was so horrifically wrong—and yet so stunningly beautiful at the same time.

She giggled as he massaged her behind, and Hugo could see her run both hands down his chest, his thighs, and up to rub his crotch. She was on fire, her eyes so wide, so alive, her face full of energy, full of life.

Connor stooped, curled his arm under her butt, and suddenly lifted her. She responded with a surprised exclamation, but wrapped her legs around his waist as he turned her, leaning her back against the wall, taking control.

She had that beaming wide smile plastered across her face as he slipped her blouse open again, and then off her shoulders, allowing it to fall to the floor before he buried his face in her breasts, holding her tight in his arms as his hungry mouth found her hard nipples. She held him tight with both hands behind his neck as he licked her sensitive buds.

She pushed him down, back, so she could kneel before him, groping at his fly, grinning as she unzipped him, as though she were now opening that world's-best-birthday-present.

Down came Connor's pants, and both Madeleine's hands were around his huge cock.

It really did look strange, as hairless as it was. As the man unfastened his shirt buttons, Hugo could see that it went all the way up—not a hair on his bronzed body from the neck down.

Madeleine planted gentle kisses around his abdomen as her fingers curled around that bare shaft.

It looked so obscene to Hugo, but having had some preparation for this, his feelings of jealousy had dissolved into a low simmer. Madeleine pumped him a few times, taking in Connor's shape with her fingers, looking up at her new lover with that wide smile.

She stretched her lips around his tip, sliding him inside her mouth, tasting him, her tongue snaking around the head.

Hugo felt his own hardness throb in his hands in response, almost as though his pretty wife was now sucking on his own cock, not that of a relative stranger standing there across the street in another apartment.

He watched as she hungrily swallowed him up, her head sinking down on that impossibly large shaft, his manhood completely filling her mouth.

She worshipped him, using her cheeks, her lips, her nose to caress his shaft in the moments she did not have him inside her, rubbing him over as much of her skin as possible, marking herself with his scent, his presence. Adoring this strange experience of another cock.

And Hugo felt so strangely connected, so that he could almost experience what the other man was experiencing. His memories of having Madeleine performing this on him merged with what he was seeing, meaning he wasn't quite so detached from the scene across the street.

It seemed the two men in Madeleine's life both had to control themselves lest they bring a premature end to the evening—as Hugo found himself holding himself back, careful not to lose it to the searing sight of his wife with her mouth full of another man's cock, Connor also seemed to find himself in danger of ignition.

Hugo saw him usher Madeleine up onto her feet again, where they resumed their frantic kissing, only this time with Connor pressing his erect shaft against her, his clothes now a distant memory.

Hugo watched as this other man, a man he had never met, slipped his hand between Madeleine's thighs, pushing up her skirt, cupping her mound, though her little black panties stood in the way.

She must have been so wet. Wetter, probably, than she'd ever been with Hugo. She was effectively making love to two men right now.

Connor guided her back on the bed, and Hugo found his breathing deepening, his heart-rate quickening.

But it wasn't yet time for that ultimate act of extramarital liberation. As she lay back on the bed, Connor pushed up her skirt again to reveal those shockingly adult-looking stockings and suspenders, which leant her legs an almost magical eroticism. Madeleine was saying something that Hugo wished he could hear, while her new lover swept one hand up her thigh, to glide over her mound.

He caressed her as they talked, and Hugo found it almost impossible to believe that straight-laced Madeleine, with whom he'd had so much difficulty in the past discussing anything involving sex, was now letting another man grope her pussy as they talked about something that had to be at least sex-related.

She was all smiles, one semi-raised eyebrow suggesting the risqué nature of their conversation. It made Hugo slightly envious that she could apparently talk about something personal and erotic while with this other man, yet it had always been so difficult doing similar with her husband.

Connor began kissing his way along her inner thigh, and Madeleine opened her legs for him wider still.

Hugo found curiosity again overtaking any feelings of envy or jealousy as the man nudged up against her panties, and began caressing her through the thin black fabric, kissing her, inhaling her devilish scent in deep and very obvious breaths.

Those panties had to be dripping wet by now.

His wife seemed euphoric as the younger man reached for her waistband, and she lifted her hips to help him slide her underwear down past her behind, over her thighs, past her knees and away.

Hugo stiffened further at the startling sight of his wife's bare pussy, shaved completely clear. She was stunningly beautiful, whichever way she tended it, but now it was so different from the norm, and it was so

clear how much trouble she'd taken to prepare it for this other man. It shocked and delighted Hugo.

Connor also seemed to approve, and whatever he said to her made her faintly blush and respond with a bashful smile.

Connor slowed his pace to a crawl as he returned to her smooth inner thigh, and accompanied his approach with more little kisses, building up to his arrival at that smooth, pretty little pink pussy.

He was so slow, so patient, working her with soft kisses around her clit and her pussy lips, only occasionally venturing directly to her little sensitive button, though he clearly could not refrain from slipping his tongue deep into her slick groove, to taste the profuse moisture of her arousal.

Madeleine had that little crease in her forehead just between her eyebrows, which told Hugo she was in pure ecstasy. Breathing deeply, for the most part she closed her eyes to cope with the forceful sensations flowing through her body, even tilting her head back as Connor continued to feast on her.

Hugo wished he could hear her moans. It was one of the key disadvantages of watching them from so far. However, as the other man took her to heaven, the sheer joy was imprinted in every strain on her face, every gasping breath, every toss of her head.

And then as she mouthed the words: "Oh my God" over and over, Hugo could tell how she felt—this was all about giving her a thrilling experience, and the fact it was clearly a thrill for her made Hugo feel incredible.

Yet when her first peak was over, and Connor propped himself up on his arms to kiss a beaming Madeleine on the lips again, and then she pulled him up by his shirt collar to roll over her and onto the bed, Hugo found himself becoming intensely nervous again.

Connor lay on his back across the bed, removing his shirt as Madeleine knelt by him, and took his hard cock in her hands. She stroked

him, saying something to him.

Connor reached under one pillow, so casual it had to speak volumes about his own promiscuous lifestyle, and there in his hand was a condom, which he held up for Madeleine's approval.

Hugo caught his breath.

This was it. Hugo knew he could stop it—he could call her, he could text her, he could even flash the apartment lights on and off desperately if he wanted to.

But there was something so very sexy about the thought of Madeleine having an extramarital affair.

His Madeleine, so hot she had other men quivering in her wake, so fiery she couldn't be satiated by a single guy. Sliding another man's hard cock into her mouth, lubricating it so she could roll down that thin latex sheath, which would make it all okay for this man, this stranger, to sink his cock inside her tight, wet, married pussy.

Oh God, there it was.

With him in her hands, Madeleine suddenly turned her head and gazed out across the street. Hugo swallowed, though his throat was too dry to swallow anything. This was it.

His cock stiffened as Hugo sat still, waiting. Knowing that if this didn't happen now, it might not happen at all.

Hugo tried to control his breathing, tried to keep calm. One beat, two beats, three beats... Madeleine gave a little nod, and then she lifted her leg over him, straddling Connor, still wearing her smart little skirt.

His hands were shaking so much it was difficult to see through the binoculars—but he needed to. He could watch well enough without, but right now he needed to see those details. He needed to see her edge up his thighs, positioning herself over the man's hips. He needed to see that little wiggle of her behind as her pussy touched down on his frighteningly erect manhood.

They were lying across the bed, which gave Hugo prime view of his wife's pert rear as she held her skirt up around her waist. He saw Connor's hands gripping her round cheeks, he saw Madeleine's hair falling in golden waves down her back. He saw her position that big, hard cock at her slick entrance.

He couldn't see their faces, either of them. But in that moment, that one-way, no-do-overs moment, his focus was on that one place where man and woman became one, where the most personal parts of Madeleine and Connor touched and then joined, the tip of another man's cock slipping inside Hugo's wife.

All doubt and uncertainty vanished as Connor entered her.

In the eyes of the law, Madeleine was now an adulteress.

Eighteen

All the nerves, all the uncertainty, all the cold clammy hands and gasping for breath along this whole epic journey ever since Madeleine had first revealed that innocent little kiss with her boss—it all felt like it culminated in this moment.

And yet Hugo felt fine.

Madeleine sank slowly down on Connor—the man had his full length inside her, filling her. Hugo felt fine, better than fine. He felt incredible. He thought he'd never forget how deeply she melted when her new lover sank his cock into her bare pussy for the first time.

What was most surprising to Hugo was the sudden lightening he felt, the pressure quickly evaporating from his shoulders as he watched her. He'd had hints of it along the way, him unburdening his guilt as he watched Madeleine having fun, going one step further. He'd even felt it disappear entirely on brief occasions when she had him believing she'd finally slept with someone else. Yet here as he saw his beautiful wife having her wicked way with a younger man across the street, something that could not possibly be faked in any way, the guilt had boiled away in an instant.

Madeleine looked spectacular rising and falling on that powerful shaft, her flaxen locks shimmering as she rose and fell on him, her body undulating so gracefully, her legs squeezing around his thighs.

She leaned forward on Connor, pushing out her butt, giving her husband such an exposed view, he was quite transfixed. Could either of them have thought when they first came to New York that one day, she would actually have another guy's cock penetrating her like this? Sliding in and out, stretching her.

She pulled her skirt off and away.

They were laughing, Connor lifting her, rolling her, wrestling with her. Hugo could see their faces as they moved around the bed, playing, play-fighting, tussling. Madeleine was clearly having fun, fantastic fun. Connor was clearly enamored.

Madeleine lined up on all fours, facing down the bed, side on to the windows and her husband's gaze. She swung her hair out of her face, dropped down onto her elbows, presented her rear for her new lover's use, her position emphasizing the sensual curves of her body.

He saw her glance back, offer that sideways look and seductive smile that invited him to penetrate her again, fuck her, violate her.

Connor needed little encouragement to kneel between her legs, line himself up behind her, one hand gripping her hip as the other guided his huge phallus back to her awaiting sex.

Hugo caught his breath as he saw his wife's mouth open impossibly wide as she responded to the other man's cock squeezing back inside her. Sucking in her breath through her teeth as he moved within her tight wet pussy, pushing herself up on her hands so she could look over her shoulder at him, check his response.

He saw her looking out of the windows as the toned, tanned Adonis began pumping her. She was looking out at the street, across the street. She was looking up into Hugo's eyes.

Could she see him? She knew he was there. Could she see him sitting in the window, his naked form highlighted only by the light from the street?

It appeared almost as though she could. Through the binoculars, he saw her giving him a fiery look, and then she was licking her lips in clear indication of how delicious it was to be fucked hard by another man while her loving husband looked on in blissful consent.

She knelt up while he was still inside her, leaning back to kiss him. They looked so good together, a truly beautiful couple.

Watching her taking it from behind made it all seem so animalistic. That big pole disappearing into her rear, the pale doe being taken by a magnificent golden stag, rocking back and forth against him as he pumped into her, her mouth opening wide to suck in oxygen as she coped with the forceful feelings from his hard fucking.

Hugo had never wanted her so badly. He felt a rush of testosterone swamp his body. He felt strong, powerful, felt like knocking Connor out of the way, seizing hold of the vulnerable female, taking her by force.

It was like taking some kind of drug—a pure hit of adrenaline.

But he had to be patient. Madeleine seemed to be building to what had to be a powerful orgasm, crying out as Connor pounded her from the rear. Then she was shaking, trembling, and Hugo felt a familiar pulse of acidic jealousy ripple through him. Another man had made her come.

Connor continued to pump into her, and Hugo wondered if this was the road to his orgasm as well.

He pulled out of her and peeled the condom off, leaving that beast of a cock bare, uncontrolled, dangerous. It shocked Hugo, making him fear immediately that this young man was going to sink back inside Madeleine without protection.

But he didn't slip back inside her. He stepped up off the bed, and Madeleine turned to face him, sitting on the bottom edge of the bed, once again side on to her watching husband.

He saw through those powerful lenses his wife's hand curl around her lover's rigid shaft once again. She kissed the tip of his shiny head.

As he stood there in front of her, Madeleine cupped her breasts, fondling herself, teasing those stiff nipples, offering a show for her new lover as he gripped his staff and pumped.

Madeleine was saying something, which Hugo could not hear, but then she was closing her eyes, and her strong powerful lover was erupting, thick strings of white come shooting from his cock to splash over the blonde's pretty neck and her upper chest.

Another man's come all over her.

She grinned, taking hold of his erect cock herself for the last few moments, rubbing it against her chest, her neck, all over that beautiful smooth skin of hers as though she was using it to apply perfume.

Hugo could so easily have lost control in that moment, following Connor's example in letting go as Madeleine sat there and played with her breasts. But he didn't.

He was going to wait for her to come home.

*

She lay there with her new lover for what seemed like an age. For Hugo, it was almost as bad on his nerves as those moments leading up to penetration.

They hadn't ever put together any kind of an exit strategy for one of her encounters, he now realized. He'd never even really thought about it. They'd never talked about how long she should stay once the deed was done, whether she might want to stay for a second round or more. Whether she might want to stay overnight. Hugo hadn't wanted to be too prescriptive in how an evening would go, it was for her to decide. There was no point in rushing her. She wouldn't enjoy it if she knew there was a schedule to stick to.

Nevertheless, now it was actually happening, he regretted the uncertainty of when she might return to him.

Hugo went to get a glass of water from the kitchen to cool himself down, and perhaps calm himself down.

He knew she had to be polite, had to spend a fair amount of time with her lover after the fact. But after the intense emotions of the evening, his mind could wander into some intensely dark places. Sipping the water as he slowly wandered back to the windows, he knew it was unreasonable to expect that as soon as her new lover had come, she

should be slinking back into her clothes, before scampering back across the street to be with her husband.

But the jealousy he now felt was for the affectionate way she lay with him there on the bed, one leg draped over his, gently caressing that impossibly hard torso of his. She looked at him with the kind of bedroom eyes she hadn't used on her husband for years.

What were they saying to each other while gazing into each other's eyes like that? Smiling, laughing, sharing precious time.

Connor reached over to the bedside table, retrieving something that Hugo couldn't quite identify with his hands shaking slightly as he held the binoculars. He handed something to Madeleine. Ducked his head.

He was smoking a cigarette in bed—and, to Hugo's surprise, so was Madeleine.

It was the second time he'd seen her doing it in Connor's company—what was her intention? She'd always given Hugo the impression she'd never smoked a cigarette in her life.

For some reason, it seemed interesting to Hugo that either Connor had persuaded her to do something so out of character, or she was doing it to fit in with him. It emphasized the difference compared to her married life.

But the thought that now haunted him was that this cozy post-coitus cigarette would keep her over there with Connor until they were ready to go again. Maybe that would leave her so tired she'd just collapse asleep with the guy. And then they'd wake up in the morning like a real couple, and Madeleine would get the idea that this womanizing lothario could love her, could settle down with her, a completely upgraded model of soul mate.

Hugo stepped away from the window, and padded through to the bedroom and the en suite bathroom, where he knew a hot shower might not entirely soothe his nerves, but might provide some distraction.

He left them to it, stepped under the gloriously warm stream of water, scrubbed off the sweat of an evening's anticipation and serious arousal. Well, at least if Madeleine did make the return journey that night, she would find a fresh, clean husband waiting for her.

Afterwards, stepping out of the shower, he was calm enough to even start making the assumption that his pretty wife would be spending the night in the bed of another man. His phone was blinking to announce that there was an unread text message waiting for him, and he presumed it would state her decision not to be home until the morning.

It didn't.

> Hey sweetie, you still with me? Can't wait to come home and see you.

He smiled broadly, almost as broadly as Madeleine had been all night in the arms of her new lover. Drying off, he mentally composed his reply before tapping it out on the little smartphone.

> Still with you, honey. That was incredible! What a turn on. Can't wait to see you, either. You planning on staying the night, or should I wait up?

He added that last little question as both emphasizing the fact that it was her choice how she wanted to conclude her date with Connor, but also in the hope of assuaging that little question mark that lingered in Hugo's thoughts.

> Oh I can't wait until the morning, not after that! I'll be home very soon. Hope you didn't put any clothes on.

Nineteen

She was standing out in the hallway, like a vampire asking permission to come in. Only in this case, it was as though she was asking his consent to return to their marriage.

For a moment he just breathed and indulged in the sight of her standing there, lipstick smeared, hair mussed, clothes creased.

Nipples hard as pebbles.

She looked anxious, smiling in that uncertain manner that posed a question, rather than really conveying happiness. Saying to him in that one expression: do you still love me? Do you forgive me? Did you like what happened? Do you still want me?

“Hey,” he said, trying to act calm, assured, strong.

“Hey,” she replied, trying to mimic his understated tone.

“So that happened.”

“I guess so.”

“Do you still love me?”

“More than ever.”

Then he was hardly thinking about what he was doing, his instincts seeming to take over, driving him to drag her inside the apartment, almost slam the front door shut, frantic in his pace and desperate in his desire to reclaim her as his own.

They didn’t even make it to the couch, let alone the bedroom, before he was all over her, pulling her to him, kissing her mouth passionately.

Oh God, she smelled of cigarette smoke. She smelled of sex. She smelled of another man. Of sharp, feminine perfume attempting to cover up that earthy odor of transgression, the musty scent of her juices combined with his, the faint brandy-like hint of cologne from a rival suitor.

Hard evidence that there had been no illusion: Madeleine had made love to another man right in front of her husband's gaze.

Along with the messed-up make-up, the wrinkled dress, it made Madeleine look so wonderfully sexy, so gloriously insatiable—so powerfully female.

"I need a shower," she protested, out of breath as a ravenous Hugo hauled up the hem of her dress to find her wearing no underwear whatsoever. Where were her panties? On the other man's floor?

He kissed her, hands sweeping over the curves of her beautifully round behind, tracing out memories of another man toying with these very same curves, violating them with his touch, his mouth, his cock.

"I'll help you... undress..." he said of her request for a shower, and he had to admit he was surprised at himself that he wasn't grossed out by the fact that she'd just had sex with someone else, that she hadn't cleaned off all lingering traces.

He kissed her neck, running his eager lips down to her upper chest, breathing in that strange scent of perfume mixed with something else—lingering traces of another man's come.

How was he not completely freaked out by it?

Somehow, it only drove him on into more of a blood-lust, to pull off her blouse, to drag the thin stained material down over her poised cleavage, freeing those bounteous breasts over which a younger man had sprayed his semen.

"It was what you wanted, then?" she asked. "Watching him?"

She curled her fingers around his hard cock, giving him a little affectionate squeeze as though his hardness confirmed his complete enjoyment and acceptance of her adventure across the street.

Hugo almost swallowed her hard nipples, he was so hungry for her.

"It was the most incredible thing I ever saw."

She pulled him up to kiss his mouth again, and mouthed "I love you" to him. He could see her eyes tearing up, so many emotions jostling

inside her.

He smiled warmly, said clearly, “I’ll never stop loving you, honey. Never forget that.”

Pushing his tongue into her mouth, tasting faint traces that were not the usual Madeleine flavor, which only reminded him how Connor had stretched her lips with his huge cock.

“Tell me,” he breathed. “Tell me how it was for you.”

He lifted her skirt and ran his hand gently up her inner thigh, brushing over her pussy, hardly touching her though he felt her immense wetness, the incredible response she’d had to the experience of straying.

“It was absolutely crazy,” she said. “Unbelievable.”

He kissed her again, slipped his tongue in her mouth, tasting the strangeness. Hugo found himself sinking to his knees, needing to worship her, craving some form of adoration in recognition of her incredible courage and wonderful insatiability.

“No...” she moaned quietly as he explored her abdomen, her mound, her upper thighs with his kisses, inhaling the thick scent of her arousal and the pungent aftermath of her infidelity as he brushed his nose over her smooth, gently clammy skin. Her pale flesh showed the signs of being handled by someone else—not actual bruises, but redness here and there, her nipples a little puffy, her pussy flushed and puffy from use. So sexy. So unbelievably sexy.

“I need a shower,” she insisted, tilting up his face to gaze in his eyes.

“Eventually,” he nodded, and saw the shock as his response registered in her eyes—before the shock turned into a ripple of mischievous lust.

He heard her suck in a sharp breath as his kiss arrived at her sex, his hot mouth connecting with her sensitive, tender folds, his nose crushing against her clit.

She even lifted her leg for him, resting her thigh on his shoulder, allowing him access.

“You like it?”

“I can smell him on you,” he said, a whisper of awe as he tasted that complex flavor of her juices, seasoned by the lingering traces of lubrication from the condom another man had worn to penetrate her.

One hand steadying her, clamped to the back of the couch, Madeleine’s other hand now rested on his scalp, gently but firmly pulling him to her, encouraging him, signaling her growing confidence that this was what her husband wanted, to connect with her, engage with her, bathe his senses in her as part of his process of reclaiming her.

“Tell me... tell me what it was like,” he pleaded with her.

She looked down, beaming at him, adoring him, wondering at how she could have ended up with such a man.

“I felt so... powerful,” she said, casually circling her hips to rub herself over his face. “I can’t really explain it. I guess I was making him feel good—but at the same time I knew I had to be driving you totally crazy.”

“You were so beautiful,” Hugo said.

“I was so nervous,” she smiled. “I felt a little sick before it all happened, before I got into it.”

She saw his disappointment as she stopped him, but the hard wooden floor was giving him pins and needles already, and wouldn’t be forgiving on his knees for much longer. Still, he allowed himself to be led through to the bedroom, pushed back on the bed.

“You did enjoy it?” he asked.

“Oh God yes. Such a feeling of power to know that he wanted me, that someone other than my husband—and someone so totally gorgeous—wanted me. And he’s in such great shape—and he got so hard so quickly.”

“That was your doing. Did you talk about the next date?”

“We did.”

Hugo swallowed involuntarily. The next date. Should he, as husband, be regulating her time with this other guy? What if too much time with him in a short period meant she ended up getting hooked? He had to breathe deeply, calm himself down. See it as a positive that this other guy couldn't get enough of his wife, had to see her again pronto.

“I won't go if you don't want me to,” she said, but smiled as she saw him give a slight shake of his head, the nervous exhilaration imprinted in his eyes.

Feeding off that nervous energy, and her own excitement at a repeat visit with Connor, Madeleine climbed onto the bed, crawling up his body like a panther on the prowl.

“Were you jealous, honey?” she asked him, and then kissed him. “I can't believe you watched.”

He groaned as she kissed him, and he remembered where her mouth had been earlier that evening.

“I was terrified,” he said, his hands sprawling over her butt, trying to get under that skirt. “And turned on like never before.”

She smiled, the smile of an achiever.

Then she shifted one knee further up his body, then the other, and then over his shoulder so that her sex was right there, just inches from his face. He could smell her arousal, and even as she lowered herself, her hot wet flesh touching down on his lips, he was already intoxicated by her.

“You watched me kissing him?” she said, and the jealousy burned in his chest, matching his excitement. “You saw me sucking his cock?”

He nodded under her, but did not break contact with her slippery folds.

“You saw him fucking my face?” she said, now fucking his. “It was so amazing holding that big hard cock. Licking it, tasting it, stuffing it in my mouth—I was so wet.”

Hugo found his hands wandering down to close around the hardness bobbing up from his loins. He was going to have to keep calm if he wanted this to extend.

“He licked my pussy,” she said. “Just like you’re doing now. It felt so good—he wanted to do it, even though he had no reason to.”

“He had every reason to, honey,” Hugo piped up from between her thighs, his face slick with her juices, his voice breathless. “I could tell from watching. I wished it was me, but it was so hot watching you.”

She smiled, brushed the golden locks out of her face. “I took so long rolling that condom down his cock—I wanted to make sure you had plenty of time to stop me, you know, turn on the lights over here, or text me or something.”

“It was pretty intense.”

His hands gripped her waist, and hers were running up and down his forearms as she writhed on top of him, indulging in the sensation of his face wedged between her thighs.

“Oh I missed this,” she said as at last she sat back, butt touching down between his thighs, her hands gripping her husband’s hard cock.

“You know he wasn’t any bigger than you, sweetie. Just different.”

“He looked big.”

“Not compared to you.”

She crouched, then she was up, turning around, onto her hands and knees, presenting her rear to him. It was a good position from which to finally reclaim her, sliding into her without having to make use of a condom—his bare cock filling her, stretching her.

He wasn’t normally a rough man in bed, but this time he had to fuck her, not make love. He had to claim her as his own, plunge into her, force out the gasps of breath, the deep moans as she took it all, bouncing her hips back against him to add to the force of his thrusting.

“Take me, Hugo,” she hissed as he pounded her. “Come in me. Make me yours...”

That first time, it didn't take long until he was coming inside her, his seed hot and furious and full of power, his victory complete since he did not have to pull out, he could take it to its full conclusion.

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After that first time, they both drifted off to sleep in each other's arms, shattered by the experience.

Later, though, Hugo awoke with the most wonderful feeling of warmth in his loins, only to find Madeleine lying between his thighs, stroking his semi-hard cock as she sucked on its tip.

"Hey," she said, flashing him a brilliant, adoring smile.

"Couldn't sleep?" he grinned in return.

"Not really," she said, squeezing the base of his shaft now as he attained full waking hardness. "I guess it was such an unbelievable experience tonight, I just can't fully wind down."

Oh, she felt divine. She looked divine in the half light filtering in through the blinds, her full lips stretching around his girth.

He said, "It's been a big night. It's something you've been dreaming about doing for months—ever since we came to New York."

"Almost," she said, giving him a lick, an expression on her face that was almost apologetic. "Is that terrible of me?"

He shook his head. "I like finding out about your fantasies, what you think about that turns you on," he said. "I just wish I'd had the courage to ask you about it before. Years ago."

"You like it?"

"It's pretty hot, knowing what fires you up, honey."

"This fires me up," she said, ducking her head down to take as much of his cock inside her as she could. Then she was pulling him back out, licking him, pushing herself up and stroking him against her breasts

and her hard nipples. She added, “You know I’d always be happy with this toy alone?”

Hugo chuckled. “I guess so. But isn’t it fun knowing you can play with other toys as well?”

She grinned, sucked on him briefly again, then slipped his shaft between her breasts, something she’d never done before. It was strange, but felt nice—her skin, her cleavage so soft and warm around him.

“And you’re really okay with me... playing with other toys?” she asked him. “With what happened tonight?”

“It was incredible. I wouldn’t have wanted it any other way.”

“It didn’t hurt? Seeing me with someone else like that?” Her voice was still cagey, cautious. Ever watchful in case this whole thing blew up in their faces.

“There was a little... well, I wouldn’t call it pain,” he said. “It was pleasurable, you see? Like food that’s really spicy.”

Madeleine grinned, “You think I’m spicy?”

He sat up, pulled her to him, grabbing her waist, kissing her mouth with forceful passion. A mouth that had gone down on another man, and would do so again, but that was still his.

“I think you’re very spicy,” he said. “And you know how bland things can be if you don’t have enough spice.”

He held her, and then he rolled her, and then he was between her legs, hungry for her spice, teasing her lips with little nips and nibbles, slipping his tongue inside her slippery groove, tasting that beautifully smooth shaven pussy that had taken two men that night, two big cocks to stretch it and pound it.

“Oh God...” she breathed as he slipped a finger inside her, but she wanted to ask him more, so she forced herself to avoid being distracted. Asked him: “But you do enjoy that... pain... then? Feeling jealous like that?”

“I suppose so. But it’s more complicated than that—it’s all part of the experience, and the main thing is seeing how beautiful you are, how incredible it is to watch you being sexual. On your own it’s intense enough—but to see you experiencing that powerful sensation of taking a new lover. That was unbelievable.”

“It was pretty intense from my perspective,” Madeleine smiled, and he saw that she was blushing slightly, and it wasn’t simply from his gentle sucking on her clit.

He nudged his chin into her sensitive little button, and said: “It’s been amazing to watch you recognize that guys around you are all crazy for you. Amazing to see you become this confident, sexy seductress.”

She smiled, but said nothing to his complement.

Then he said sharply, “Did you seriously ask Lucy to try to seduce me?”

She gave him an odd look, but then her face relaxed into another smile as she realized what he was talking about.

“That was just a little test,” she said. “Lucy suggested it, actually. She couldn’t really believe this whole thing wasn’t one great manipulation to get me to allow you to sleep around. I guess I didn’t believe it to start with, either.”

“You’re not still worried?”

“I mean, I guess it’s probably a little unreasonable now, isn’t it? Expecting you to be faithful only to me. After what happened.”

“Of course it’s reasonable. I’m being faithful to you because you’re being faithful to me. I’ve told you I like the idea of you playing with other men, maybe even having an affair I don’t know about, although I’d always want you to open up eventually.”

“I suppose.”

“So what would you have done if I’d said yes to Lucy? Called it all off?”

Madeleine looked faintly puzzled at that, as though she hadn't actually thought through the full ramifications of her fidelity test.

"I think as soon as you said yes to her, Lucy would have shot you down," she said after a pause. "And if she didn't... well, I guess at least it's only Lucy. I could probably forgive you eventually."

Hugo couldn't help but laugh at how badly thought out Madeleine's little test was, but he could appreciate that she had that major concern, that he might want an easy route out of their marriage for some reason, and setting her up for a fall would push blame her way.

"If she'd texted you that I'd gone for it, would you have stopped with Connor?" he asked her.

She thought for a moment. "I'm not sure. I might have. It probably would have been pretty disappointing."

"Disappointing?"

She nodded. "I guess when I was with Connor, part of the turn-on was knowing you were there watching, and getting off on watching me. Wouldn't have been the same if I'd known you had other motivations."

Hugo moved up beside her, continuing to penetrate her with his fingers as he closed in to kiss her mouth again. She was so hot, panting as he coaxed her, so sexy in the low light, her body offering a faint sheen of perspiration, her soft skin glowing with her exertions, her thick, long blonde hair all wavy and messy, falling from her head like a wild waterfall.

She sucked on his lips, on his tongue, and he was as ever surprised that it seemed to excite her to taste herself on his mouth.

"Does he know?" the question came out as soon as it formed in his head. "Does he know you're married?"

"Connor? I never took off my ring, even when he was flirting with me in the bookstore," she said. "He was asking about you last night, actually. I said you were okay about me... you know, spending time with him."

“You did?”

“I actually think he thought you were an interesting guy because of that.”

Hugo smiled. “You tell him I was watching?”

She shook her head. “I might tell him some time. Might not.”

Hugo rose up on his knees between her thighs now, unable to hold back any longer. He lined up his cock, its tip touching down to her soaking folds, then he speared her, loving how she stretched around him, how her eyes lit up as he slid inside her, filled her.

As he thrust into her, her entire body shook, and she was moaning, gasping, panting.

“Oh yeah... Oh my God...”

He felt that resurgent power inside him, the kind of alpha male sense that was not naturally in him most of the time, but now made him feel like an emperor, owning this beautiful woman before him, taking her, claiming her, asserting his right. Others might worship her, others might please her, others might penetrate her, but only he could be her true love.

After a while, though, she said, “I’m a little tender, honey.” And they settled down into a slower grind, indulging in their connection rather than merely reasserting it.

She said, more than a touch breathless, “So am I forgiven?”

“Forgiven?”

“For cheating on you,” she said with a wicked smile.

Hugo returned her smile. Like that, was it? He said, “I think I’ll forgive you this time.”

“Can you believe I was cheating on you? He put his big dick inside me.”

Hugo was a little surprised by the words coming out of Madeleine’s mouth—but it was hot to hear.

“Oh God... oh that feels amazing,” she breathed. “You know I was thinking about this while I was fucking him?”

“You were?”

“Wondering how hard you were, watching. Remembering how you got from just watching me on my own.”

“You’re so hot, honey. Whatever you do.”

“Oh—you’re making me hot. All hot and sweaty.”

He kissed her, then urged her up, over, onto her hands and knees. Lining up behind her for re-entry, loving those magnificent curves of hers, his hands gliding all over her rear, then up to hold her waist as he eased his way back inside her.

“Oh God...” she cried. “You’re so big. Some girls never get to have this—and I get two of them.”

“That’s right, honey.”

Pounding into her, her words trying to spur him on, even perhaps to get him to punish her with his penetration.

“So you like watching me cheat on you?”

“Sure.”

“The way he makes me come with that huge cock of his?”

“It’s what I wanted all along.”

“Fuck me, fuck me right now. Make me scream.”

He’d never come so hard as he did then, ramming her, filling her tight pussy, which quivered around him as they both reached the peak and he released himself inside her, as only he had been able to do that evening.

And Madeleine was screaming as he pushed her into the mattress, her body collapsing under him as he sewed his seed deep within her womb, and she was shaking with the sensations flaming through her body.

It almost felt like the first time again, the first time either of them had actually had sex.

Strange that it took the influence of another man bedding her to provoke such overwhelming feelings and forge so fierce and strong a bond between them.

Twenty

Come the morning, Hugo had to somehow prize himself out of bed to get to work on time.

He spent all day in a daze, memories of his pretty blonde wife interfering with his progress every step of the way. As the full reality of what had happened finally started to sink in, He found himself actually hoping that Madeleine's next date with Connor might be sooner, rather than later.

By the evening, one of Hugo's top clients had got itself in a tangle that required sudden attention—and meant he would have to stay late into the night to handle the press.

He bitterly regretted not being able to go home and check back in with Madeleine after such an eventful moment in their relationship.

Madeleine seemed bright enough when he called her, making him instantly suspicious that she'd take advantage of a free evening for another rendezvous with Connor, this time away from his view.

"Oh no, I was going to go for a few drinks with Lucy, actually," she said.

Hugo had laughed at that, mainly because he knew Lucy would have been hounding Madeleine for details of the previous night, and probably coerced her into a night out to divulge all.

"If you were going to see Connor, would you tell me?" he asked her.

"I'm not sure. I might."

"You might tell me, or you might be going out with Connor tonight?"

"I might tell you," she said.

"What happened to your fantasy of having a secret affair?"

Madeleine laughed. "It's not secret now, is it?"

“Are you sad it’s not secret?”

“No. No, I think I had enough of a connection with him already that it wasn’t weird when it finally happened.”

“All those secret lunches. And that date at the Met.”

“Lucy told me you saw us,” she said in a whisper now. “I guess I was kind of hoping you would.”

“It was wonderful, honey,” he said. “So when’s the next date?”

“I’m not sure. He’s out of town for a week or two. I guess I’ll have to distract myself with Lucy if you can’t be home.”

“Yes,” he said. “I guess you guys can practice kissing, or something like that.”

He heard Madeleine giggle. “She told you about that?”

Hugo couldn’t help but smile. “It’s not the great shocking thing you might think it is, honey,” he said. “Not these days.”

“Oh, okay.”

“Kind of hot, actually.”

“Oh,” Madeleine said, and Hugo wondered if he’d stolen a great secret from her, something that had given her a nice little hint of wickedness inside. Well, she had plenty of opportunities for other wickedness now. She said, “What time will you be home tonight?”

“Not sure. Maybe not even until the morning.” Hugo sighed.

“In that case, I might just sleep over at Lucy’s tonight,” she said. “It’s so boring getting the subway all the way back when it’s dark.”

“Okay, honey, you do that.”

“Maybe we’ll practice a little kissing.”

*

Hugo wasn’t wrong when he said his workday might run through to the morning. In fact, it ran through until Sunday morning—his client had become embroiled in something of a scandal, which no amount of public

relations gloss was going to provide an escape from damage to the reputation.

Friday night was not so bad—he liked to imagine Madeleine was having enormous fun with her best friend, chattering about the extraordinary events of her first time sleeping with Connor.

Saturday night, though, he didn't know what she was up to, and at no point during the day did he have a chance to ask her.

Was she with Connor? She could even have stayed the night with him.

When he eventually returned home, on the Sunday afternoon, Madeleine was all over him as though he'd been away for a month, as though she needed to reclaim him. God, she looked good, even dressed down in sweatpants and one of her college t-shirts, those nipples straining against the thin cotton. But he was exhausted.

He'd said, "Honey, I'm really sorry—I think I need to sleep before I do anything."

She'd nodded, bitten her lip in a manner that sent a tickle of arousal through even his shattered frame.

"You had a good time with Lucy?"

"Of course."

"And last night?"

"Last night was fun."

He chuckled at that obvious attempt to engage him in something more than going to bed, but he continued through to the bedroom, hauling off his shoes and then his clothes. A splash of cold water on the face felt fantastic—so much so that he slipped on the shower for a full rinse. Well, it felt better to collapse in bed clean than it did with the lingering traces of 72 hours in the office.

It was when he got out of the shower and started brushing his teeth that he opened the little mirrored medical cabinet above the sink to find

the floss, and there on the shelf was that big box of condoms—with only two of them left.

Jesus.

His heart jumped a few times, his breathing became suddenly rapid. Ten condoms were missing from the box. Had she really had full so many times without Hugo's knowledge?

It shocked him—even now, even after their fidelity barrier had been broken with Hugo watching, it was deeply disturbing to him to see that her fun with Connor had apparently continued behind closed doors.

Yet judging from the electricity rippling through his body and the rampaging erection he was now presented with, the evidence that Madeleine had been a naughty girl while he'd been out was equally exciting to him.

Slowly, he stepped out of the bathroom, wrapping his waist and his swollen manhood in a little white towel. He wasn't sleepy now. Not in the slightest. Call it a second wind, call it whatever, he felt fully energized again. It was like that myth of the mother lifting a car off her infant because of the power of the adrenaline flowing through her body at the sheer panic and terror.

Where had she done it?

Like a hawk, his eyes fixed on the little scrap of scarlet that had fallen to the floor by the bedside table, and been overlooked in the cleanup.

The open wrapper from a condom.

Madeleine walked into the bedroom. Hugo tried not to react to her, despite the fact that while he'd been in the shower, she'd stripped off her sweatpants and t-shirt, and she was now standing in an elaborate luxurious white lace lingerie set, complete with white lace-topped stockings and garter belt, with an almost bridal bra and panties that looked wonderfully extravagant.

And she was wearing this especially for him.

Hugo tried not to be distracted. He asked her, “Connor spent the night with you?”

She nodded meekly, hands behind her back like a naughty schoolgirl.

“And you didn’t tell me. We’ve not talked about you spending the night with him yet.”

“I’m sorry.”

Hugo stepped up to her, said rhetorically, “So this is going to be how it is, is it? You’ll be taking advantage of any moment we’re not together to run to some other guy. What am I going to do with you, Madeleine?”

He saw the glint in her eye, that little hint of mischief, responding to the stern tone of his voice, the suggestion that despite his exhaustion, he was now up for some game play.

Only, it wasn’t a game that Madeleine had actually spent the night with her crush, right here in this room. Hugo could tell that.

“I’m yours, only yours,” she insisted, her voice taking on a slight soupçon of Damsel in Distress. “I’m yours to do whatever you want with.”

He nodded, trying not to react though his cock was so swollen beneath that little towel to see her like this.

“Go to the window,” he said. “Stand there and open the blinds.”

“Open them?” she was fearful.

“I don’t know if your Connor is over there in his apartment, if he can see you. I don’t care. If he is, he can see me taking what I want from you.”

She gasped. But after a beat, she complied. Without even turning off the lights of the bedroom, she went to stand in front of the windows, and drew up the blinds completely, so the glass was totally revealed, the whole world outside free to see almost everything going on in that room

—and in particular, the sexy blonde standing right there in front, wearing Playboy-centerfold underwear.

Hugo waited a few moments, enjoying the picture of his wife exposed, the idea that anyone could see her like this—that Connor could see her like this.

Then he turned the lights down a little into a softer, more romantic glow that still cast enough brightness to keep Madeleine on display. He moved behind her and encircled her in his arms, nudging his chin over her shoulder, pressing his face into her hair to breathe in her fragrance.

He ran his hands all over her body, reveling in the texture of the lace over her skin, the erotic nature of her stockings and suspenders.

As his hand slipped between her legs from behind, cupping her pussy, finding the lacework wet from her arousal already, he asked her, “Did you enjoy spending the night with him?”

She nodded. He pressed his fingers against her wetness, his fingertips finding the dip into her soaking groove even through her lavish underwear.

“It wasn’t supposed to happen,” she said quietly, still apologetic.

“But it did.”

“I was on my own, so he came over to keep me company. It was my turn to cook for him, I guess.”

“What did you make him?”

“Dominos.”

“Good girl.” He tried not to smile.

“We weren’t really hungry. We couldn’t keep off each other.”

“You fucked him? On the bed?”

“And the couch, and the window seat, and the floor. And in the shower. And on the kitchen counter...”

“How productive.”

“And then it was too late to throw him out, and I just wanted company while you were gone.”

“Just the company?”

“I wanted his body, too.”

Hugo flicked the catch on her bra, freeing up those beautifully rounded breasts, her proud nipples. Making her catch her breath at the startling exposure in front of these windows.

“Get on the window seat,” he said. “On all fours, like the animal you are.”

She did so, pushing out her behind for him. He said, “Do you love him? Seems like you’d want to spend the night with him if you loved him.”

She said quickly, “No. He’s just fun to be around. And he has a nice cock.”

“And you saw a lot of that last night.”

Keeping the towel around his waist, Hugo lay on the window seat behind her, running his hands over her soft, smooth flesh, in awe at the curve of her behind, the elegant wickedness of her lingerie, particularly the suspenders which framed her pussy for his gaze.

“Oh it felt so good inside me,” she said, then flinched as she felt him nuzzle into her pussy from behind, his nose pressing against the saturated material, his tongue slipping out to touch up against her hot sex, tracing out her dripping slit.

“Eventually we fell asleep,” she said. “I knew I should have called you or sent you a message, but it felt so good drifting off in his arms.”

She moaned as he licked her through the lacework, tasting her savory juices, then slipping aside her panties to reveal the pink rosy petals of her hairless pussy, which the previous night had been so well used by another man.

“And you just slept after that?” he asked her.

“He woke me in the middle of the night by kissing me all over, by going down on me.” Madeleine gasped as he feasted on her slippery

folds from behind, loving her flavor, adoring how his tongue and his lips and the heat of his mouth made her sigh and pant and sway.

“You liked it better than when I do it?”

“Not better. Just different,” she answered, her voice strained. “Then he was on top of me, inside me, taking me all the way.”

As though taking her prompt, Hugo quietly slipped off his clothes, and then pushed her down under him, so he could straddle her thighs, stroking her pussy from behind with the tip of his rigid cock.

She groaned as she felt his manhood grazing over her sex, and then let out a glorious cry as he fell on her, his arms embracing her, squeezing her breasts as his hips pushed forward to violate her with his hardness.

Legs together, she was seriously tight, but so very wet that he glided inside her pussy, thrusting into her as though spanking her with his penetration.

“Oh God...” she exclaimed over and over. “Oh fuck...”

It felt so strange to be doing this in the window, so very public. Yet he was so wound up from the surprise of finding out his wife had spent the night with another man that he was on fire, nothing was going to stop him.

Madeleine had cheated on him, in a way. Not maliciously, though. Not because she wanted to hurt him. She was fulfilling her needs, giving in to desire, making the most of her new freedom. She was insatiable, and that was what Hugo had always wanted.

As he slid inside her, he thought to himself that perhaps one day she’d have a real affair with some stranger, someone Hugo did not know, and had not approved prior to the relationship beginning. There was something curiously exciting in that prospect, too, though taking the assumption that she’d eventually share the details with him, and that he would remain most important to her.

He thought she came, but he was not nearly done despite his fatigue. Her outfit had given him a second wind—she did not wear this

stuff very often. There had been a time, very recently, she'd never conceive of wearing something like this, though it seemed the easy way to get any man to worship her.

He turned her over, pulled off her panties, breathed in her scent from them, then shared her affectionate smile. He couldn't help but fall on her again, taste her while her legs were clad in those sexy stockings. That smooth completely bare mound, her hairless pussy was so divine, he couldn't avoid taking his fill.

She raised her hips as he ate her, her hands slipping over his scalp, her fingers pulling her to him as she rode his face to another climax.

When he finally called time on his own performance, he was on his back on the window seat, and Madeline was riding his shaft, completely on display to the world if it was watching, loving the risk, the danger of being seen.

Clamping herself to him as he released his hot oil inside her, reclaiming her.

"I guess you're forgiven," he said as they settled down in bed, allowing sleep to come and claim them both.

Twenty One

Connor was due to be away for six weeks to tend to his latest business ventures on the West Coast. Madeleine didn't talk a huge amount about what he was up to, but it was clear to Hugo that his absence gently frustrated her, just when she'd embarked on such a physical relationship with him.

Her signals unnerved her husband a little, though he told himself it was simply her body's physical craving for the powerful stimulus of her new lover, not that she was developing feelings for him.

He remembered how he'd been with new girlfriends in the years before Madeleine—it wasn't love, it was lust.

Hugo did benefit from some of her desperation, of course, diverting her lust in his direction, even role-playing the part of Connor when they made love. Lucy helped distract her friend, too, with some girls nights out.

Hugo had also redrafted the concept of Date Night, which had fallen by the wayside ever since Connor's dating was confirmed. One evening they were due to go out for a nice dinner-and-a-movie night, but Hugo returned home after work to find a rather frantic Madeleine.

"What's going on?"

"Uh... look, would you mind if I went out tonight... without you?"

Hugo sighed, and on the inside he was laughing. It was so obvious that she wanted to go out with Connor. Was he back in town early? He didn't quite know how to respond to her question and not demand she tell him what she wanted to do with Connor.

She was too hyper, apparently, to wait for his answer, taking his pause as being either outright rejection of her request, or annoyance at her snub.

She said, “Okay, I’ll tell you. He’s back in town for the night, so if I want to see him, this is the only time I can.”

Hugo nodded slowly, amused at how his snail’s pace was winding her up—she wanted to be gone, she wanted to be with Connor, there wasn’t time. He was quietly buzzing at the prospect that his wife was going to see another man again, was going to let him do all manner of unspeakably depraved things with her.

It didn’t get old, didn’t lose its power. Wife sharing. The question was whether exposure to the bright light of a new relationship would take the shine off her marriage, make her lose interest with Hugo. He suspected he’d answered that particular concern already. The key to his keeping her satisfied while still interested in him was to allow her out, and then make the most of the opportunity to reclaim her—he saw that.

As for now—well, he could hardly refuse her consent at this stage.

Just as he was about to nod and smile and step back to allow her into the bedroom to start a rapid change of outfit before dashing out the door to the arms of another man, a sudden thought came to him.

“I’ll say that you can go…” he said to her calmly, “on one condition.”

“Yes?”

He smiled. “After dinner with him, or whatever you’re doing, you come back here to our apartment.”

“Come back here?”

Hugo nodded. “You come back here, and whatever you do with Connor you do it in our bedroom, in our bed.”

Madeleine rumped her brow—not opposed to the idea, but confused, curious.

“Why—where will you be?” she asked, and the mere formation of the question on her lips got her to where Hugo’s idea lurked. “You want to watch, don’t you?”

He was silent, but he did not deny her question.

Madeleine glanced over toward the windows, and the street, and the apartment in the next building. Hugo could see a glimmer of mischief in her eyes—he could see she liked the idea of being watched, and perhaps of pulling the wool over Connor’s eyes about where Hugo was.

“Where will you be?” she asked him, as he now stepped back, and accompanied her to the bedroom to change.

“I guess the obvious place would be in the wardrobe,” he said.

Madeleine stripped off her clothes before finding fresh underwear, her nudity and the outfit she now changed into quickening Hugo’s pulse considerably. Was this really going to happen? Was he going to see her taken by another man, just a few feet away?

She sat on the bed, texting Connor, as Hugo checked out the built-in wardrobe that spanned the entire back wall of the bedroom. It seemed suitable enough for a man to conceal himself comfortably enough. Perhaps with a few cushions here, some spare pillows there.

He closed the mirrored wardrobe doors, and went to the bed to see if someone occupying it, or perhaps ramming his huge cock into another man’s bride, might be able to see that someone was hiding in the wardrobe with the door open just sufficiently to see. With the lights down low, he didn’t believe so.

Madeleine’s cell phone buzzed with a message, and she giggled as she read it. “He says yes to meeting me here. And he suggested getting food delivered so he can spend every minute possible... well, you know.”

“Making you come like a freight train,” Hugo chuckled. “So he’s coming right here?”

She nodded. “Should be here in twenty minutes. I need to get in the shower.”

“And I need to get myself holed up inside the wardrobe,” Hugo said.

When he was ready and in position, Madeleine double-checked his risk of discovery.

“Can’t see you at all,” she said, fresh-faced and rosy-cheeked from her shower.

“I can see you, though. Feeling jealous already.”

He could only trust her that he wasn’t visible from outside the wardrobe, but he was still a touch nervous about being discovered. That wasn’t all he was nervous about. It was one thing watching his wife from across the street, but quite another to see it happen right here, just a few feet away.

“You’re okay?” she said, standing over him as he got comfortable on the floor of the closet, cushioned by spare pillows and bedding.

“Absolutely.”

“You have your phone?”

“Yes. It’s here.”

“Because if it gets too much...”

“I know,” he said, feeling that familiar tension as his pulse quickened.

She closed the closet door leaving a crack through which he could see out, and for a moment or two, sat back on the bed, ensuring that her husband was going to be completely hidden from view.

*

The waiting. Sometimes that was the hardest thing of all.

Sitting there in the shadows, knowing what was coming, and even with that hint of a possibility of stopping it if he really had to, the potential complications and embarrassment meaning that really, there wasn’t much potential for Hugo to have any control over this.

It was going to be another roller coaster ride, that was for sure.

In the silence, he trembled.

He could hear the relentless pounding of his heart. It made him think of Poe's Tell-Tale Heart, an idea that even raised a half-smile as he considered the protagonist of that story, a man driven mad by hearing a dreadful heart-beat.

Only unlike Poe's guilt-ridden narrator, Hugo hadn't committed murder. His dark, anti-social act had been to allow his wife to invite another man inside her.

A quiet bang, clatter. Madeleine putting on make-up. For a quick romp with her husband, she would never have troubled herself, but with her new date, even a casual late-night booty-call required a hint of lipstick and mascara. A spritz or two of perfume, and from where he was crouched, Hugo could breathe it in, the scent of seduction—seduction of another. More terrible silence, Hugo breathing deeply, practicing how quietly he could draw in the air, pacing himself to keep calm.

Then the shrill, agonizing ring of the doorbell. The sound of Madeleine scampering around to answer it, her pace displaying clear enthusiasm, excitement. A girl waiting for Christmas morning to officially begin so she could open her presents.

"Yeah, he can come up," she said to the concierge. Nice having a concierge, not something they'd had in Boston. What would he think of such a late-night caller? Perhaps he remembered that both husband and wife were at home this evening.

More silence, waiting, waiting.

Then, finally, the rattle of the chain and the lock, and Madeleine's bright, breezy exclamation: "Hey!"

A deep voice lost in hers—a man. Connor. No doubt embracing her out there, kissing her. The worst part of the waiting was that last part: waiting for them to come through to the bedroom, not knowing what they were doing, only hearing brief murmuring conversation, because mostly they were too wrapped up in each other, absorbed by their lust.

Then, at last, they arrived.

Twenty Two

Madeleine sprawled over the sheets, looking gorgeous in a casual pair of white cotton panties and a white halter top, expressly worn to give the impression she'd simply been home alone before giving the green light to a late-night booty call. Her quick application of subtle make-up belied the suggestion that she'd made no effort in her appearance for her new lover.

Then, there was Connor. Removing his jacket to reveal a crisp white shirt. Leaning over the bed, planting a soft kiss on her rear as she lay on her front, feigning sleep as she waited for him.

It was shocking to Hugo, another man now lying on his bed, lips gently exploring his wife's exposed behind. He caught a hint of the man's cologne in the air—expensive, sophisticated yet understated—and it sparked a fresh burst of jealous acidity in his stomach. It was so real—so much more real than watching across a street.

Terrifying.

As he watched the man kiss his way slowly up Madeleine's back, over her thin white top, Hugo felt the underlying fear of discovery blending with the fear of how his wife would enjoy this man's lovemaking more than his own, of how his wife might no longer want him.

"So hubby's out tonight, huh?" Connor said, and Madeleine smiled, feeling his hands playing with her underwear, pulling the material from the back, tight against her pussy.

"Uh-huh."

"And he knows about this, too?"

"I texted him."

Hugo felt a warm glow bloom inside him at the first true confirmation that Madeleine had definitely told her new lover that she was married, that her husband knew of her straying. It felt intensely reassuring to him, that she was emphasizing to Connor that this could only ever be a little fun.

He'd got the impression from all that spectating that Connor wasn't the type to become obsessed with one woman, to want to settle down with her, have her exclusively. But this was powerful confirmation.

Connor now lay spooned up against Madeleine, who tilted her head to allow him to kiss her neck.

"He'll be back later?"

"Uh-huh."

"I guess we'd better hurry then."

"Oh, we're okay," she said, turning to kiss his mouth, her arm curling around his head.

Connor pulled aside her panties, and Hugo had the perfect viewpoint from which to see how wet she was already, even before her new boyfriend was kissing his way back down her body, over the round curve of her rear, his hands gliding up her thighs to nudge up against her tender folds.

Madeleine had positioned herself well for the benefit of her audience.

She closed her eyes, biting her lip and arching her back as Connor's experienced fingers teased her sex, and then were replaced by the soft lips and wet tongue of her new lover. Hugo could hear her labored breathing, like the sound of silk rubbing against silk, so beautiful.

"So have you been with many guys like me?" Connor said, as Madeleine swiveled under him, to lie on her back and open her thighs for him, so he could have easier access to lick her soaking pussy. "With your husband's permission, I mean."

“You’re the first,” she said, her body rising and falling as her breathing deepened under his attention.

Hugo felt his erection throb at that, imagining that his wife was hinting at wanting other lovers at some point down the line. There was something so sordid, yet so exhilarating to think of her as being that insatiable.

“I feel honored,” Connor chuckled. Then he said, “God, I never met anyone like you before, Lainie.”

Lainie. Was that how she’d introduced herself to him? She’d never shortened her name to anything other than Maddie before, and usually she preferred the full Madeleine. Now she had this rogue persona, this sexy independent self that fucked other men, and it had another name.

Lainie.

It was like she had a porn star name. Did she like it? Had she wanted her husband to call her that? It made him feel suddenly excluded.

“I never met anyone like you before,” she said, uttering a little gasp as he teased out one of her labia with his lips.

“Seriously?” he chuckled, and gave her a long, slow lick up the length of her pussy, which made her groan. “You did go to college?”

She laughed, and Hugo looked up to see that she’d slipped down her top to reveal her bare breasts, and those devilishly stiff nipples, which she quietly fondled as the younger man lapped at her pussy.

“I went to college,” she said. “But I wasn’t really the type—”

“What type were you?”

She sighed as he slipped two fingers inside her, teasing her as his mouth touched down beside her clit, nudging her little sensitive button a while before enveloping it.

“Oh... you know, the library was my best friend...”

Connor chuckled, and Madeleine seemed to respond with mild surprise to the sensations that ran through her clit as he did.

“You never slept with anyone at college?”

“Not many,” she said.

Sitting in the closet, quietly stroking himself as he watched Madeleine’s hand gently caressing another man’s head as he ate her pussy, Hugo found himself suddenly wanting Connor’s interview to continue. His wife had never before revealed anything about her dating past. She’d told him she was inexperienced before he had come along, but conceding that she wasn’t a virgin when it came time to sleep together was about as far as it had got.

There were times, usually when she was giving him a killer blow job, that he’d been curious about where she had learned the technique. Who had she practiced on, how many.

True, when they’d started dating, he really hadn’t wanted to know. But now, he was curious to know how his wife had developed.

“How old were you the first time?”

“Why do you want to know?” Madeleine’s tone suddenly took on a slightly startled, awkward note. Like she realized her husband was present, and she suddenly remembered that if she told Connor, she’d be telling Hugo as well.

“I’m curious. Tell me about your first time.”

“First time for what?”

Hugo was at full hardness at the thought that Connor might force it out of her, now. There was something hot about learning saucy secrets about your partner. There was no reason for her not to tell him as far as Connor knew. Unless she wanted to reveal Hugo’s presence to him.

“Well, let’s go through them. First kiss?”

“With a boy?”

“Or a girl, if it was proper kissing.”

“End of high school.”

“And?” he said. “Boy or girl?”

“My friend Lucy.”

“I’ll bet she was a hottie, too.”

“We just practiced kissing each other, that’s all.”

“I also bet that wasn’t all you did, too. First blow job?”

Hugo saw Madeleine glance down toward him, toward the closet, a moment of fear and apology on her face as she attempted to see through the crack, see if she was angering her husband by this talk of her past.

He wanted to tell her it was all right, he was curious too. Turned on, even. They hadn’t really developed a signal system for him to do that, though. All he had was texts.

Madeleine’s phone buzzed briefly on the bedside table. She leaned casually over to reach for it,.

“Hubby?” Connor asked, equally casual. Not afraid of discovery, since apparently he knew Madeleine had told her husband what she was doing.

“Yeah.”

“On his way home?”

She read the text Hugo had sent:

> Answer him if you like, honey. It’s hot finding out about your past! You should see how hard you make me.

She smiled, blushed a little.

“Yes,” she lied.

“And he’ll want me gone by the time he gets back?” Connor asked, making Hugo wonder if he’d actually be okay with the whole watching thing after all. “How long have we got?”

“I don’t know, half an hour?” She said, peering at the closet, trying to see something of her husband’s response to her holding another man’s face firmly clamped against her sex.

“Plenty of time,” her new lover said. “So you were saying... about your first blow job.”

She flashed a quizzical look her husband’s direction. Knowing how she herself refused to even think about her husband’s exes, her husband’s

sexual past. Looking at him with the last invitation for him to stop her: Really? You really want to hear this?

“End of high school,” she said. “Also.”

Connor chuckled. “Not your friend Lucy again?”

She shook her head, and now sat up, her top falling back into place as she urged Connor up and over, encouraging him to turn onto his back so she could straddle him, stealing another kiss and a taste of herself on his lips as she slipped over his thighs.

“Ian Johnson,” she said. “It was at a party before we all went away to college.”

Hugo had no idea who Ian Johnson was, or where he was now, but it provoked a fresh tickle of jealousy and made his hardness throb like crazy to imagine his wife as a sexy high school girl, fumbling with her first experience of a boy’s cock.

The way she sat astride Connor, her hands sweeping all over him, wrenching off that shirt, her wide eyes following her fingers all over the toned topography of his torso, made Hugo suddenly think of how she might have been with a first boyfriend. She had that same kind of eager curiosity, as a teenage girl might have with her first love. Stroking his pecs, that ridiculous washboard stomach, checking out the underlying power in his biceps.

Even when she made love to him, she never really looked at Hugo like this. It made Hugo want to get down to the gym, right now. She was impressed at the man’s physique. It was hardly surprising, and neither was Hugo’s envy. But still, the surprising thing was how good it felt to have given her this opportunity to experience such an athletic lover.

The look of wonder and joy on her face was the most magnificent thing of all, and it was all the reward Hugo needed.

Connor moaned as Madeleine kissed her way down his chest, her hands enveloping that exposed shaft of his, which bucked in anticipation of her mouth.

Hugo felt another little jolt in his chest to see her wedding ring right there on her fingers as they curled around another man's brutally hard cock. It was a detail he hadn't really been able to see when watching from across the street. It glinted as she continued to grip the other man's erect cock, and she seemed so brazen, so confident to be wearing it like that. Yet after the initial anguish, Hugo felt himself warming to the sight of that little band of gold—the symbolism that Madeleine was still his, still committed, and yet so clearly violating their original marriage vows, and that turned him on.

How erotic it suddenly seemed to him that a woman, such a beautiful and powerful creature, would give up all temptations of the flesh other than her husband, when committing to marriage. And how erotic it could be that a husband would reward her commitment by offering her some of those temptations in celebration of her devotion to him.

"Ian Johnson. He was your boyfriend?"

"No," she said. "We were playing spin the bottle. Somebody—Dave Lutkins, I guess—brought beer, which was kind of disgusting, but nobody cared, everyone was drinking."

Hugo felt the air suddenly evacuating from his body. This was all new ground for him, he'd never heard anything about Madeleine's back catalog. Spin the bottle—he'd never have thought she'd be involved in such a thing.

Connor said, "Do high school kids really play spin the bottle? I thought it was a myth."

This, coming from a man who had regular orgies at his apartment across the street. Hugo smiled.

She kissed her way around Connor's abdomen, and around the hair-free base of his manhood. "I only did it that once," she said. "Seemed like some of the others had done it before."

"And you had to give some guy a blow job?"

“I kissed a couple guys first,” she said. Hugo saw her eyes dart to his closet for a moment, and she took on this mischievous look of defiance, declaring to her husband that if he wanted her to talk about her past, she wasn’t going to hold back.

Hugo shivered again, though it wasn’t remotely cold.

“Some of the girls went home when it got late and people were suggesting more than just kissing,” she said. “I stayed, and pretty soon the bottle was pointing at me.”

Hugo throbbed again as he saw her snaking her tongue around Connor’s tip, then drawing it down his length, sampling him. He knew men always have an inaccurate idea of their own size, because they only ever see their own cocks from the kind of perspective that makes them appear smallest. Still, From close up, Hugo thought the cock Madeleine now stretched her lips around was bigger than she was used to. He was surprised that he didn’t envy it, he actively enjoyed that she was having this different experience.

“Must’ve been seriously hot,” Connor said as she slid him into her mouth, her husband responding to the wet sounds of her sucking, ducking her head down as her hand finally closed around his shaft.

“Mmm...” she slipped him back out of her mouth again. “Ian Johnson. He smelled of beer and vinegar. Tasted of... well, cock, I guess. My first time tasting that...”

Connor merely groaned and pushed his head back in the pillows as she reacquainted herself with that taste. Sucking him, pumping his shaft with her fist, either consciously or by accident, she angled her body so her husband could see how wet she was.

“Mmm... I remember being surprised at how big it got,” she said, and it struck Hugo as strange to hear her talking about size, his assumption from their early days being that it had never mattered to her.

“He was your biggest?” Connor asked, his voice strained by her actions, and perhaps his attempt to control himself, hold himself back.

“I don’t know. I don’t think so. I guess because it was the first time I really saw one, you know, get hard. It just seemed massive.”

Connor laughed. “Probably why the men who wrote the Bible said women should be virgins when they marry,” he said. “So the lucky Ian Johnson... was he your first fuck as well?”

Madeleine was crawling back up his body, now, reaching for another taste of his mouth, her smooth belly brushing against his rock hard cock. “No,” she said, tilting her head to kiss his top lip. “The game didn’t really get that far. I think I was a little too freaked out when he came in my mouth.”

“That wasn’t very polite.”

“It was too fast for any warning,” she giggled, lifting a final knee over Connor’s hip, so her pussy came to rest on his big pole. Hugo found herself wondering if this young suitor was her biggest, then.

“So your first was, what, college?”

Madeleine hummed and moaned as she pressed her sex against his manhood, rocking back and forth on him without yet letting him inside her.

“Sophomore year.”

“Seriously?” from Connor.

She laughed, and from the expression on her face, it seemed odd to her that she could admit it, talk about it in public, let the apparent shame of her dry year pass.

“A whole year in college and no one managed to tap this sweet little pussy?” Connor said, and the complement made her beam as her new lover delved between her thighs, his big paw swarming all over her aforementioned sweet little pussy, fingers seeking out her clit as she stroked herself with his hardness.

“I told you... the library was my boyfriend back then,” she giggled. Hugo couldn’t remember the last time he’d made her giggle.

“Who was he?”

“Another journalism major. Bobby Tyler. I used to sing ‘Total Eclipse of the Heart’ to him, to tease him. Eventually he got the message and asked me to the sophomore dance.”

“And that’s where it happened? At the dance?”

“Not at the dance,” she smiled, rolled her eyes. “He took me back to his room afterwards.”

“Nice.”

“He was okay,” she said, relatively dismissive.

“Just okay? To win your cherry, Lainie, and he was just *okay*.”

“I was shy. I was a geek. Guys weren’t interested.”

“I can’t believe that,” Connor said.

Craving details about his wife’s past, Hugo almost found himself too distracted to remember what was happening right in front of his eyes. He almost missed the sight of Madeleine—Lainie—grab Connor’s cock and now position it to slide inside her pussy.

No condom this time.

Hugo was shocked. He was gasping for breath, clawing the air for oxygen, but trying desperately not to make a sound as he watched his wife slowly sink down on another man’s brutally erect cock, without the aid of any kind of protection. Bareback.

Twenty Three

Despite how ready she was, so wet for him, and for their audience, it seemed that she had to work to get his hardness inside her, her pussy stretching around him.

Then she was reaching down to feel the part of him that would not go inside, as though in disbelief that he was that big. Oh yes, Connor was bigger than her husband. That was okay, though. Hugo wanted her experience to be different from him. But bareback? He had to keep calm, pace his breathing. Trust that she knew what she was doing.

And from the deep moan Madeleine emitted, it was clear she was appreciating her husband's trust.

"Oh, you must have been so cute as a college geek," Connor said, the strain showing on his face again as he fought to prevent himself from finishing early.

She laughed. "I wore skirts down to my shoes and massive sweaters."

"Your first boyfriend, then."

Madeleine grinned, surprised that his questions were continuing even after full penetration, though she did appear happy that this gorgeous specimen of a man was so interested in her past.

"Ben," she said, rising and falling on that huge pole. "I guess we dated for about six months."

"He was good in bed?"

"Not really. It was kind of over too quickly."

"How many guys were there after that? Before hubby, I mean?"

"Three or four."

Connor gripped her behind, guiding her rhythm, his biceps flexing as he lifted her, and relaxed, lifted and relaxed.

“Oh God...” she breathed “You’re so strong...”

Connor wasn’t to be distracted from his questioning. “Three or four guys?” he prompted. “When it’s that low, you know which one it is.”

“One guy I didn’t really... well, I just gave him a blow job.” She giggled.

Connor pushed her up, and it seemed to Hugo that she knew what he wanted without him having to actually say anything. Madeleine already had that kind of chemistry with him. On her hands and knees, she presented her rear for him, which he duly accepted, one hand on her round buttock as the other guided his length inside her again.

“Oh God... oh Jesus...”

Hearing her with him, hearing her respond to what she was experiencing, it was a powerful thrill for Hugo.

“Oh fuck...”

Her reactions to his size and force as he thrust into her provoked little ripples of jealousy and intense excitement in her concealed husband.

Madeleine turned to look directly at the closet again, at him. She made it look as though she was trying to look back at her lover, but unable because of the angle. Really, though, she was gazing directly at her husband as the other man thrust inside her. Her strained expression full of ecstasy, gratitude, perhaps, and even a touch of concern for her husband’s wellbeing.

But it was the shock and surprise on her face from just how incredible it felt to be fucked by this young stud right in front of her husband—that was the look on her face that nearly made Hugo lose control.

“Oh yeah... oh yeah... oh yeah...”

Connor’s forceful pounding soon eased her mind of concern that her husband was suffering in any way.

Her elbows slumped and she buried her head in the pillow, pushing up her hips so that her date could continue stretching her pussy, filling every part of her with that beast of a manhood, the bed creaking quietly as they moved together.

“Are you gonna come?” Hugo heard Connor say, his voice disturbingly deep in the context of their own private bedroom.

“Oh God, yeah...” she said with urgency raising the pitch of her voice.

Hugo found his own deep breathing synchronizing with hers as she fought for oxygen and he fought for calm as the intense feelings rushed through his body to watch his wife rising to what appeared to be the strongest climax she’d ever had.

“Yeah... yeah... yeah...” little high-pitched yelps, not the kind Hugo had ever really heard before.

She was gasping, shuddering, wailing as her body shook with the force of a monumental climax—but while Hugo found himself suddenly sharply reminded that this guy was inside his wife without the aid of birth control, Connor was not reaching his end just yet.

He turned her over, so that he was in a loose spoon with her, she was on her back and he was on his side, sliding in from a mostly rear position, curling around her as he slowly fucked her, to caress and suck her breasts and those impossibly stiff nipples.

“Oh God, I’ve never come so much before,” she said before realizing how offensive such a thing might be to her concealed husband.

She darted a sharp look of apology and concern toward the closet, making Hugo appreciate that this performance of hers must have been complicated for her to manage, knowing two guys were so close, one unaware of the other, and that to be fully open to her lover might threaten her diplomatic relations with her observer.

“You tell your husband this?” Connor was chuckling.

“I don’t know,” she said. “I guess I should. He likes me to enjoy myself.”

“He really must do to let you cheat on him.”

Madeleine smiled. “I think he likes it when I cheat on him,” she wiggled her behind as Connor continued to stir his hardness inside her. Then she gasped as some kind of realization seemed to dawn on her: “Oh God, I’m really cheating on him...”

The way she said it made Hugo so unbelievably hard in his hands. It was so wrong, yet so right. The idea of his wife as this sexy, mischievous, sensual goddess, too much for a single husband to handle.

It wasn’t cheating in Hugo’s eyes, since it was expressly consensual. But the dark connotations of the word seemed appropriate, and deeply arousing.

“You guys are nasty,” Connor was laughing again, seemingly impressed at their unusual marriage. Then he turned back to the questioning. “So when was your first... When was the first time a guy gave you an orgasm? A proper one, unassisted. Ben?”

“No,” she smiled. “That would be my husband, actually.”

Hugo felt his ears burn and his stomach fill with unbridled contentment. Well, he hadn’t been all bad, then.

“Wow. Ben really must have been a disappointment.”

She grinned. “He was just a bit selfish, I guess. And I was obsessed with making sure he was satisfied—I hardly worried about myself.”

Connor nodded. “Hubby gets some credit, then.”

“Hubby gets a lot of credit,” Madeleine said. “He’s the most amazing man I ever met.”

Funny how hearing that from her tugged on his heart strings more than anything else. Made Hugo well up, even, actual tears forming.

“He sounds like a fascinating guy,” Connor said. Then he added, “Okay then... first time with more than one person.”

Madeleine chuckled. “What? More than one person? In bed?”

Connor laughed now. “You never had a threesome?”

“Of course not!”

“You did go to college?”

“Not hooker college.”

Connor laughed. “We’ll have to do something about that.”

Hugo caught himself drifting into a daydream, the idea of his wife having sex with more than one person at a time—two guys? Two girls? Would she really go so far?

He snapped back in to reality to see Connor between his wife’s thighs, sliding that huge cock inside her dripping wet pussy from the missionary position, which should have seemed so conventional compared to what Hugo had seen over the past few days and weeks—yet because it was so intimate, her lover gazing down into her adoring eyes, it still had the power to shock.

“Oh, I can feel it all the way in,” she said, her words jabbing at her hidden husband. “You’re so enormous.”

Everything she was saying, everything that was happening was so disturbing, yet so exhilarating, the ultimate in bittersweet.

Whispering: “Oh my god... holy shit...”

Whimpering.

Wonderment: “Oh my god, how can you fuck me like that?”

Screaming, “Oh my God, Oh my God... Oh my God...”

And then Connor was pulling out, his huge manhood pulsating as he spurted hot cream in strings over Madeleine’s pussy and her stomach, with some even reaching her heaving breasts and chin.

So startlingly real, another man’s come spread across her smooth skin, her beautiful body.

*

Hugo slipped out of the apartment while the happy couple was in the shower. Connor was under the impression that the husband was out, so it would be safe enough if he was actually out, Hugo figured. Safer, even. He could text Madeleine to say he was nearly home. Would Connor scramble to get out of there? He knew she was married, he knew her husband was aware of her fooling around. Maybe he would purposefully hang back, to see what the dynamic might be if the two of them actually met.

Hugo wasn't sure how it would feel to meet Connor, to meet him with both of them fully compos mentis about what was going on. Would Connor slip into the societal assumption that he was somehow less of a man for taking pleasure in his wife's straying?

Was he less of a man?

It was good to get out of there anyway. Get some night air. Not entirely fresh air with the tang of brine from the East River, the smoky scent of the traffic, the hint of garbage or fried food that occasionally wafted under the nose—the underlying musk of the city. But it was out of the stifling intensity of that room.

Separation also gave him room to think.

Madeleine had just had sex with another man, without the aid of a condom.

*

She was sitting on the window seat as he came in, gazing across the street.

She was wearing one of his shirts—the one he'd last worn to work, in fact—loose since she hadn't even bothered to button up, but not much else as far as Hugo could see. Her hair was still damp from her shower, her skin rosy fresh from the heat of the water as she sat there, gently lit by a single table lamp nearby.

She looked up, smiling in that affectionate, nervous way that suggested even after everything that had happened between them, she still couldn't guarantee that he wouldn't be upset by what she'd just done.

"Hey," she said, sliding her hand out from between her thighs. Hugo realized she must have been touching herself, even without consciously deciding to.

"Hey," he said, drifting over toward the window. "He's gone?"

She nodded, offered another smile, her eyes still posing questions: are you all right? Are we all right? Are you upset, angry with me?

Hugo smiled, broadly, and saw that it instantly put her at ease.

"You were incredible," he said.

Placed his hand gently on the side of her neck, his face closing in on hers, loving the happiness ingrained in every feature as he closed in for a soft kiss. He could smell the floral scent from her shower and that sharp, acrid smell of cigarette smoke that at once repulsed him and also strangely aroused him. The post-coitus cigarette: it seemed to emphasize that she'd been with a different man, following different rules.

"You smoke now," he said, trying to keep the judgmental out of his tone. "Did you ever do that before?"

"In college. Years ago. Just to be social."

"It makes you seem... wild."

She smiled at that, loving her affect on him. He kissed her cheek, then as his hand slipped down to her chest, and under the loose shirt to cup her breast, he took her bottom lip into his mouth, and as he tasted her mouth, the lingering savory flavor was unmistakable even over the traces of cigarette.

"He came in your mouth?" he whispered, a little taken aback at what had happened in so short a space of time that he had vacated the premises.

She gave her husband a sheepish grin. “He was hard again by the time we finished our shower,” she said. “It was too tempting.

Hugo chuckled, “So you got all nice and clean, and then got out of the shower and started on him again?”

She blushed, “I was watching him getting dressed—it was just standing there, swaying in the breeze.”

He gently pushed his tongue inside her mouth as his finger and thumb squeezed her stiff nipple, forcing himself to handle the strange way his wife tasted following her encounter. Not a strong flavor at all—quite subtle. But enough to emphasize what his wife had done, her sexy insatiability, and provoke that emotional response in her husband—pride and jealousy. Connor had been so taken with her, even after full sex, he was back to full hardness within minutes.

Hugo stooped, kissed his way down her chest, her stomach, her borrowed shirt falling open to reveal her pale body in the soft light, and the fresh pair of panties she’d put on.

“He wasn’t wearing protection this time,” Hugo said as he touched his lips down to the top of her underwear, his hand sliding down her thigh.

“No,” she said. “My tests came back clear.”

“Your tests?”

She smiled. “It’s what people do nowadays, you know.”

“Seriously?”

Hugo kissed his way down to the place where her underwear covered the apex of her slit, and sucked gently on the material over her clit, feeling her squirm a little under him. She was already wet, the dampness pervading her panties, and Hugo suspected that had started as soon as she had gone down on Connor that last time. Perhaps, as soon as she had stepped out of the shower again.

“Well you’ve seen Connor and his friends over there,” she said, groaning at the gentle heat from his mouth. “They’re fairly liberal in

sleeping with each other.”

“I guess so.”

“There’s a special online clinic they use for testing. It’s very easy, very quick.”

“Online clinic, huh.”

“It’s the 21st Century now,” she grinned, or at least he assumed she did from the bright sound of her voice. Hugo was too busy nuzzling into her panties, breathing in that dark scent of her aroused womanhood, brushing her warm moisture over his lips, his face.

He slipped his fingers under the thin gauzy material of her underwear, feeling just how wet she was even before reaching the searing groove of her pussy.

“So how was it, really?” Madeleine asked, before moaning softly as her husband’s fingers dipped gently into the source of her wetness.

“How was it?”

“Watching from so close. God, we were just feet away from you.”

Hugo pulled aside her damp panties, revealing the scintillating sight of her womanhood, which still seemed strange to him without a hint of down to be found.

“It was different,” he said, and realized his answer wasn’t helpful.

“You did have a good time, though? I want you to be happy.”

“I had an amazing time,” he said, trying to be clearer in his enthusiasm. “Seeing you so close like that, hearing how you responded to him.”

Leaning over her thigh, he gently pressed his lips to hers, slipping out his tongue to taste her tangy flavor, the contact of his hot mouth on her sensitive parts teasing out a long groan from Madeleine.

“It was intense,” he elucidated, “I could smell your perfume and his cologne, I could hear the sound of him sliding inside you. But I just loved seeing your expressions, just how you were enjoying it—and when you looked directly at me. The way your face contorted with bliss...”

“But you didn’t feel bad, you didn’t feel too jealous?”

He kissed her clit, and then slipped his fingers inside her, gently covering them in her slick juices before penetration. “I always feel jealous,” he chuckled. “I guess it’s an acquired taste, which I’ve acquired.”

“But when he was asking me all those questions, about my... you know, history. I am so sorry—I just couldn’t stop him.”

“I know. I actually enjoyed hearing about it, it was interesting. Hot, even. I wanted to know more about how it was, your first time and so on.”

“Seriously?”

“You’ll have to tell me more some time.”

“You’re crazy, you know that?”

He smiled, “I guess I am. So how did you feel being in our bedroom with him? You prefer being across the street?”

Hugo shifted round, so that he was between her thighs, one draped over his shoulder, the other raised as her foot supported her on the edge of the window seat. From here, he had better access to dive in, lap up her sweet nectar, drawing his tongue slowly over her hot, slippery folds as he nudged her clit with his nose.

She groaned. “I think you’re right—it’s a different experience when I’m right in front of you. It’s kind of nice both ways. But in here, I was a little worried about how you were taking it—it was kinda like you were trapped in there.”

He said, “I had to be careful not to give myself away—I suppose that was one of the down sides. So d’you think you prefer being safely across the street?”

“Oh no,” she groaned as he started kissing his way around her clit, nudging it though refraining from direct contact. “No, actually, not at all. It’s fantastic fun being over there in a strange environment—sexy, I guess. But here having you in the same room—that was insane.”

“Really?”

“The emotions were just deeper, the feelings. This was our bedroom—our bed—and I’d brought in a strange man. And you were right there, I knew you were. Watching. Hopefully excited by what you were seeing.”

“I certainly was.”

“I loved it, knowing you were watching. That was best of all,” she moaned at the memory, though perhaps also from her husband’s soft tongue flicking over her little button. “I only wished I could have actually seen you,” she added.

“Seen me?”

“I wanted to see how you responded to it all,” she said. “That would have been so hot.”

Hugo grinned, and now pulled himself up, stripping off his shirt, the bulge obvious in his pants. “You see how I respond?” he said. “I guess you’re beginning to understand my side of the fantasy, huh.”

“I guess so.”

“But you still dream of having a proper affair?”

“It’s a different fantasy, I think.”

The beaming smile on her face made Hugo feel pure elation. Her hands flew to his belt, fingers moving rapidly to fling open the buckle and open his fly, then push down his pants to reveal his hard manhood.

She leaned forward to stretching her lips around his tip, her tongue pressing hot to his flesh, tasting the dribble of moisture she’d already inspired from him.

But then she was leaning back, slipping her underwear down past her hips and over her knees, opening her legs wide for him.

She was breathtaking. And she was all his.

Hands holding her calves, he glided inside her, easily filling her, her profuse wetness aiding his passage. Did she feel a touch different after she’d just had someone else’s cock inside her? He wasn’t sure, perhaps it

was his imagination. She felt so wonderfully tight around him, that was the important thing.

“Does that feel different to him?” he asked her, feeling strangely open about talking about this with her.

“A little,” she said.

“He’s bigger?”

She grinned. “I think he’s a little longer, but not much. You’re a little thicker, actually.”

“Really?”

“You have the perfect cock, sweetie, did I ever tell you that?”

He smiled.

She looked at him as he slowly thrust in and out of her tightness, for a moment just gazing in his eyes, her chest rising and falling from her heavy breathing, as though she was considering something.

She tilted her head. “You know what I think about sometimes? Well, ever since we started talking about this strange fantasy...”

“What do you think about?”

Hugo felt himself quiver. What was she going to say? Madeleine didn’t really talk about her fantasies much, and when she had—revealing her crush on Connor, for example—it had an explosive affect on Hugo.

She gave a bashful half-smile, creasing up her eyes, her expression suggesting she was beginning to regret mentioning the fact that she’d been fantasizing about something. But she could see there was no way to put the cork back in the bottle now.

Suddenly almost shy, she admitted, “Sometimes I think about you sharing me with Connor.”

“I am sharing you with him.”

“No, I mean at the same time. So I can see you watching as I fuck someone in front of you, so I can feel you react while you’re inside me.”

Hugo felt his manhood throb deep inside her, and it was obvious from her little gasp that she felt it too.

“You like that idea?” she asked, the shyness falling away from her voice, her demeanor, as her confidence returned.

God, she was so sexy. Even her fantasies.

“Threesome, huh?” he asked her, a wry grin spreading across his face.

“I guess it wouldn’t need to be with Connor,” she grinned, “but that’s the way it is in my mind.”

“Nice.” He leaned down to kiss her mouth, her pretty eyes looking up at him with fresh awe at what a wonderful husband she had, a sense that only made him feel warmer inside. “I’m not sure how well I’d stack up to him...”

“Oh, we wouldn’t be comparing,” she said.

She stood up, and Hugo gave her room to turn, present her rear to him. He stooped briefly to kiss her there, to gently touch his lips to her reddened lips to reacquaint himself with the exhilarating taste of her sex. Then he was standing again, hands moving over the soft, warm roundness of her behind as his big, hard, burning cock nudged against her wetness, and then slid slowly inside.

“Go slow,” she said, “I’m a little sore.”

A little sore from a night of madly fucking another man. The thought made him feel slightly giddy, though the blood filled his manhood so that he was harder than ever.

He had to resist the temptation to go at her like some mad lust-crazed animal, reclaim her and satisfy the biological urge within him to dislodge another man’s seed from this fanciable female.

As he complied with her wishes to slowly stir within her, he said, “We never really talked about threesomes before.”

“We don’t have to—” she uttered, clearly worried he was not so open to the idea of sharing her in such a way.

“No, I like the idea,” he said. “I just never knew you had that kind of fantasy.”

“Oh, I have other fantasies I haven’t told you about yet,” she smiled at him as she tucked her beautiful golden hair behind an ear.

He fucked her irresistibly slowly, and from the way she moved under him, and the way she cried out from the sensations as he thrust carefully into her, it appeared that she didn’t need much more than that moderate pace. Her hand did slide down between her legs to stroke her clit as he penetrated her.

Hugo said, “So you think your friend Connor might want to try it?”

She smiled back at him, he smile of a confessor.

“You already talked to him about it, didn’t you?” Hugo laughed.

“When you were having your shower with him.”

“I might have.”

“And?”

“He’s intrigued.”

It was only as Madeleine was rising over her final shuddering climax of the night, pulling him with her so that his stiffness pulsed and throbbed inside her, erupting with a powerful burst of pent-up come—only then did he notice that in the darkened windows of Connor’s room, a shadow suggested that they had had an audience for their display in the window.

Twenty Four

The fact that Madeleine was dating Connor meant that when she went out with Lucy now, on the whole Hugo usually felt as though it was a night off for him. She wasn't going to look for another man while her lusts were preoccupied with her crush from across the street. It meant girls' nights out would involve only looking for a guy for Lucy.

Hugo found himself working late, or perhaps grabbing a post-work drink or two with Ray or Lowego, happy that Madeleine was probably having some innocent girl time, and he didn't have to think about the possibility that another man might be sleeping with her.

He supposed that at some point—when Connor decided to go his separate ways, or when her liaisons with him started to become old hat, and she and Hugo perhaps began to get that little tickling itch for her to find a new guy to play with—girls nights out might become dangerous, with Madeleine and Lucy acting as singletons out on the prowl together. For now, though, they were relatively safe.

After one evening in which he stayed late at the office to catch up on some work, Hugo came out of the building to find an unexpected person waiting for him.

“Hey.”

“Oh, hey. Wasn't expecting—“

“Thought I'd drop by—we haven't really met, not properly.”

“No, I suppose we haven't.”

The man who was fucking his wife was casually waiting for him on one of the benches lining the entrance lobby of the building.

Hugo's blood froze. The guy hadn't really been dating Madeleine for long—or at least, hadn't been sleeping with her for long. Yet as he saw the well-presented young man waiting there in the lobby of his

office building, Hugo found his mind leaping to all sorts of painful conclusions.

Like the possibility that he might be here to ask Hugo to divorce his wife.

Hugo shook the man's outstretched hand politely but cautiously. He didn't want things to be awkward between them—he liked that Madeleine had a crush on Connor, strangely enough. It showed she was picky, she wasn't going to go with just anyone. But actually meeting him was strange.

“Good to meet you,” Connor said with a warm smile.

“Uh yeah...” Hugo said, trying to smile back, trying to believe he was here for good intentions, not to demand some kind of eighteenth century-style duel over Madeleine's hand. “Does Madeleine know you're here?”

Connor shook his head. “She's supposed to be having a night with the girls tonight, I believe.”

Hugo nodded. Connor wasn't giving off any negative vibes whatsoever, not even a hint that he saw Hugo as a bitter rival, or that he wanted to select weapons, line up with him back-to-back in the middle of a Manhattan thoroughfare, then take twelve paces, turn and fire.

“Well,” he said, “I guess she likes keeping some of her secrets from me—“

“She does,” Connor's confirmation sent a little spike of jealousy through Hugo's chest, as though suggesting this other man, this virtual stranger, had knowledge about Madeleine that Hugo himself did not. “Hey—look, do you want to find a bar somewhere? They must have them around here.”

“Uh... sure.”

Well, he wasn't doing anything, and Madeleine would be tied up with Lucy until late. Beginning to suspect that Connor wasn't here to

demand an instant divorce, Hugo found himself curious about him, and his take on the beautiful enigma that was Madeleine.

Hugo steered them round the block to a bar he often went to with his co-workers, but which he knew would be unlikely to contain any that might know him that evening. As they walked, he fired off a quick text to Madeleine to say he was having drinks after work, not that it mattered since she was out, but out of sheer habit for letting her know where he was.

“So,” came the awkward ice-breaker as they both sat down at a quiet table, Hugo with a Blue Moon, Connor with a JD and Coke.

“So,” Connor nodded, accepting it was his responsibility to get to the nub of why he’d decided to meet the husband of his current squeeze. “Madeleine’s told me you know all about our little... well, thing.”

“She’s not wrong.”

“To tell you the truth, I was pretty surprised when she finally accepted one of my requests for a date.”

“You knew she was married, I suppose—but then, that didn’t stop you asking her out.”

“No. That whole thing started as a bit of a joke—I mean, it was so clear how flirty she was at the bookstore, hell that was the only reason I went there, so I’d just pop that question in every time. I knew she was married—but I also knew that you guys were great together.”

Hugo raised his eyebrows.

“Those blinds of yours don’t hide nearly as much as you think they do.”

That made Hugo laugh. Well, it was too late to be embarrassed. He said, “You watched us?”

“Hard not to sometimes. She’s really stunning.”

“She certainly is.” Hugo took a swig of his beer, pleased at the complements for his perfect wife.

“I never thought I’d want to sleep with a married woman,” Connor said. He looked at his tumbler as though there was some answer there to a question he couldn’t quite fathom. “I certainly never thought I’d want to get married myself.”

Hugo felt his stomach churn. He remained silent.

“I always thought marriage was the end of good sex, you know? Why tie yourself down to one woman?” Connor said. Then he added: “Well, I know women, I’ve been with plenty in my time, and I’ve never met anyone like Madeleine.”

“She is one of a kind.”

“I hate to sound like an asshole, but it’s not in my habit to sleep with the same girl very much.”

“I get that impression.”

Connor nodded, accepting that if he’d been able to see Hugo and Madeleine with their blinds attempting to control the view, there was no way they could have missed Connor and his complete lack of blinds or curtains of any kind.

The younger man said, “Madeleine has changed me.”

“Changed you?” Hugo felt sick. He should never have allowed her to date a man she had such strong attraction to, such strong feelings for. He should have insisted on strangers if she was going to stray at all.

“You’ve changed me,” Connor said.

Hugo sputtered, midway through a sip of beer. “Me?”

“You’ve been the one to encourage her—I’ve seen it plain as day. She’s become this wonderfully sexy, confident, independent woman, and she’s totally transformed my view on what a married woman can be like,” Connor said. “I’ve seen how she’s changed since she first started at the bookstore.”

“So now,” Hugo said, “what are you saying? You want to marry her?”

Connor looked up, a sharp look of confusion in his eyes. Then he broke out into a broad smile, and started to laugh. Hugo felt heat well up under his collar.

“Marry her? Marry Madeleine?” Still laughing, Connor shook his head. “Do you know how much she completely adores you, Hugo? There’s no way I could compete with that, even if I wanted to.”

“Oh.” Hugo felt relief wash through him.

“She loves you, man. She can’t stop talking about you. Even with us, she put me off until she knew you’d be okay about it.”

Hugo sipped his beer, feeling a surprising camaraderie with the younger man.

“You know how many lunch dates I had with her where we talked about you? Talked about how she has your permission to even be there? Like she was trying to justify all this to herself. To ease her guilt.”

That sounded about right. Hugo liked the sound of that. “What can I say? I started out hoping she’d get friendly with a few guys just to try to cheer her up after... well, after we moved to a strange new city. It came as a bit of a surprise that actually having her flirting with other guys would have such an affect on her.”

“But you liked it, beyond the simple fact that it turned her into a horny sex goddess?” Connor said. He seemed genuinely interested.

“I think maybe you wouldn’t understand it unless you have someone you can’t do without, someone so important to you that it would seem insane that you’d risk sharing her with other guys.”

Connor nodded. “I’ve never really met a girl like that. A woman. Not until Madeleine came along—not that she’s the one I want to marry. But you’re not jealous? I find myself jealous sometimes when Madeleine’s with you now, and I’ve never ever been jealous about a girl before.”

“I get jealous—and afraid. Afraid I’ll lose her, even though I know deep down that I won’t. But somehow, that’s become part of the thrill.

You know—it adds intensity to the whole thing. A little like when you get that sharp fear on a roller coaster.”

Connor signaled one of the servers to refill their drinks, and then he said: “You know, my whole life I’ve thought that when you got married, you had to settle for one woman and it would all get so dull. I kept dating all these different women, but they kind of all blur into nothing. I can see now the point of dedicating yourself to one person. But the idea that you would let her see other men, that it would strengthen your bond, that it would have the strange affect of making her more horny for you when she returned... well, I’ve never even thought about that before.”

“It’s not for everyone.”

“No, I’m sure it’s not, the amount of spousal homicide that’s caused by infidelity. But... well, recently, it’s begun to be something I can’t stop thinking about.”

Hugo chuckled, a little disbelieving that the most eligible bachelor this side of New York, who they’d seen with countless young, beautiful women over in his apartment over the course of the past year, might want to find himself an insatiable wife to settle down with, while allowing her the same kind of sexual independence Hugo was encouraging in Madeleine.

He said: “You could always give it a try. What have you got to lose? I’m not saying marry someone just to attempt that kind of experiment—but if you met someone who seemed right, you might give it a go.”

Connor nodded. “You’re right. I should just do it.”

*

He actually enjoyed hearing from the guy his take on seducing Madeleine, on what it had been like for him to have no chance at this married beauty he saw regularly peeling off her clothes in the windows

of the building across the street—and then suddenly find himself taking her out on dates, kissing her, going the whole way to heaven and back.

“I think it was her attitude more than anything that was so sexy, so different to the girls I’d dated before,” Connor said. “She’s such a sharp, interesting person—and yet she has the most unbelievable fire inside her.”

“She does,” Hugo said, feeling a warm glow inside him to talk about his beloved wife.

“I don’t know how you guys can go your separate ways every morning to go to work. I’d want to keep her locked in the bedroom, never stop, you know what I mean?”

“When you’re married, you get the feeling you have plenty of time for that. So you feel able to wait—long enough to earn a living, anyway.”

“Well, I’d never cope, what can I say—your wife is so incredible.”

Drinking with Connor, Hugo found himself actually wanting to hear the details of how the guy found his wife in bed, what they actually got up to. It was also fascinating to hear his side of experiencing the shared wife phenomenon.

He said, “I think when I was first getting interested in her, the idea of pursuing a married woman just appealed because she’d want it no strings, you know? And then when she actually said yes—well, it was delicious to get something that should have been off-limits.”

“I can understand that appeal.”

“And then when we were on a date together—every time, it felt so different to any date I’d been on before. I mean, I date a lot of women, but it’s just so exciting being with Madeleine—she’s feeling this constant state of anxiety, that she’s being depraved or naughty for being on a date with you, and it’s just so hot.”

Hugo nodded, understanding that feeling perfectly.

“The first time we went back to my place for lunch, I remember how nervous she was. How she kept looking up at her place—at your

place. Like she wanted you to be there, but didn't."

Somehow, Hugo managed to remain stony faced. Somehow, he was able to raise his glass of beer without his hand shaking like crazy.

"I think she was actually disappointed that you weren't."

"Yeah?" Hugo's throat was parched, despite the beer.

"I mean, she quickly got over it. I remember it so distinctly. She was in these super tight jeans and a sweater that molded to her body."

Hugo knew the one. It was tight and scooped low enough to show off a healthy amount of cleavage. He hadn't seen her wear it in more than a few months. His body buzzed at the implications. "The pink and white one? With the stripes?"

Connor nodded. "That's the one. We'd had a few lunch meetings. Been on a few dates. She'd been so coy, putting me off. I tried to be cool, but I couldn't resist any more. Not with that sweater. So I suggested we pick up some lunch and eat it back at my place."

Hugo gulped. "And she said yes?"

"Took some convincing, but yeah."

"And that was your first time?"

Connor grinned. "First and second. We spent most of the afternoon together. She can be insatiable."

Hugo thought of the box of condoms and how empty it was. Everything started sliding into place. He felt sick to his stomach, but incredibly aroused at the same time.

"She can be," Hugo ventured.

"I started thinking about her all the time—when we weren't fucking, I mean."

"You did it a lot?"

Connor looked up at Hugo, realizing perhaps for the first time that this was all new territory for the man. "Not as much as I would have liked. We had all our lunch dates at my place after that. We met up at the

W a couple times, too, just to switch it up—she seemed to like that place.”

Hugo could feel the panic in him rise as quickly as his excitement. She’d been fucking him all this time. Months and months of Connor’s cock in her sweet, adulterous pussy.

“Yeah. We’ve had a few adventures there in the past,” Hugo said. He felt like a block of wood. His mind was on all those dates she’d had—dates in which she’d pretended to be seeing strange men. Dates she’d said led nowhere.

Dates that he’d encouraged her to go on.

“How did they usually go? Those times at the W?”

“They were always my favorite. I love the casual Madeleine, but when she dresses up...” Connor shook his head. “I love a girl in thigh highs or stockings and short little dresses. Lainie never disappointed. And she seemed to love to get down on her knees in nothing but those stockings and heels and... Well, you know.”

Hugo licked his lips and tried to swallow. “Yeah.”

“Anyway, as awesome as those times were, it was nothing compared to the first time we did it with you watching. She was so nervous, and yet... I mean, she’d always been passionate, but that night, she took things to another level.

“Yeah. You guys were pretty awesome to watch,” Hugo said. His shock had begun to clear. They were back in familiar territory.

No, it wasn’t just that. Madeleine had actually done what she’d planned on doing all along: she’d had her secret affair, then slowly revealed it to Hugo. He’d encouraged her to sleep with other men—even knew that she might do it without his knowledge. How could he be upset with her?

Connor went on. “She’s really into you, man. She adores you. And I’m pretty fucking envious of that. I want to find a girl like that—one

who'll be so into me, but without being the kind of boring submissive sap that's little more than a hole to fill."

"And maybe one that will embrace the idea of you sharing her?" Hugo smiled.

"Something like that. Hey, there was something else I wanted to talk to you about tonight," Connor said.

"Something else?"

"Yeah. It was about Madeleine's other relationship."

"Her other relationship?" Hugo's body went cold.

"Yeah. She won't tell me about it at all."

Hugo scratched his head. "No, no, what d'you mean, other relationship?"

"She didn't tell you? I got a hint that something else was up, but then she wouldn't say anything about it. I sure got the feeling she's been dating someone else when she's not with you or me—but she won't open up."

"Seriously?" Hugo said, staggered. "But she was so nervous when it came to dating you. Like it was the first time."

Lucy hadn't mentioned anything about this. Surely Madeleine would have told her if she'd been dating someone else as well. Then again, Lucy never told him that Connor and Madeleine had been fucking all long.

Hugo felt queasy. Numb with shock. It was the same sensation he'd felt just a few moments earlier, when he'd realized that she'd been with Connor long before he'd watched—only a thousand times as strong.

"I should ask Lucy about it."

"The chick she's out with tonight? Her friend from college?"

"Our Maid of Honor," Hugo nodded. "Those two don't have any secrets from each other. She'll either know what's going on—or else it's not going on."

Hugo started typing a text message to Lucy. Connor interrupted. “You know any other men she’s shown interest in since you guys decided she could start dating again?”

“A few. There’s a few guys she likes at the bookstore, one that she kissed once.”

“She kissed someone? Maybe it’s him.”

Hugo pressed send on the message:

> Is Madeleine with you tonight? She said she was hanging out with you this evening, but I get the feeling she might be dating again.

Connor said, “Do you think you might tell Madeleine you’re going to be out really late tonight? I don’t know, taking a client out, or something.”

“Why?”

He shrugged. “It’s probably a long shot, but maybe if she thinks you’re safely out of the way, she might think she can safely take a date back to your apartment for a few hours of play time.”

“I see.”

“We’d be able to see from my apartment.”

Twenty Five

They took a cab back, and Hugo felt the peculiarity of going into the wrong building—accompanying Connor into his apartment, somewhere he'd always thought would be the last place he'd ever visit.

On the way there, he received a text message from Lucy.

> She hasn't told me what she's doing tonight—what are you thinking might be happening? How late are you gonna be with your work friends?

Hugo showed Connor the text, which suggested that if Madeleine wasn't with Lucy, wasn't with either of them—and there wasn't an event or a late opening on at the bookstore that evening—then she had to be seeing someone new, or at least someone they did not count on her seeing.

“Text her back to say that you'll be out until very late with a client,” Connor said, then when Hugo looked confused, he said: “You know she's going to feed whatever information you give her straight back to Lainie, right?”

“I suppose.”

Connor hunched his shoulders and turned up his collar as they exited the yellow cab, and Hugo realized the need for stealth—if Madeleine wasn't back in the apartment with her date already, she might be on the way back, and recognizing her husband was now in league with her other lover might make her suspicious.

In the elevator on the way up, Hugo saw that his new friend appeared to be nervous.

“You okay?”

Connor nodded. “I guess it's a little unexpected, isn't it?”

“You don’t like the idea that Madeleine might be dating someone else as well?” Hugo asked, finding that actually, he was pretty relaxed about this whole deal himself. He’d wanted Madeleine to have fun with her sexuality, and this was exactly what she was doing if she was out dating another man.

Connor, though, might be sleeping with another man’s wife, but he’d come to find Madeleine more than just another fling, and to find that other men might be sharing her was probably a new concept for him.

“I’m not sure,” he said. “I mean, I’m the other man, so what right do I have to say who she should or shouldn’t see?”

“I guess you’re right,” said Hugo, and suddenly did not envy Connor at all. Although he was the new exciting toy in Madeleine’s life, as a mere date he didn’t have the same kind of role as a husband if he wasn’t so keen on Madeleine’s other dating habits.

“But it’s interesting, isn’t it? That she’s so free to see whoever she wants?”

“I’ll say.”

“Nice that she gets that excitement,” Connor said, as the elevator slowed to their floor. “If she’s pursuing her fantasy of an illicit affair again, she must be turned on like you wouldn’t believe.”

“It’s a hot thought, isn’t it? You think of the look on her face as she’s misbehaving, as she’s being so wicked in bedding someone else.”

It felt off to be teaching Connor the benefits of having an insatiable wife, almost like Hugo was trying to convert him. Well, when you discovered a wonderful thing, it was only natural to want to spread the word.

“The thing is,” Connor said, “I now see the real benefit the husband has in this kind of arrangement. When Prom’s over, he gets to leave with the Prom Queen.”

Connor’s apartment building was noticeably plusher than Hugo and Madeleine’s across the street—the fittings were nicer, the carpets in the

hallways, but the most obvious sign that this was for wealthier types than them was the sheer size of the hallways, and as Connor held his fingertip up to the scanner on the wall next to his front door, letting them into a huge great apartment, it was clear in the square footage and the ceiling height of the apartments.

Hugo felt an odd sense of familiarity with this apartment, having seen it so many times from across the street, most recently through a pair of opera glasses. But Connor kept the lights out after they came inside, and had them freeze just inside the door, in case anyone across the street was watching the apartment.

Still like statues, they looked out of the floor-to-ceiling windows to see that the lights were off in the windows that Hugo assumed to be those of his own apartment.

“What if they’re in there with the lights off?” Hugo whispered.

Connor smiled. “You don’t have to whisper,” he said. “They might be able to see us, they definitely can’t hear us.”

“Oh, right.”

Connor was peering at the building across the street. He said: “They don’t have the blinds drawn, which Lainie would usually do if she was up to anything.”

Hugo envied Connor his rich upbringing, to have an apartment like this. It stretched forever, with the kind of designer furniture, fixtures and fittings that made it look like some kind of movie set.

“Nice place,” he said, for something to say while they waited like idiot statues.

“Thanks.”

“Always made my insecurity that much more intense, imagining Madeleine coming over here, wanting this instead of what we have,” Hugo said.

“I think she’s perfectly happy with what she has,” Connor said. “A husband who worships her.”

“It’s nice you can take her out on glamorous dates, though. She likes that.”

“Happy to. Especially if I get to take her for a spin afterwards, so to speak.”

“So to speak.”

A few moments later, Connor was confident no one was in Hugo and Madeleine’s apartment, and they were safe to decamp onto a long sofa that faced away from the windows, and allowed someone sitting on it to peer over the back while concealing themselves—in this darkness at least—in the cushions.

“So how come you call her *Lainie*?” Hugo asked, since he had Connor cornered.

“Isn’t that what she’s called?”

“Never. Or at least, not before we came to New York. She was usually just Madeleine, occasionally Maddie.”

“She introduced herself to me as *Lainie*,” Connor said, getting up from the sofa seemingly with an idea.

“I guess it’s her way of creating a new persona for herself—for her dealings with other men.”

“A new persona—interesting.” Connor was in the corner of the large open-plan living area that appeared to be a study or office, complete with desk and bookshelves, ferreting through the desk drawers.

When he came back, he carried two pairs of black binoculars, one of which he handed over to Hugo.

“What was she like, before?” Connor asked him now, as they both peered through the high-powered lenses at the windows into Hugo and Madeleine’s apartment. “Before you came to New York, before you started feeding her this idea about dating other men.”

Hugo sighed, as ever feeling it wasn’t his place to discuss Madeleine’s condition with anyone, particularly not her new lover.

Playing it safe, he described Madeleine as the woman he'd married, the woman he'd fallen in love with.

"Sharp as a straight razor, pretty as a peach," he smiled. "But we were both fairly conventional back in Boston, you know. Monogamous, relatively conservative in how we saw dating."

"She never gave you any suggestions that she might like to see other men?"

"Never. And I wouldn't have considered it back then," Hugo said. "If she so much as looked at another guy, I'd start getting all jealous and uptight."

"You still get jealous, right? You said that."

"Yes, but in those days, I didn't enjoy it, I didn't see it the right way ____"

Hugo was interrupted by a light coming on in the apartment across the street—or at least, he initially thought it was a light coming on, but on examination through the binoculars, he saw that it was in fact the front door opening.

Someone was entering the apartment.

Now a light did come on—the warm glow of a table lamp, then more around the living room, revealing Madeleine as expected, but then also Lucy, stepping in through the front door to put her coat up on the coat rack.

"Lucy?"

"That's your friend Lucy?"

"Yeah. I guess she was lying then, when she said she didn't know where Madeleine was," Hugo said. He actually felt a fair amount of relief—Madeleine wasn't having a secret affair, at least not yet. She'd been telling the truth when she'd said she was simply having a girls' night with Lucy that evening.

So why had Lucy felt the need to lie?

“It’s not necessarily proof that she’s not dating someone else,” Connor sniffed. Was he disappointed not to have uncovered this new dark facet of the woman they shared?

They watched in silence for a while as Madeleine and Lucy poured themselves glasses of wine, then sat on the couch in front of the TV to gossip.

Hugo felt a touch disappointed now, that this wasn’t the start of a whole new adventure for Madeleine. Still, it had been interesting to meet Connor. He felt a little uncertain as to what he ought to do now—he’d told Lucy and Madeleine that he’d be out late with a client. Perhaps it was just best to say he’d skipped out early, or that the client had decided to get some sleep.

“She’s very pretty, Madeleine’s friend,” Connor said.

“Yes, she is.”

“Single?”

“As it happens, yes.”

“Interesting.”

They continued to watch, and Hugo found himself curious as to why Connor was not bringing their night vigil to a close, since it was quite plain that Madeleine was not having an affair, and not entertaining a new man in the apartment across the street.

Putting down his binoculars briefly, he looked across at Connor and got the idea that the guy was watching Lucy, not Madeleine. Was he interested?

The girls were having fun, chatting and laughing and drinking wine and watching something on TV that Hugo couldn’t make out. He started wondering if he ought to head home himself, since it was beginning to get late.

“What was it that made you think she was seeing someone else tonight?” Hugo asked Connor.

“She said something about seeing a friend.”

“She is seeing a friend—Lucy.”

“But she wouldn’t tell me about her.”

“And that’s evidence she’s seeing someone else?”

Connor chuckled. “If she was simply having a girls’ night out with her best friend, she’d have told me instead of being all mysterious.”

“Maybe she just goes out with Lucy to nightclubs, and pulls random guys while she’s there.”

“Maybe.”

“She hasn’t tonight.”

“Looks that way.”

Now it was Hugo’s turn to laugh. “You sound disappointed she’s only come home with Lucy—you want her to see other guys?”

Connor shrugged. “I told you I was curious how it would feel.”

“But she already sleeps with me, you know that.”

“I’m not sure you really count in this—I’ve always known she had you as her primary.”

“So what now?” Hugo asked him.

Connor paused, then said, “She will want to date other guys, won’t she? It won’t be quite the same as what you feel when she’s with me or someone else, but maybe it’ll be something like it.”

Hugo peered through his binoculars at Madeleine and Lucy. Did they have a secret about who else Madeleine was seeing? Would it come out at some point?

He saw Madeleine getting up from the couch, wandering over to the kitchen to retrieve something from the refrigerator—a glass bowl containing something red. Hugo steadied the hand holding the spyglasses and on focusing, saw they were strawberries. Very decadent.

When she returned to the couch, Madeleine was smiling and laughing and offering one of the ripe red fruits to Lucy—holding it right up to her mouth.

Lucy appeared to appreciate the offering. A little scarlet juice dribbled down from the corner of her mouth. With a broad grin, she picked her own strawberry, then fed it to Madeleine. It made her quite giggly as she allowed her friend to push it between her lips.

“What are they eating?” Connor asked.

“Strawberries, I’d say. I didn’t know we had any in our fridge.”

They watched the girls swapping strawberries, each choosing one for the other, not for herself. There was something very graceful in the way they were together—assured, familiar, confident, happy. The way they laughed with each other, so innocent and joyful, made Hugo happy, banishing his memories of the dark times. It also made him curious about how sensual this experience appeared.

“Why would she keep another relationship secret from you?” Hugo asked his new friend. “I mean, she has no reason to. Not like you’re wanting her to settle down with you, go exclusive.”

“Not sure,” Connor said. “I had hoped to find out.”

“You haven’t told her she can’t see anyone else?”

“Of course not. I love that she’s breaking out into wild territory.”

Madeleine nearly dropped one of the strawberries Lucy offered her, and watching her, Hugo suspected she was getting fairly drunk—not that he’d seen her take a drink for a while.

Lucy dropped one, too, and they both giggled about it.

Teasing her friend, Madeleine took the next fruit between her lips, and looked as though she was about to let it slip out, which was apparently a bad thing in this little drunken game of theirs. Lucy moved in to keep it from falling—but then Hugo gasped as he saw the pretty Asian-American move further in, to stop the strawberry falling by taking it with her own mouth—almost kissing Madeleine.

“She must know I’m watching,” Connor whispered, a pointless hushing of his voice considering. “God, they’re trying to drive me crazy.”

Madeleine gave Lucy a funny look—Hugo couldn't quite gauge what it was. Were they joking with each other, fooling around? It was such an intense look, though, her eyes sharp, not drunk.

Then, the two of them closed in on each other again, only without a strawberry to save.

Hugo gasped as he watched his wife tilt her head slightly, her nose moving against Lucy's, her lips opening to draw Lucy's lips in, eyes closing, tongue slipping out...

Madeleine was kissing Lucy, and it wasn't a chaste peck on the cheek.

Twenty Six

The two beautiful women were smiling at each other like long lost lovers reunited, hands locking together as they brushed noses affectionately, their lips crushing against each other once again.

“Well, I guess they’re still practicing, huh?” Connor said.

Hugo remained silent as they watched Lucy lean back, lying down on the couch as Madeleine crawled over her like a panther on the prowl. They were so beautiful together, so graceful, their hands moving over each other’s curves with elegant poise as they kissed.

Connor sighed, “Seriously.”

They saw Madeleine fumble with Lucy’s fly, then she was pulling her friend’s jeans down her smooth, golden thighs, over her knees, off completely to reveal a pair of pink panties. Madeleine lost her skirt, and the two were kissing each other again, Madeleine on top of Lucy, both of them revealing their underwear.

Hugo felt himself trembling, his breathing deep—he was a little confused, wondering how long this had been going on. Madeleine so clearly more than just a friend for Lucy, more than a best friend.

He watched them, feeling sheer shock that she’d kept this from him. And yet he wasn’t angry—he wasn’t in the slightest bit jealous. Watching the real affection in Madeleine’s eyes, the real love for Lucy that she clearly felt, it just didn’t trigger the primal instincts that Madeleine’s playing with other men did.

He liked watching her with Lucy, smiling at their forbidden love as she slipped a hand up the raven-haired girl’s top. Lucy broke away from their kiss briefly to moan as she felt her best friend’s hand cup her small breasts. Hugo did not feel remotely threatened, even as a rational part of

his brain reasoned that she could just as easily run off with Lucy as she could with Connor.

Hugo wasn't prejudiced—it was biology. He just didn't feel a hint of antagonism about Madeleine pulling down Lucy's shirt to reveal her sweet little breasts and those dark, stiff nipples that seemed to call out for her kiss.

"So this is the big reveal," Connor said, in awe, and Hugo felt somehow proud of his wife.

Madeleine sat up, Lucy moving with her, pushing up her top, neither of them apparently choosing to wear a bra for that evening's girls' night out. Lucy teased Madeleine's fuller chest with her mouth, sucking on her hard nipples, enjoying the softness, the roundness of her cleavage, the heat of her paler flesh.

They were so natural together, their smiles so tender, so affectionate for each other. Locked together on the couch, wearing nothing but panties, feeding each other the occasional strawberry again, though in between kisses, in between fondling, indulging in the velvet sensations of skin-on-skin, both breathing in the other, both seemingly celebrating their little naughty tryst behind closed doors.

Madeleine rose to her feet, and Hugo felt his heart thudding as she offered her hand to Lucy, helping her up with a flash of suggestive, bedroom eyes.

"It's gone past fooling around, huh?" Connor said in the still of his darkened apartment.

Hugo was on fire, so hard at the prospect of Madeleine cheating on him with Lucy. The dark secret she'd harbored now revealed, along with a whole new sexy side. How long had they been continuing this physical aspect of their relationship? Since college?

Madeleine led the pretty Asian-American girl through to the bedroom, carrying the bowl of strawberries with her. Hugo kept his enhanced gaze fixed on them, watching Lucy climb onto the bed, lying

on her back, looking up with excited eyes as a grinning Madeleine sat between her feet, reaching for her panties.

“I don’t think they’ve been doing this that long, actually,” Connor said, almost reading Hugo’s mind to find the questions lurking there.

“You don’t think?”

Madeleine was caressing Lucy, her hands moving around the other girl’s underwear, tracing circles over her smooth skin, teasing her at the edges of her panties.

“I think it’s possible—probable, even—that they had something in college beyond kiss-practice,” Connor said. “But they haven’t done anything for years until recently. You can see the excitement in their eyes at this. This isn’t something that’s been long-term.”

As they watched his wife now pulling her friend’s panties off, over her thighs, up over her knees and feet, Hugo felt mild relief at Connor’s assessment.

Strange to see Lucy like this. He’d always thought of her as attractive, though strictly off limits to admiring glances being his wife’s best friend. He’d certainly never seen her naked before. Sprawled out on the bed, slender but with enough of the curves to excite, and all that beautiful golden skin.

He found his breathing was growing heavy as he watched Madeleine fall onto her bare friend, kissing her again. She moved down the other girl’s trim body, over her stomach, skirting over her clear, smooth skin to the tidy little patch of dark hair over her mound.

Wow, oh wow.

Madeleine picked another ripe, juicy strawberry and trailed it over Lucy’s skin, over the slight swell of her chest and across her flat stomach. The initial touch of the cold fruit on the other girl caused her to flinch and giggle.

Madeleine circled the fruit around Lucy’s glistening pussy, saying something to her that Hugo wished he could hear.

Then she dipped the fruit inside Lucy, dragging its point across the other woman's smooth pussy lips. Lucy shuddered. Madeleine drew the fruit away, lifting it to her mouth. Crushing it between her teeth. She tasted her friend's come blended with the sweet, red juice.

The men watched in silence as Madeleine chose another strawberry, and began penetrating Lucy with it, fucking her with the fruit, making the pretty dark-haired girl lie back, eyes closed, moaning.

"I take it back. She's done this before," Connor chuckled. "Naughty girl."

Hugo was shocked and thrilled, thinking how difficult it was to really know someone, even someone you've been married to for so long. They can always surprise you—in good ways and bad. He had to believe this was a surprise in a good way.

Madeleine gently slipped one strawberry completely inside Lucy, and then another, and then another. Hugo was astounded, but the girls seemed only to laugh and giggle as Lucy's pussy was filled with ripe fruit.

Then Madeleine sucked on the other girl's dark pussy lips, teasing the tender flesh with her mouth, and through the powerful binoculars, Hugo could see the strawberry juice trickling out.

He had to hand it to her, his wife seemed to have a skilled tongue when it came to pleasuring another woman, flicking over Lucy's sensitive pink folds as though sampling a delicacy.

"How do you feel?"

"Oh, well, you know," Hugo didn't quite have the words to describe how he was feeling. He watched Lucy's body undulating, rising and falling in waves to Madeleine's mouth between her legs. Lucy's hands found their way to Madeleine's head, fingers slipping through her blonde tresses, driving her on and on. Madeleine slid her fingers inside her friend's slippery groove to take her further and further as she slowly retrieved the crushed fruit.

He had to see it as merely Madeleine feeling liberated, encouraged to do as she pleased in exploring her sexuality—not some kind of threat to their marriage that had come completely out of left field.

“Do you feel jealous?” Connor asked.

They saw Lucy’s body quiver and shudder, and Hugo wondered if Madeleine had made her come already. Well, no one knew how to please a woman as well as a woman.

“Not really,” Hugo said. “Not at all, actually. I mean, it’s probably some kind of completely unfair prejudice inside my biology that makes me unable to accept that a woman could be any kind of threat to my marriage—but I can’t help it, even though my head tells me there’s just as much chance that she might decide to leave me for Lucy as for you.”

“Oh, there’s no chance of that. Zero chance she’d ever leave you.”

That felt good, coming from Connor.

“I know. I trust her—she might want to keep things from me until she’s ready, but I always wanted her to feel free to do as she wants. I guess I only made the assumption that she might want to see other men.”

They watched Lucy urged Madeleine up. Madeleine flashed a mischievous grin and slipped a last strawberry into her friend’s mouth, flavored by her own juices.

The pretty Asian American leaned forward to kiss the blonde’s stomach, and ease her panties down her thighs.

“God, you’re so lucky, Hugo—do you see that?”

Lucy kissed Madeleine on the mouth, the passion between them unmistakable. This was no practicing. Tasting herself on Madeleine’s lips, she pushed Madeleine back so that she could take charge. Her lips nibbled her friend’s soft skin down her neck, her chest, licking around her breasts and those bullet-like nipples, her hands finding and caressing Madeleine’s strikingly bare mound.

“Having a wife that will share herself with you like this,” Connor continued. “Open up about all her fantasies, about everything that turns

her on.”

“Opening up?”

“She is, you know,” he said. “She’s doing this with those blinds open, isn’t she?”

Lucy edged down Madeleine’s body, seeming to worship her curves.

“There’s no way she could know that I’m over here watching her, though,” Hugo said.

Madeleine’s hand gently stroked Lucy’s hair as the dark-haired woman ducked down to plant a soft kiss on the apex of her pussy. Lucy glanced up and smiled at her, that warm affectionate smile that reflected a strong connection between them. Then she, too, was sampling the ripe red fruit with the added seasoning from her friend’s wet pussy.

If Madeleine loved Lucy, it didn’t detract from the love she had for her husband. Hugo saw that. Her love was not in a finite quantity, to spread more thinly if shared between more people.

“But she could know that *I’m* over here watching,” Connor said. “She knows I could be home tonight—she’s putting on a show for me.”

“So how is that—“

“Perhaps she’s hoping to let Lucy in on this little game of ours,” Connor said. Hugo found the idea enticing. “Is Lucy like Madeleine? She likes guys as well?”

“Very much so.”

“So it looks to me that whether she believes I’m here watching now or not, she’s preparing to introduce Lucy to our little dynamic. And if she’s serious about getting off having you watching us, she’ll want you to see her with Lucy as well.”

Abandoning the fruit, Lucy feasted on Madeleine’s pussy, pushing her face into her flesh as she drove her tongue inside her. Madeleine simply lay back, panting in response at the powerful sensations she was creating inside her.

Did she want Connor to see?

“See how she’s holding Lucy’s hair back, so we can all watch?”

Connor said. “And the way they’re lying—angled toward us, so everything’s on display for anyone watching over here.”

“I suppose so.”

Lucy broke off to focus more energy on her fingers, gazing down at Madeleine’s pretty pussy while she used those fingers to reach deep inside her, find those sensitive parts her tongue could not reach. Leaning down again to bathe her clit in her hot mouth, Madeleine’s body writhing under her as she fucked her with those flexible fingers.

Hugo tried not to feel bad that Madeleine was apparently doing this so that Connor might just be able to see her, that she wasn’t really doing this to show him, her husband. It was exciting, wasn’t it? That she was doing this at all.

He saw Madeleine glance toward the window, saying something to her friend, and then Lucy was looking their way, mildly uncertain about their overt display. Was she telling Lucy they might have an audience? She couldn’t know Hugo was there, but could know that Connor was enjoying the show.

Maybe she did intend, one day, to reveal this side of her to her husband. It was in the open now.

“What has she got?” Connor was murmuring.

Madeleine had pulled something out of her bedside table, and Hugo had half an idea what it was before she was holding it up to her friend, encouraging her up onto all fours, licking her pussy from behind as though to prepare her for it, as though Lucy wasn’t completely soaking already.

“Naughty girl,” the other man was laughing softly.

Madeleine glided the tip of the long glass object over Lucy’s pussy, one hand on her ass, twisting it slowly as she eased it inside her, stretching her pussy around it. Lucy looked gravely serious, somehow, as

she had her tight channel filled by this pink-tinted crystalline phallus, biting her lip as she was stretched by it, unused to its size.

Was his wife preparing Lucy to take something more like Connor's cock? Both women kept flashing glances over to the windows, as though they were thinking about the possibility that Madeleine's crush might one day join them.

Hugo felt excluded, and yet thrilled by his wife's dark secrets. The fact she appeared to be planning a secret threesome.

Madeleine was gently thrusting the thing inside Lucy's pussy, her other hand nestling between her thighs to coax her clit while she fucked her, watching closely as the thing pushed into her. Hugo thinking this was a toy he'd never seen Madeleine with before—had she just got it for this night?

Then Madeleine lay down, on her back, encouraging Lucy to drop down so that she could kiss her clit while continuing to penetrate her with the huge dildo, something that seemed to get Lucy quickly back to orgasm.

When it came time for payback, Lucy snatched the toy from Madeleine, but in turning to apply it to Madeleine's own open pussy, she continued to press her own flower down over Madeleine's mouth, the blonde perfectly happy to continue lapping at her juices.

"You think they want us to go over there?" Connor whispered in the darkness.

"Us?" Hugo said.

"Well, they want me to go over there," the other man said confidently.

"What if they don't?"

"Then they should have closed the blinds."

Connor grinned. What a strange, strange situation. This other man declaring that he was going to go over there and sleep with his wife, as

she herself slept with her friend Lucy. Where did that leave Hugo? How did he fit in with the equation?

“You’re going to go over there?”

Connor fastened his jacket, and dropped his binoculars on the couch as he stood up. “You bet,” he said. “Wouldn’t miss this for the world.”

Hugo felt awkward. He wasn’t ready to just storm into the apartment to find Madeleine with Lucy. And with Connor in tow, it would just seem bizarre.

“Hey, you’re welcome to stay, see how things pan out,” Connor said, heading for the door. “Come over when you’re ready.”

Hugo nodded, feeling nervous again, the butterflies in his stomach threatening to bring back a hint of that jealous nausea, though he wasn’t entirely sure why. Because this other man was about to go over there and claim the women in his pack? Or because this man was going over there to indulge in the kind of threesome Hugo had once coveted.

A pause, one last chance for Hugo to decide to accompany Connor.

“There’s supplies in the fridge if you get hungry,” Connor grinned, the expression on his face a clear final invitation.

Hugo nodded. “I think I’d like to see what happens when you go over there. If they let you join them, maybe I’ll think about coming over too.”

“A sound strategy,” Connor said, opening the front door. “If they kick me out, then you know to leave the two of them to it.”

“Hey, have fun,” he said, feeling strange about encouraging this man to walk across the street and, most likely, to fuck his wife.

“Thanks, Hugo.”

Twenty Seven

Hugo had to rub his eyes and look again as he returned his focus to the binoculars and what was happening in the apartment across the street.

Lucy was now straddling Madeleine's hips, her body rising and falling as though riding a man.

Only after a while did he catch sight of the sex toy joining them, the thing curved in such a way as to penetrate them both as Lucy danced and writhed on top of Madeleine.

Hugo couldn't hear what was going on over there, but he saw the sudden flinch in them both, and the way their heads turned toward the source of the noise as the doorbell sounded. Connor had arrived, making the journey in double-quick time.

He saw Madeleine reach over and check her phone for any sign of a message she'd missed from Hugo that he was on his way. Then she threw on a bath robe and shared a worried look with Lucy. Lucy gathered up her clothes, ready to dive into the closet if she needed to.

Did that mean they weren't intending to reveal their relationship, as Connor had suggested?

Clutching her bath robe tightly about her, Madeleine padded through to the living room and the front door, looking nervously at the clock above the TV, as though to decide whether it was proper for a young woman to answer the door in a bath robe at this time in the evening.

She opened the door slowly, and Hugo felt his heart in his mouth—he felt nervous for Connor, strangely, his throat dry out of concern that the girls would be angry at the younger man's intrusion.

And there he was, standing in the hallway, a big puppy grin plastered on his face. Hugo couldn't see Madeleine's face at all, but the

way Connor maintained his smile could only mean she was pleased to see him. She took a step back to allow him into the apartment, and turned such that Hugo could see that she was smiling.

With the front door closed, Connor grabbed Madeleine, pulling her in for a kiss, his hands venturing inside her bathrobe, nudging the garment off her shoulders. Could he taste Lucy on her lips?

Whether or not Madeleine had known he was watching, or had expected him to make an appearance, she was all over him now. Her hands moved feverishly to strip off his clothes even as he kissed her.

Hugo flicked his binoculars back to the next window, to see Lucy hovering with her clothes in her arms, wondering what was going on out there in the living room. Then, her tense expression seemed to release, and she dropped her clothes back on the chair by Madeleine's dresser, and climbing into the bed to conceal herself from the neck down with the bed sheets.

With Connor wearing only a pair of Calvin Kleins, most of his athletic frame on display, Madeleine grabbed one of his hands and pulled him like livestock through to the bedroom, where Lucy was laughing and coyly holding the bed sheets up under her chin.

They were all laughing, nervous but excited.

All except Hugo, who watched from across the street feeling that familiar tightness in his stomach as he saw his beautiful wife push a half-naked man back on their bed, straddle his thighs and slowly peel his underwear down over a semi-erect and growing cock.

Lucy had allowed the bed sheets to drop to reveal her breasts to this stranger who now lay naked before her, and as Madeleine closed her fist around Connor's hardness, pumping him up to full size, Lucy leaned forward at her friend's prompting to take him inside her mouth. She did nothing to stop Connor flicking back the bed sheets to reveal her bottom half.

Apparently completely unfazed by his joining them, the girls traded his cock back and forth between them, and when he thought he could get away with it, Connor glanced over to the window to see if he could tell if Hugo was reacting to what he saw, or perhaps to try to entice him to come across the street.

Hugo felt that low-level burn in his stomach when he saw Madeleine stretching her lips around him, and sinking down on his shaft, her eyes closed, enjoying herself with her favorite toy.

Why did he feel this jealousy with Connor, and not Lucy? Was it prejudice? He was so into the whole equality thing, and yet his fundamental masculinity could not comprehend the threat that a woman represented to his bond with Madeleine?

He felt conflicted, again, watching these beautiful women playing with Connor's cock. A strange contentedness that Madeleine would share Connor with her friend, but not her husband, the idea suggesting she valued him too much to share. And yet also the feeling that he was missing an opportunity, an experience, in not sharing Lucy with Madeleine, an opportunity Madeleine would allow Connor, but not him.

But hadn't she purposefully encouraged Lucy to get closer to him? Lucy had become his guardian angel through this. And then Madeleine had tried to get her to seduce him...

No, he wasn't entirely comfortable with the idea of getting involved with Lucy herself. It was simpler to appreciate the sight of Madeleine enjoying herself with her friend, with Connor, with whoever.

Connor looked as though he was in seventh heaven, but after a while, he ushered Madeleine up and changed places with her. Hugo took a deep breath as he watched the other man lining up between her thighs, pushing her knees apart, placing the tip of his hardness to her slick entrance.

Jesus, it really wasn't any easier to watch, even now that it had already happened before.

Connor eased forward, and Madeleine moaned as he pushed inside her, bareback once again, her eyes closed as she felt his swollen organ violate her, stretch her, fill her. Hugo gasped to see his sweet bride penetrated by another man without even a condom to prevent him from pumping his semen deep inside her.

Lucy draped herself over Madeleine, periodically kissing her full breasts, sucking on her nipples, but for the most part completely absorbed in the spectacle of this toned man thrusting inside her friend. Madeleine snaked an arm around her, stroking her head, though she had little focus available for Lucy, lying there panting as he pierced her tightness with that huge beast.

Hugo found himself thinking about Connor's suggestion that he go over there too—he was tempted. The power of the experience when he'd been inside the wardrobe, watching this other man fucking his wife just a few feet away, had been overwhelming. But to see Madeleine with Lucy as well, that would be quite something.

But he felt he did not want to miss a minute of this strange spectacle. The girls ushered Connor onto his back so that Lucy could straddle him, his big wet prick sliding inside her pussy. At first Madeleine just watched them close up, curious to see this spectacle. Then she straddled Connor herself, dropping her sweet bare pussy onto his willing mouth.

The girls leaned in to kiss each other as they used the man beneath.

Hugo felt his heart begin to palpitate again as Connor pulled himself up to take control, this time Madeleine was on all fours, allowing him to thrust into her from behind, her golden hair flowing down, her face showing the strain as he stretched her, his big hard shaft glistening with her juices as he sank into her time after time without protection.

When Lucy moved under Madeleine, lying on her front but flat to the bed, Connor had his choice between two open pussies, the girls giggling in between moans as he alternated between them.

The intensity that Hugo felt was absent whenever Connor pulled out of his wife and sank into Lucy.

It was beautiful to watch him with the dark-haired vixen, they seemed made for each other, with the chemistry between them undeniable, Connor's eyes lighting up with a new kind of energy that wasn't the same with Madeleine.

But for Hugo, it wasn't so powerful an experience until the man was back thrusting inside his wife, causing her such forceful and obvious pleasure as he pounded her from the rear, the muscles in his athletic body rippling as he drove into her, her graceful form undulating in response to his penetration.

The ecstasy imprinted on her face caused by someone other than her husband.

Lucy pulled away from her sharing of Connor's cock, and moved up the bed, twisting onto her back so that she could face Madeleine as this other man continued to fuck her. Lucy could watch her friend up close breaking her marriage vows, but she continued moving so that Madeleine could kiss her way down her body, over her small breasts and taut stomach to that soft dark down over her mound.

Madeleine seemed happy enough to bury her face between Lucy's thighs, every thrust from Connor shoving her against the Asian girl's quivering folds, to pass on some of the force of her penetration through her eager lips and tongue.

Hugo found his focus dwelling on that connection between his wife and the younger man, the insertion of that great giant cock inside her, and how it seemed to both amaze and enthrall her.

He couldn't tell how much of his paranoia was real, his thoughts that she never looked quite this sexually voracious, quite as well fucked as when she was with him—and yet it was nevertheless exciting to him as well, that she was experiencing this, in addition to his more tender lovemaking.

This whole experience for Madeleine had been from Hugo's gift.

Connor pushed her down onto the bed, so he was straddling her thighs and holding her hips firmly while plunging into her from behind, her legs locked together. Hugo caught a brief glance from the other man, over toward the windows, as though he was checking his audience was still there, was responding to this display.

Madeline almost looked as though she was in pain, the pleasure was so intense.

Another brief glance from Connor, and Hugo could see a wave of energy wash over the three of them. Where the orgasm started, he couldn't tell, but one triggered it in another and then the third, and it overwhelmed them all.

Connor was making sure Hugo could see that he was inside Madeleine, penetrating deep as the climax hit, his body suddenly tensing up, his hands gripping Madeleine's hips firmly as he began pumping his hot come inside her, pushing himself as far inside her as he could.

Hugo was unable to keep himself from shaking as he saw the other man inseminating his wife, and the look of wonder and joy on Madeleine's pretty face as she felt his hot oil filling her.

He felt suddenly cold, drained of energy as he saw them finally disengage, and there was Madeleine's exquisite pussy all reddened from another man's cock, glistening with the telltale trickle of white leaking out. Connor stroked her, teasing her pussy to emphasize the fact to their audience.

Connor had probably done this before, but it was the first time Hugo had seen it with his own eyes. He was surprised the impact it had on him. Yet for all the shock and the shivers that went through him, he was so hard to see it, and so desperate to pounce on Madeleine himself, to plunge his own hardness inside her. It was proof of her wickedness, her insatiability, her depravity, and therefore somehow hot to her husband, even if it went against everything he thought he believed about marriage.

Madeleine was lying back catching her breath, her face blissed out as though she was still feeling the echoes of her incredible pleasure flowing through her.

Hugo watched as Lucy now sank down onto Madeleine, lapping gently at her, smiling and laughing as she cleaned the traces of her infidelity.

Connor stroked Lucy, appreciating her naked beauty, when Hugo saw him quite unmistakably revealing all to the two women about just who might be watching from across the street.

Twenty Eight

Hugo felt panic grip his heart. He pulled himself back, sat on the couch so he was hidden from the outside, gasping for breath.

Were they angry, Madeleine and Lucy? Angry that Connor had let him in on their secret, that both men had been watching their intimate, personal time? Hugo felt certain this was how they had taken the knowledge that he was over here, watching them. Both women had turned their heads, eyes wide, mouths gaping, shocked to learn about their unexpected observer, and the surprising collusion between husband and suitor to learn of Madeleine's true relationship with Lucy.

Whether or not they had been intending to let Connor in on their little game—and from their reaction to his arrival over there, it appeared that they had at least half-expected him to watch them—it was probable that they did not intend for Hugo to know about all this, not at this stage.

He waited a few moments, wondering if they'd actually seen him in this dark apartment, or whether he could slip out and pretend that anything they'd been told about him by Connor was merely his attempt to wind them up.

When he turned, and edged his head up far enough to see over the back of the couch, he was a little surprised to find Madeleine was no longer in the bedroom. In fact, he couldn't see any sign of her anywhere in the apartment at all. Lucy and Connor were still there in the bed, getting familiar with each other while lying side-by-side, Connor apparently already hard and inside her again as he nuzzled into her, kissing her neck.

Where was Madeleine?

Hugo shifted his binoculars to the front door just in time to see it close. Was she coming over here?

He felt rattled, not knowing what to do now. Could he make an exit while she was going down in the elevator? He would invariably take as long to get down to street level as she would, so would probably see her as she crossed the road. What if he timed it so that he was descending as she was in the elevator coming up to this floor?

He figured escape was a lousy idea. She'd be even more angry with him if he fled. She'd know he had, too. She'd never believe him that he'd never been here, that Connor was making it up that he had. He had to face it, there was going to be a confrontation.

Trying to keep calm, figuring he wasn't the first of them who had kept secrets from the other, he tidied himself up and waited.

It wasn't long until the doorbell sounded.

"Hey."

Oh God, she looked so unbelievably gorgeous. Wincingly, heart-stoppingly, deeply arousingly gorgeous. Wearing her black coat with matching scarf, her dirty-blond hair fell in waves around her pretty face. Her smeared make-up lent her the mischievous air of a bad girl—confirming her status as a sexy, insatiable wife. Hugo felt certain he couldn't handle having this goddess mad at him, he would do whatever it took to seek her forgiveness for his intrusion.

"So you had your secret affair," he said.

"How much did you see?"

"All of it. From when you came in. Are you angry with me?"

"Wait—am I angry with you?" she said sharply, making Hugo flinch, ready for the fireworks.

"For watching you. I know I wasn't supposed to be here."

"Angry with you?" she laughed, but confused rather than amused.

"I came over here to see if you were angry with me."

"Why would I be angry with you?" Hugo said, realizing that a normal husband probably would be angry at Madeleine's secret sexual explorations.

“For being with Lucy, for not telling you.”

Hugo smiled. “Why would I be angry about that?” he asked her. “You know it’s up to you who you’re with. And I know you were with Connor a long while before the first time you let me see.”

That little revelation surprised her too. But she saw that he wasn’t mad at her.

“And you’re not at all angry at me for that?”

“Maybe a little, for keeping such a hot secret from me,” he grinned. “You’re not angry at me for prying?”

She returned his smile, her face lighting up in that way that always made him feel as though someone had ignited his insides—true devastating beauty. “Of course not,” she said. “I like it when you watch, you know that. Are you upset you didn’t get to see our first time?”

He looked at her, then shook his head. “It was near enough. I know your first time must have been a something like the first time I saw you. You were still nervous, beautiful, hot beyond belief. I believed it was your first time at the time—I had that experience.”

“Yes, I think you did. It would have been much the same.”

“Maybe the next affair you have, you’ll let me see the beginning.”

Her pretty mouth broke into a smile. Madeleine stepped inside the door, and reached for him, pulling him to her forcefully. “My next affair. Hmm. Actually, I wanted to talk to you about that.”

“Oh?”

She reached up on tip-toes for a passionate kiss. Her lips were so soft, a touch waxy from her lipstick and tasted faintly sweet from the fruit, yet with a piquant flavor Hugo realized reflected her run-in with Lucy and Connor. There was real fire in that kiss, even before the door closed behind her, and her coat opened to reveal she was wearing absolutely nothing underneath other than her scarf. Both of them were dispelling perceptions that either had wronged the other, while reconnecting and confirming their incredible bond.

“My company wants me to move to head office,” she said. “To take my ideas to the next level.”

“That’s fantastic, honey! Congratulations!”

“But also, it might free me up to pursue one of the guys at the bookstore, if you’re happy for me to.”

Hugo slipped his hands down her naked torso, and pushed her back against the wall beside the front door, now kissing his way down her velvet neck.

“Since you wouldn’t be working with them any more.”

“Not directly, no.”

Hugo couldn’t help smiling. “It wouldn’t be someone tall, dark and handsome, would it?”

“Maybe,” she flashed her eyes.

She moaned gently as he sucked on her neck, his hands fondling her breasts, thumbs grazing over her sensitive nipples.

“So how long has that been going on for—with Lucy, I mean.”

“I don’t know,” she said. “I guess we used to fool around a little in college—you know, innocent stuff. Occasionally since then, well, there’s been a few times here and there when we’ve had a lot to drink...”

“But recently you’ve been seeing more of her?”

“Not for ages—and then, you know, I was being more confident and flirtatious generally, and she was talking about moving to New York, and you were talking about me being with other guys...”

“You’ve been dating her since then?”

He returned to kiss her mouth, sucking on her tongue softly, inhaling her sweet scent with every breath, finding it such a thrill that she tasted and smelled different from normal, because he knew she’d been having sex with the couple now engaged in their own little private fling across the street.

“It was never really dating,” Madeleine said. “Just hanging out really, fooling around if we felt like it.”

“Sounds like dating to me.”

She smiled, and he could see a hint of wickedness in that smile. She said, “You’d like me to call it dating?”

He grinned. “Kind of hot to think my beautiful wife dates other men—and women.”

She laughed. “I forgot how men are so hung up on the whole lesbian thing.”

Hugo slipped off her coat, both of them allowing it to just slump to the ground as he sucked on her firm nipples, hands running down her heavenly curves.

“You’re not a lesbian, though,” he said.

“I’ve never found myself drawn to any other woman.”

“But you do have feelings for her. Beyond just fooling around.”

Madeleine looked suddenly sad, regretful, as though this was a revelation too far, which might mean she’d have to end everything with her Maid of Honor.

“She’s my best friend.”

“She’s more than that.”

Madeleine shrugged, but looked almost as though tears were on their way. Hugo felt more than a little strange, though jealousy still was not really rearing its head, despite the apparent confirmation that his wife had a fairly significant emotional bond with someone else.

Things were clicking into place in his head about Madeleine, about who she was, what drove her.

He made another mental jump, joining two dots that hadn’t seemed remotely close. “Lucy said you slept with someone at your bachelorette party,” he said. “It was her, wasn’t it?”

“Yes,” Madeleine said, lighting another fire within Hugo’s chest.

So it went back as far as that.

She looked as though she was now bracing herself for his anger, for his rejection, for him to order her out of his life. But Hugo smiled, and

kissed her tenderly, completely catching her off guard. Then he was crouching, kneeling, breathing in that strange musk lingering around her, kissing his way down her stomach, hands gently fondling her breasts as he made his way to the enticing camber of her smooth, shaven mound, where her spicy aroma only intensified.

He said, "If you feel so strongly about her, could you handle sharing her?"

Madeleine turned her head toward the windows and the view across the street, and she let out a little gasp, though Hugo wasn't sure whether it was from seeing Lucy now making love to Connor, or because he was now lapping at her soaking, swollen pussy lips, pushing up one of her legs so that her foot balanced on his shoulder.

"You think she might want to go out with him?" Madeleine asked her husband.

"Would you be okay with that if she did?"

She looked down at him, panting as he sucked on her labia, lapped up her slick nectar, pressing his face to a pussy already flushed from its earlier attention from Lucy and Connor.

"Of course," Madeleine smiled, confidence returning to her pretty face. "I think he'd be perfect for her. He'd have to share her with me. But she can have him. Connor was only a little fun for me. Plenty of other fish in the sea, right?"

Hugo said, "I know there's a few biting in that bookstore of yours already."

They laughed at that, but now Madeleine urged him back up onto his feet, and grabbed his hand, pulling him over toward the floor-to-ceiling windows.

"I want to see," she said, placing her hands on the glass and jutting out her pert behind for him, apparently completely unconcerned how exposed she was in front of all that window, without any kind of blind or curtain to shield her.

Hugo slipped his hand between her thighs as he stood behind her, feeling how incredibly wet she was. He opened his fly, slipped his rock-hard cock out, then quietly glided inside her gloriously hot pussy, his thrust into her made so easy by her evening's infidelity.

"Oh God... oh that feels amazing," his beautiful wife sighed as he filled her.

It was an amazing feeling. Though Lucy had cleaned her following Connor's climax, deep inside her Hugo could feel an uncommonly silky wetness that was not merely Madeleine's own lubrication.

"I can feel his come inside you," Hugo said, trying to keep himself controlled within her.

He could see her smile reflected in the glass. "It seems so wrong letting him finish inside me," she said, moaning as Hugo continued to plough into her from behind, "but it's so incredible to feel that big hard cock stretching me, pulsing as he's pumping it deep inside me..."

Hugo slowed, pacing himself, wanting to experience this for longer.

"You're so hard," Madeleine said, her voice hushed in awe. "It really turns you on to see him fuck me, doesn't it? To watch him put that big hard cock inside me..."

It was almost as though she was trying to force his hand. He loved the way she talked, so different from the way it had been before, when neither of them could open up about anything even vaguely sexual.

"We should go back over there, once they're ready," Madeleine said.

"You want him again?" Hugo smiled. "One last time before you give him up?"

"I want both of you," she said, "even if it's just once, I want to feel you both inside me."

The thought of Madeleine taking two guys at once, whether it included her husband or not, was too much for Hugo to contemplate and keep himself back from the edge.

He said, "I'm sure it won't just be the once."

Then as he saw the look of delight on her face, reflected back in the glass, and felt her body shudder and shake as a fresh orgasm seized hold of her. Hugo was suddenly at the end of the road, grabbing her hips tight as he buried himself deep inside her, his huge fat cock throbbed as he pumped his own hot come inside her, claiming her, marking her as his own.

*

Afterwards, back in their clothes, though Madeleine had precious little other than her coat, they leaned against the back of the couch, gazing out the windows, watching their apartment across the street, as Lucy rode Connor like a jockey on a champion racehorse. There could be no doubting that the two of them had powerful chemistry. Lucy looked besotted, the rapturous expression on her face as she writhed on top of him making it appear she had never experienced such instant attraction before. Connor was looking up at her as though she was some kind of angel. Or, as Hugo suspected, a goddess.

"Will you keep seeing him after tonight?"

"I wonder if it might not be better to leave them to it for a while," she said.

Madeleine looked a touch regretful—and yet happy for her friend. Nostalgic, perhaps, was the word for it. One episode in her life—their lives—was coming to an end, but a new one was beginning, offering tantalizing possibilities.

"You know, Connor just told me he wanted to see what it was like, being in a relationship like ours?" Hugo said.

"Is that so? And Lucy wants to try it, too. That's a happy coincidence."

"I guess we've shown them how wild it can be."

Madeleine turned to look at him, a mischievous glint in her eye. “Oh, we’ve only just scratched the surface,” she said, and with a glance at the door, indicated that it was time to rejoin the party.

#

Acknowledgements

The writing of this trilogy was something of a journey for me, in exploring ideas I inadvertently uncovered in the writing of my earlier novel, *Anarchy of the Heart*, and at the end of it all, I'd like to thank a few people who have helped me along the way.

Firstly I'd like to thank my beloved wife who spurred me into writing *Anarchy of the Heart* in the first place by stating her verdict on my earlier stories as “a little tame” when first I revealed the shocking truth that I was an author of erotic fiction. That story was supposed to be a straightforward account of group sex, to hit back at my “tame” label, conceding that most of my previous stories had been one-on-one “vanilla” erotic romance. I decided on a partner-swapping scenario set in the relative safety of a foreign vacation, and, reluctant to toy with the concept of marriage, opted for protagonists who were merely engaged to be married.

In the writing of *Anarchy*, I had assumed the big thrill for a male writer such as myself would have been the opportunity for my hero, Leo, to explore his desires with more than one woman—separately, and together. Perhaps as a younger, single writer, that would have been the case. But as I wrote the story, trying to really imagine what it would actually be like for a committed couple to consider such a challenge to monogamy, it seemed to me that the more significant concerns in the mind of my leading man was how he would cope knowing his beloved fiancée was going to be sleeping with another man, and how she might feel about him sleeping with another woman.

It was this inner conflict that caught my interest as a writer, and to my surprise as I was writing the story, it appeared that for a man like Leo, the jealousy and fear that comes with giving up your true love

(albeit temporarily) to allow her an earth-shattering experience in the arms of another man could actually enhance the sensations for him, and even strengthen the desire he felt for his beloved, and the romantic bond they shared together.

In taking forward this concept in a story about such feelings within an established marriage, I have found the writing of authors including Kirsten McCurran, Kenny Wright and Ben Boswell enormously enlightening and enjoyable, along with countless blogs written by real people out there exploring “semi-open” relationships. Mainstream culture doesn’t imbue these kind of journals with much value, but in revealing the thoughts and experiences of people leading lives different than the norm, they do hold a great deal of value.

I’d also give a nod to the impressive and highly readable academic examination of “insatiable wives” within David J Ley’s book, *Insatiable Wives: Women Who Stray and the Men Who Love Them*, which also proved hugely helpful and informative regarding relationships where the husband enjoys the sexual freedom of his wife.

In the actual production of the Madeleine Trilogy, I’d like to give particular thanks to Kenny Wright, who as editor has been invaluable in discussing the story, the subject of insatiable wives in their various guises, and the inner workings of erotic fiction. This would be a far poorer story without his input.

And finally, special thanks above all to you, Dear Reader, for honoring me with your time and attention. In this day and age, the reader has never been more important to an author, not merely in shelling out for a book in the first place, but in recommending it to friends and strangers through online bookstores, social media and even by word-of-mouth.

If you’ve enjoyed this trilogy, if it’s not too much trouble I would urge you to share your honest review with others via the ebook store where you made the purchase, or on Twitter, Facebook, GoodReads or

your favorite discussion portal for fiction. You'll not only help others to find this story for themselves, you'll be actively helping in the production of more stories from your humble author.

About the Author

Max Sebastian lives in London with his wife and child, and has been writing erotica for more than 10 years, winning awards including Literotica.com's Best Erotic Couplings Story, Reader's Choice Sci-Fi & Fantasy Story and Best First-Time Story.

Breaking into the world of indie publishing in late 2011, with his first full length erotic novel *Anarchy of the Heart* arriving in 2012, and Submitting to Her a year later, his writing explores various erotic fantasies and kinks, from sweet vanilla erotic romance to spicy ménage stories, revealing voyeurism/exhibitionism, scandalous wife-sharing, sensual femdom and light BDSM. His stories particularly focus on sexy, independent and empowered females along with the strong, sensitive men who can help them find their happy ever after.

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And, readers are always very welcome to contact Max by emailing Max@MaxSebastian.net.

Also by Max Sebastian

Novels

Anarchy of the Heart

Madeleine Wakes

Madeleine Plays

Madeleine Strays

Submitting to Her

Short stories

Inside Source

Sexual Healing

Two Anonymous Souls

The Wives with Benefits Collection (*Wife-sharing short stories*)

Retribution

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The Female-Led Collection (*Light femdom short stories*)

In Her Service

Stockholm

She was a Good Girl

The New Adult Collection (*Coming-of-age short stories*)

A Girl in the Library

A Kiss is Just a Kiss

Waiting in Line for a New iPad

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